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The Indian EXPRESS

JOURNALISM of COURAGE

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Happening today

● **THE UNITED** Nations General Assembly will vote to elect its next president for a one-year term. Bangladesh Foreign Minister Khalilur Rahman and Cyprus Special Envoy for Multi-lateralism Ambassador Andreas Kakouris are vying to lead the General Assembly during its 81st session, which starts in September.

● **LEBANON AND** Israel are set to hold their next round of direct talks in Washington even as Israel's government ordered strikes on the southern suburbs of Beirut Monday.

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POLITICS PAGE 5

BENGAL CABINET EXPANSION: 35 MINISTERS TAKE OATH

SIGNATURE ROW: TMC EXPELS 2 MLAS, CM SAYS THEY FILED COMPLAINTS

STEM girl power: In JEE Advanced, over 10,000 clear exam — highest pass rate

Pallavi Smart
Mumbai, June 1

FOR THE first time, more than 10,000 girls have cleared JEE Advanced 2026, the gateway to IITs and premier engineering institutions, according to data analysed by *The Indian Express*. With one in four girl candidates clearing the exam, this also marks a new record.

The data shows that the number of girls clearing JEE Advanced has jumped nearly 89 per cent, from 5,356 to 10,107, since 2019. Over the same

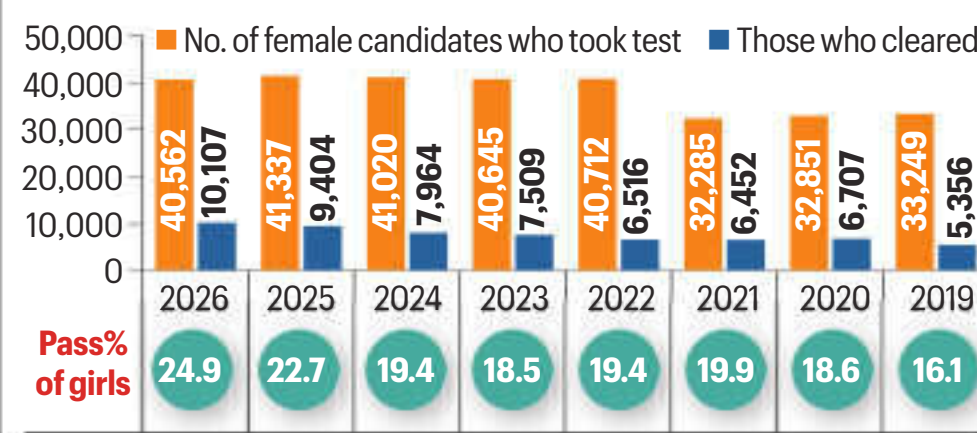
period, the number of girls appearing for the exam rose by about 22 per cent, from 33,249 to 40,562.

As the results were declared Monday, 24.9 per cent of the 40,562 female candidates, who appeared, cleared the exam. Overall, around 56,000 candidates qualified and made it to the common rank list.

How many of the successful girl candidates make it to IITs depends on their rankings and availability of seats — the 23 IITs together offer about 20,000

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

● RISING SUCCESS RATE



Prime Minister Narendra Modi with Myanmar President U Min Aung Hlaing at Hyderabad House in New Delhi, Monday. ANIL SHARMA

Won't allow our territory to be used against India's interests: Myanmar

Shubhajit Roy
New Delhi, June 1

MYANMAR PRESIDENT U Min Aung Hlaing assured Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Monday that Myanmar's territory "would not be permitted to be used against India's security interests".

In the past, India has repeatedly expressed concern

over Northeast insurgent groups operating from within Myanmar.

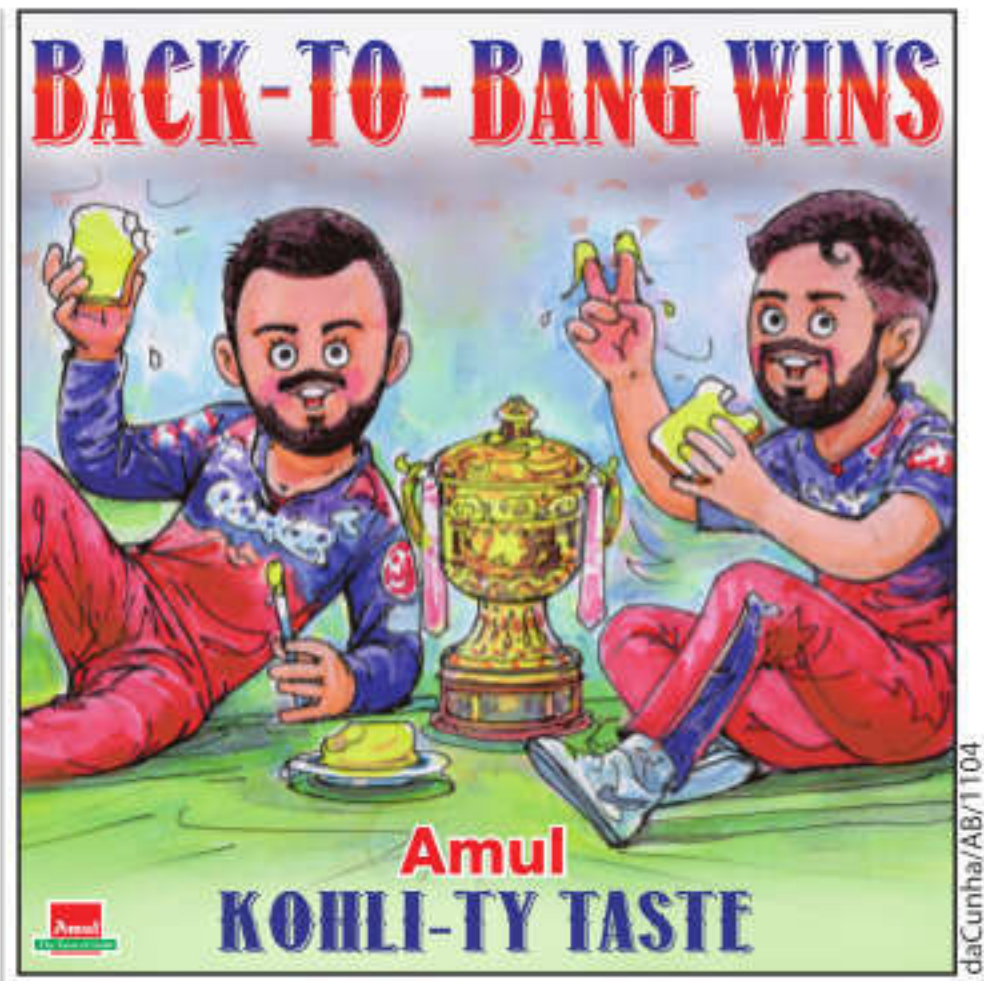
Briefing reporters after the bilateral meeting, Foreign Secretary Vikram Misri underlined that "stability and peace in Myanmar is a major interest for India".

Min Aung Hlaing is visiting India from May 30 to June 3 — his first visit since taking over

as President. The former chief of the military junta government was elected President on April 3, five years after he grabbed power in a coup, ousting an elected government.

Misri said the leaders discussed cooperation on defence and security, critical minerals and rare earth, and connectivity projects.

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2



FOUR-DAY TRADE TALKS

India seeks edge over Asian peers in US talks

10% tariffs lapse in July, Trump can use Section 301 to levy higher duties

Ravi Dutta Mishra
New Delhi, June 1

AS NEGOTIATORS from India and the US begin what seems like the final round of talks before formally signing a bilateral trade agreement, Commerce and Industry Ministry officials Monday said New Delhi is seeking an edge over Asian competitors under the new set of Section 301 tariffs Washington is expected to announce before July-end.

The US had earlier said it would use Section 301, which gives it powers to slap higher import duty on countries hurting its industry, after the President Donald Trump administration lost the case on reciprocal tariffs in the US Supreme Court. Immediately after this loss, the US had imposed 10% global tariffs under Section 122. This lapses on July 24, which creates the urgency for New Delhi to sign a trade deal within the next 5-7 weeks.

The framework for the US-

Business as Usual

By EP UNNY



India bilateral trade agreement was agreed upon in February when the US said it would bring down tariffs to 18% from an effective tariff of 50% (25% reciprocal and 25% penalty for buying Russian oil).

"Now the fight is about Section 301, which is the only statute available to the administration given by the US Congress. The rates do not matter in this case; preferential market access

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

Delhi building collapse: Owner arrested, police say family has several properties in area



At the building collapse site in New Delhi, Monday. ABHINAV SAHA

Pragnesh & Alok Singh
New Delhi, June 1

TWO DAYS after a building undergoing allegedly illegal additions collapsed in South Delhi killing six people, the Delhi Police said on Monday that they had arrested the 71-year-old owner, Karambir Sejwal.

Sejwal, who had been missing since the tragedy on Saturday evening, was traced to his farmhouse in Green Avenue, Church/Mall Road in southwest Delhi's Vasant Kunj, police said.

Sejwal's family owns several properties in the Saidulajab area, which it has rented out to

businesses and individuals, police said. A sign, allegedly put up by Sejwal's family, at the mouth of the lane in which the building stood, says "Zaildar Estate". Police sources said the family likely had powerful "political connections".

Five medical and engineering graduates and the owner of a makeshift canteen in which the students were eating, were killed after the building on Westend Marg in Saidulajab came down in a heap of rubble — with chunks of concrete crushing the tin-roof eatery. Saidulajab, an urban village

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

CITY

OWNERS OF SIX BUILDINGS IN SAME AREA GET NOTICES

EATERY WAS GO-TO PLACE FOR STUDENTS STAYING NEARBY

PAGE 4

For 2 years, rape convict Asaram kept getting bail, citing failing health — until HC drew line

He's back in jail after Rajasthan HC on May 27 cancelled bail, upheld conviction

Hamza Khan
Jaipur, June 1

OVER THE past two years, self-styled godman Asaram Babu, convicted for rape in two cases, has cited his deteriorating health to obtain court relief at least 15 times through medical treatment permissions, emergency paroles, and interim bail. On May 27, that run was halted.

The Rajasthan High Court upheld his life sentence in a

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 7

● 15 TIMES AND COUNTING

MARCH 21, 2024: HC allows Asaram to be taken to Arogyadham Centre, Jodhpur; stays until April 2

APRIL 16: HC allows him to get admitted at the Jodhpur centre for "7-10 days".

JULY 26: HC removes condition that he pay for his security

AUG 13: HC grants "emergent parole" for 7 days so Asaram can get treatment at Madhavbaug hospital in Maharashtra.

SEPT 3: HC extends Asaram's emergent parole by 5 days.

NOV 7: Court eases his bail conditions, says can stay at Arogyadham for a "period deemed appropriate" by hospital authorities.

DEC 10: HC allows Asaram's treat-

ment at Madhavbaug for 17 days.

JAN 7, 2025: SC gives him interim bail until March 31 for treatment.

JAN 14: Rajasthan HC too gives him bail until same date; Gujarat HC gives bail until June 30, extends it to July 1.

APRIL 7: Rajasthan HC extends bail until July 1; is extended to July 7 by Gujarat HC & July 9 by Rajasthan HC.

JULY 8: Rajasthan HC extends bail until Aug 12.

AUG 11: Asaram's lawyers submit Gujarat HC has extended his interim bail up to Aug 21, Rajasthan HC extends his bail until Aug 29.

OCT 13: Arogyam Ayurvedic Hospital states Asaram suffering from



Asaram in Jodhpur on May 28 before his surrender. PTIFILE

multiple serious illnesses.

OCT 29: Rajasthan HC gives Asaram interim bail for six months

APRIL 29, 2026: HC grants him bail until May 25, or up to the date judgment delivered in his appeal, whichever is earlier

MAY 25: Bail extended until July 7

MAY 27: Rajasthan HC cancels bail

Annamalai set to resign from BJP, open a new chapter in TN politics

Arun Janardhanan
Chennai, June 1

K ANNAMALAI, the former Tamil Nadu BJP president and one of the party's most visible faces in the South, is likely to submit his resignation from the BJP and formally convey this decision to party chief Nitin Nabin in Delhi, according to multiple senior BJP sources familiar with the development.

Reliable sources in the BJP



Former Tamil Nadu BJP chief K Annamalai. @ANNAMALAI_K/JX

said he has already made up his mind and that the Delhi visit is intended not merely as a political meeting but also as a gesture of gratitude towards a party with which he spent the last six years of his public life. "He wants to thank the leadership for the opportunities, experiences and political journey the BJP gave him after he resigned from the IPS," a top source familiar with the discussions said.

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Telangana bans salary in cash, brings gig workers under minimum wage net

Nikhila Henry
Hyderabad, June 1

A BAN on cash wage payments, mandatory electronic transfer and bringing gig workers under the country's minimum wages law — that's what the Telangana government has done through a government order that was issued recently.

This comes months after the Telangana Assembly passed The Telangana Platform-Based

Gig Workers (Registration, Social Security and Welfare) Act, 2026. The GO serves as the mechanism to execute that law by bringing eCommerce, courier, and platform workers under the official minimum wage net and tightening wage payment compliance.

Issued on May 30, but coming into force Monday, the order — GO Ms No. 6 — activates the provisions of the

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E. EXPLAINED

Wage security

The government order brings e-commerce, courier and platform workers under official minimum wage net and tightens wage-payment compliance. Platforms are now required to pay overtime at double the standard rate.



The mural by Satish Gujral at Shastri Bhawan. GUJRAL FOUNDATION

● CULTURE MINISTRY, NGMA, GUJRAL FOUNDATION WORKING ON PLAN TO REMOVE, RELOCATE MURALS INSTALLED IN 1968

Shastri Bhawan to be razed, Satish Gujral murals to find new home

Damini Nath
New Delhi, June 1

ALMOST 60 YEARS after they were installed, murals by artist Satish Gujral on the facade of Shastri Bhawan are set to be removed and relocated before the building's demolition for the Central Vista redevelopment project, *The Indian Express* has learnt.

As part of the government's redevelopment project, Shastri Bhawan and the adjoining Krishi Bhawan are set to be demolished soon to pave the way for two new office buildings — Common Central Secretariat (Kartavya Bhawan) 4 and 5. The Central Public Works Depart-

ment (CPWD) has floated the tender for the project, which includes the demolition of the existing structures. The last date for bids is June 6, with an estimated cost of Rs 3,218.44 crore, as per the tender document.

According to government officials, the Ministry of Culture, National Gallery of Modern Art (NGMA) and Gujral Foundation are currently working on a plan to move the ceramic tile murals, spanning the height of the seven-storey building, which were installed on the facade of Shastri Bhawan in 1968. The final place for the murals has not been decided yet, they said.

When reached for comment, Mohit Gujral, son of Satish Gujral and the co-founder of the Gujral Foundation, said: "The National Gallery of Modern Art has been consulting conservation experts to determine the most appropriate methodology for undertaking this complex exercise and has remained in touch with the Gujral Foundation wherever necessary during the process."

Kishore Singh, an independent art consultant and the curator of the Satish Gujral retrospective at NGMA earlier this year marking the artist's centennial, said the Shastri Bha-

wan murals were among several installed by the artist in the 1960s.

"Satish Gujral had gone to study mural-making in Mexico in the 1950s from Diego Rivera and David Alfaro Siqueiros. He was the first Indian artist to go on a scholarship to study mural-making. When he came back, he started making his murals using ceramic tiles. He made murals for the Delhi High Court, Baroda House and Shastri Bhawan. If his murals are being removed and relocated, it is a progressive step and sets a good precedent," Singh said.

With the work on the build-

ings likely to start soon, the murals are expected to be removed within a month.

Under the government's Central Vista plan, 10 new Common Central Secretariat (CCS) buildings have been proposed to house all Union Ministries. The new buildings are to come up at the site of existing offices and other government buildings. Last month, Nirman Bhawan became the first of the old office buildings to be demolished. The demolition of Udyog Bhawan, Shastri Bhawan and Krishi Bhawan are expected to start soon.

Started in 2019, the Central Vista plan includes the construction of the new Parliament

building, Vice-President's Enclave and Executive Enclave (Prime Minister's Office, Cabinet Secretariat and the National Security Council Secretariat). Of the 10 CCS buildings, three have been completed, while tendering or construction of the remaining seven are underway. The construction of the Prime Minister's residence is also underway.

As of February this year, according to a reply by the Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs in Parliament, the total sanctioned cost of the projects, including Parliament, Vice-President's Enclave and Kartavya Bhawan, was Rs 13,169.61 crore.

DELHI GYMKHANA CLUB LEASE TERMINATION

‘Process of taking back govt land will go on’



Express News Service
New Delhi, June 1

DAYS AFTER the Union Government started the process of taking back the land leased to the Delhi Gymkhana Club, Minister of Housing and Urban Affairs (MoHUA) Manohar Lal on Monday said the government could take back land needed for any other purpose and that this process would be followed wherever necessary.

In his first remarks on the issue since the Ministry's Land and Development Office (L&DO) on May 22 wrote to the club to vacate the land by June 5 as it was required for "defence infrastructure", the minister said: "Land is a basic feature of urban development... In most cases, it has been given on lease. The leased land can be vacated upon expiry of the

Union Minister Manohar Lal. FILE

lease or even before that for any other use... The land we are taking back today will be put to use as per the requirements, and this work will carry on... There is no other source of land, so we will have to use this land for development needs."

Manohar Lal made the remarks while replying to a question at a press briefing on the BRICS Urbanisation Forum to be hosted by the Ministry in Delhi on June 11-12.

In its May 22 letter, the Land

and Development Office wrote to the Delhi Gymkhana Club, "Whereas, it has been determined that the said premises, located in a highly sensitive and strategic area of Delhi, is critically required for the strengthening and securing of defence infrastructure and other vital public security purposes. The land is essential to fulfil urgent institutional needs, governance infrastructure, and public-interest projects, integrated with the resumption of adjoining government lands."

Not just the Delhi Gymkhana Club, but other prominent lessees, including the Delhi Race Club, have also been asked to vacate the land. Last week, the Delhi High Court vacated a stay on the eviction proceedings started by the L&DO against the Race Club.

Master Plan 2041 to be finalised after Amit Shah chairs meeting: Manohar Lal

Express News Service
New Delhi, June 1

DELHI'S MASTER Plan 2041—which has been in the works for years—would be finalised after one "last meeting" to be chaired by Union Home Minister Amit Shah, Housing and Urban Affairs Minister Manohar Lal said on Monday.

Asked at a press conference about the status of the delayed masterplan of the Delhi Development Authority, the Minister said: "One last meeting is due at the level of the Home Minister. We have completed the work and submitted it... Just two-three final suggestions from there have to be incorporated

and one last final meeting will be held before we complete the process."

The Master Plan 2041 was supposed to be notified in 2021, to replace the Master Plan 2021.

The Delhi Development Authority had approved it in February 2023 and sent it to MoHUA on April 13, 2023, according to a reply by the Ministry in August 2024. Since then, discussions have been held within the Ministry and at a meeting chaired by Shah in July last year.

When he was asked about the status at a press conference on September 30, last year, the Minister had said there were "technical issues" that would

be addressed soon.

Approving the Masterplan 2041 was on the Ministry's agenda for the first 100 days of the third term of the Narendra Modi government. The master plan is yet to be notified.

Asked about the National Capital Region (NCR) Master Plan 2041, which has also been delayed, the Minister said the NCR states—Delhi, Haryana, Rajasthan and Uttar Pradesh—had some objections to the draft.

Further, he said the plan would be finalised on June 16 at a meeting of the NCR Planning Board, which includes representatives from all the NCR states.

• Skywatch

Forecast: June 2, 2026:
Partly cloudy sky becoming generally cloudy sky; spell of very light to light rain

MAX: 36-38
2°C below normal

MIN: 25-27
1.9°C below normal

- *Sunrise: 5:24 AM (June 3)*
- *Sunset: 7:15 PM (June 2)*
- *Moonrise: 9:15 PM (June 2)*
- *Moonset: 7:25 AM (June 3)*

• AQI Tracker

Anand Vihar
Satisfactory
AQI: 73

Aya Nagar
Satisfactory
AQI: 91

ITO
Satisfactory
AQI: 80

IGI
Moderate
AQI: 104

● Good (0-50)

● Satisfactory (51-100)

● Moderate (101-200)

● Poor (201-300)

● Very Poor (301-400)

● Severe (401-500)

Property registration scrutiny tightened to check undervaluation, recover stamp duty loss

Express News Service
New Delhi, June 1

TO CURB undervaluation of properties and ensure that government receives the correct amount of stamp duty, the Revenue department has directed all sub-registrars and joint sub-registrars to closely scrutinise registrations and take action to recover deficient amount if the declared property value is lower than the circle rates, particularly in cases involving basements in residential areas, officials said on Monday.

The circular, issued by the Divisional Commissioner's office, lays down the procedure to be followed under Section 47-A of the Indian Stamp Act, 1899, in cases where properties appear to be undervalued.

As per the circular, under the Delhi Stamp (Prevention of Under-valuation of Instruments) Rules, 2007, owners must clearly specify both the plinth area (covered area) and built-up area (total physical footprint) of the property and the stamp duty will be calculated on the basis of these values, including the construc-

tion cost. However, it is often observed that stamp duty is incorrectly computed on the maximum permissible plinth area instead of the actual built-up area, leading to undervaluation, it said.

Amid these concerns, the department directed sub-registrars to inform concerned parties in writing when they register a property that they are paying less than the required amount if the declared property value is lower than the official circle rate. The department also said that parties shall be given an opportunity to amend the document to reflect the correct valuation and to pay the deficient stamp duty.

"If the parties fail to amend the instrument and do not pay the requisite stamp duty as per the circle rate valuation, the sub-registrar and joint sub-registrar shall register the instrument with an endorsement regarding the deficiency and forward the registered document to the collector of stamps for for determination of the correct market value and proper stamp duty..." read the circular.

The Collector of Stamps has been directed to dispose of such cases within three months of receiving the documents, said officials.

Encroachment notice sent to Ghaziabad teen murder accused

Drishhti Jain
Ghaziabad, June 1

A DAY after Asad, the main suspect in the Ghaziabad teen murder case, was killed in an encounter, the district administration on Monday pasted an encroachment notice outside a two-storey house owned by his father, stating that it stands on the land owned by the government.



The notice pasted outside the house in Ghaziabad. AMIT MEHRA

The owner, identified as Nawab, is also an accused in the murder case. He has been asked to remove the alleged encroachment within 15 days, officials said. In its statement, Ghaziabad District Administration claimed the owner had illegally occupied a portion of this government land.

"A notice is issued under Section 136 of the Uttar Pradesh Revenue Code, 2006, directing that the said illegal occupation be removed within 15 days of receipt of the notice. Otherwise, legal action will be taken and the encroachment will be removed at one's own expense,"

There was no 16-hour study schedule, sleep non-negotiable, says JEE Advanced AIR 10

Express News Service
New Delhi, June 1



Darsh Sikka. EXPRESS

AT 17, Darsh Sikka from South Delhi's Kidwai Nagar knew when to study and when his body needed to relax.

On the days when his preparation for JEE (Advanced) took a toll on him, Sikka would step away from his desk. He would play chess, head out to play sports with friends, or simply leave the books behind for a few hours.

"I tried studying 14-15 hours a day for two days," he recalled. "It didn't work for me. The cognitive load became too much. I couldn't process things properly and my problem-solving ability started going down," he told *The Indian Express* on Monday.

Among the 1,79,694 candidates who appeared for both papers of JEE (Advanced) 2026 on May 17, Sikka secured an All India Rank (AIR) 10 with a score of 311 out of 360 marks. The results, declared on Monday,

placed him among the country's highest-performing engineering aspirants.

All three top rankers—Shubham Kumar, Kabir Chhillar, and Jatin Chahar—belong to the IIT Delhi zone, which dominated the Common Rank List (CRL) this year.

While Kumar scored 330 out of 360 marks, Chhillar received 329 marks. Chahar secured the third place with 319 marks.

For Sikka, who lives near South Extension and studied at Delhi Public School, R.K Puram, the journey to crack one of India's toughest examina-

tions began much earlier, in Class 9.

Some of his friends had started preparing for competitive examinations, and he found himself drawn to the challenge. "I tried some problem-solving and liked the idea of solving difficult questions," he said. "I wanted to take it up as a challenge. And IIT is one of the most prestigious institutions, so I wanted to get into it."

Sikka says chemistry wasn't his strong suit. "Chemistry was my major weakness during preparation," he said. "I kept revising repeatedly, and because of support from my teachers, I was able to improve my performance."

"There wasn't a 16-hour study schedule," he said with a smile. Instead, he generally limited himself to around 10 or 11 hours of study each day and made sleep non-negotiable.

"I tried to get seven hours of sleep every day," he said. "My mother made sure of it. If I wasn't getting enough sleep, she

would practically force me to sleep."

His father played a different but equally important role. When mock test scores dipped and frustration mounted, the solution was often not another practice paper. "My father would say, 'let's go somewhere,'" Sikka said. "Just getting out with family helped."

The breaks, he believes, were essential. "Studying continuously for very long hours didn't work for me..."

Throughout his preparation, he maintained friendships, continued playing sports and occasionally turned to chess to clear his mind. The friendships extended to his coaching centre as well.

"My friend group was very good," he said. "The teachers were also quite chill. There were a lot of jokes and fun interactions in class."

Sikka expects to pursue Computer Science, with his top preferences being IIT Bombay and IIT Delhi.

ARMED FORCES TRIBUNAL (PRINCIPAL BENCH)
West Block-VIII, Sector-1, R.K. Puram, New Delhi-110066

Applications are invited for filling up the following posts in the Armed Forces Tribunal, Principal Bench, New Delhi on Deputation for a period of three years

S. No.	Name of the Post	No. of Post	Pay scale (Rs.)
1.	Financial Adviser and Chief Accounts Officer	01	Pay Matrix Level -13 (Rs 123100-215900)
2.	Tribunal Officer/Section Officer	01	Pay Matrix Level - 07 (Rs 44900-142400)
3.	Tribunal Master/Stenographer Grade-I	03	Pay Matrix Level - 06 (Rs 35400-112400)
4.	Junior Accounts Officer	01	Pay Matrix Level - 06 (Rs 35400-112400)
5.	Upper Division Clerk	01	Pay Matrix Level - 04 (Rs 25500-81100)
6.	Lower Division Clerk	02	Pay Matrix Level - 02 (Rs 19900-63200)

For further details, kindly visit our web site www.aft.gov.in

(Sunil Kumar Sharma)
Deputy Registrar

Date : 01.06.2026

त्रिपुरा विश्वविद्यालय
TRIPURA UNIVERSITY
(केन्द्रीय विश्वविद्यालय / A Central University), त्रिपुरा (E.) / Tripura (W), पिन / PIN - 799022

Ref. No. F.No.TU/Dy.R. Acad/Admission/2026-27/01 **ADMISSION NOTICE** Date: 01.06.2026

Admissions are open for Postgraduate Diploma and Postgraduate Programmes for the Academic Session 2026-27 through CUET (PG)-2026 conducted by NTA. Online registration through the Tripura University Admission Portal has commenced from 26th May, 2026 and will continue till 14th June, 2026 (5:00 PM). For programme details, eligibility criteria and admission updates, visit: <https://tripurauniversity.ac.in> and <https://tripuraminvest.com/triuniv.edu.in/> (NIT - Hindi version is available on T.U. website)

Sd/- (Prof. Samir Kumar Sill), Registrar(I/c)

IN REMEMBRANCE

Corps of Signals salutes its Signallers who left us for their heavenly abode during the month of May 2026.

(a) 15677423X	Havildar	Niranjan HR
(b) 15708246M	Havildar	Satendra Singh
(c) 15708363X	Havildar	Rajana Lakshmana Rao
(d) 15726973M	Naik	Ravinder Kumar
(d) A4203146F	Agniveer	Yuvraj Singh

Deeply mourned by Lt Gen Vivek Dogra, SM, SO-in-C, Col Comdt and all ranks of Corps of Signals.

DELHI PUBLIC SCHOOL BHILAI
Risali Sector, Bhilai, Chhattisgarh – 490006
(Under the aegis of The Delhi Public School Society, New Delhi)

REQUIRES PRINCIPAL

Candidates with a consistently strong academic record, with at least 55% marks in post-graduation, a B.Ed. degree and a minimum of 15 years of teaching experience in Senior Secondary classes in English medium that includes at least 5 years of experience in an administrative capacity (as Principal/Vice Principal only), are invited to apply.

The age of the candidate should not exceed 55 years as on 1st April, 2026.

Salary, perquisites and other benefits shall be as per the rules of The DPS Society. Higher emoluments will not be a constraint for a deserving candidate. National award winners in the field of education will be given preference.

Procedure for submitting applications :

1. Apply on-line by clicking 'Application for the post of Principal' at the 'Careers' section of website of DPS, Bhilai (<https://dpsbhilai.in>).

2. After successfully submitting the application on-line, take print-outs of the application that is sent to your e-mail, affix your recent passport-size photograph on it, enclose self-attested photocopies of certificates related only to your date of birth, qualifications, experience and national awards, if any, and post it to the following addresses :

a) The Secretary, The Delhi Public School Society, F-Block, East of Kailash, New Delhi-110065.

b) The Secretary, Steel Education Society (SES), Room No. 01, Office of Employee Services, Old Hospital Building, Sector-5, Bhilai – 490006.

c) Last date for submission of applications on-line is 15/06/2026.

d) Last date for receipt of hardcopy of applications at DPSS, New Delhi and SES, Bhilai, is 25/06/2026.

3. The envelope should be superscribed: 'Application for the post of Principal, DPS Bhilai'

4. Incomplete or erroneous applications will be summarily rejected.

5. Please do not enclose any other document (like letters of appreciation, certificates of participation etc) with your application other than those specified above.

Only shortlisted candidates will be called for an interview.

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SIX PEOPLE WERE KILLED AFTER ILLEGAL STRUCTURE FELL ON SATURDAY EVENING

After Saket building collapse, six nearby premises get MCD notice

‘Hundreds of buildings flouting norms’ in nearby areas, say police

Pragnesh & Drishti Jain
New Delhi, June 1

TWO DAYS after a building collapse in Saidulajab area near the Saket Metro station in South Delhi killed six people, including five medical and engineering graduates, the Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) launched a crackdown on Monday against illegal constructions and issued notices to owners of six buildings in the vicinity, said officials.

The *Indian Express* reported on Monday that the Delhi Police on two occasions in March had flagged ongoing illegal construction atop the four-storey building, which crashed on May 30. More than a dozen people — mostly medical and engineering graduates — were present inside a canteen adjacent to it, which was crushed in the collapse. Six of them died.

Even as construction of only three floors plus stilt parking is allowed, as per officials, a large number of buildings — like the one that collapsed — are allegedly flouting the norms in the neighbourhood, which is home to a large number of students preparing for various competitive exams.

Sources told *The Indian Express* that letters were sent to MCD regarding 200 to 300 such illegal structures by Mehrauli police station to MCD, BSES, and Delhi Jal Board in the Mehrauli-Chattarpur belt in the last three months.

A senior MCD official said, “We’ll analyse what action has been taken against these units. At some places, notices may have been issued, some units may have been sealed, and at some places demolitions have been carried out.”

Close to the site of the incident stands another abandoned structure of five floors, which was also sealed by the MCD.

“After it was sealed, authorities just scrapped some part of its porch and then removed the seal. It should have been razed completely,” said a source on the condition of anonymity.

Multiple commercial and residential buildings in the neighbourhood are allegedly



Policemen deployed in the locality on Monday. EXPRESS

flouting norms. Apart from underground libraries, which have been operating in alleged violation of rules, students say rampant illegal construction has been ongoing in the area.

“Almost every building here is like that. Fire safety norms are not being followed. Underground libraries have no ventilation. Last year, a blaze broke out in one such library. But no action was taken,” said a friend of one of the deceased, preparing for Foreign Medical Graduate Examination (FMGE).

A student, who witnessed the collapse last week, said, “Imagine the toll if this incident had happened that day. Workers were involved in the construction at the building that came crashing down... there were students involved in the co-working space,” he said.

Admitting that illegal construction has been rampant, another MCD official said, “Around a 100-300 m area located in the vicinity of Rai Pithora Fort was initially unoccupied... nobody used to take care of it... then people either encroached on it or made unauthorised constructions here.”

On the alleged violation by the building that crashed, the MCD officer said, “The engineer concerned did not give us information earlier, and after the building collapsed, a report was sought. In the report, he had mentioned that he had inspected the building on May 27 but there was no such report handed over to the office on May 27.”

‘Aunty Wala Kitchen’ go-to place for students who stayed in PG, on rent while preparing for exams

Alok Singh & Pragnesh
New Delhi, June 1

PARVATI OJHA (50) had managed to escape moments before a four-storey building collapsed on her eatery at Saidulajab near the Saket Metro station on Saturday night. But then she turned back. She hoped to save some medical and engineering graduates — many of whom regularly ate at her makeshift eatery — after they got trapped under the debris.

She never came out again. Her body was recovered later along with that of five students who were at her eatery when the building collapsed.

She ran ‘Aunty Wala Kitchen’, located next to the building that housed a coaching centre. The eatery was the go-to place for students who stayed as paying guests and tenants in the area while they prepared for competitive examinations.

“Parvati aunty” was popular among the students. “She would always think of us. She was humble, calm and helpful. Minutes before the incident, I had coffee in the eatery and left. I had barely reached my PG accommodation when I heard a loud noise. I saw the building next to her kitchen collapsing,” a young woman recalled.

“Aunty, her staffers and some students had managed to come out of the eatery. But after a few seconds, she went back in, hoping to help some students trapped inside. She got trapped herself,” she added.

Hari Prasad Ojha, Parvati’s cousin, worked with her in the eatery. “I was preparing cold coffee. The last order was for 12 parathas and four cold coffees... We rushed out as soon as we heard sounds from the adjacent building. But Parvati went back inside while talking to someone over the phone,” he said.

Originally from Nepal, Parvati had been living in Delhi for several years. Around a year ago, she had opened the eatery — a single-storey structure with a tin roof — for students in the area, said Ojha.



Excavators remove the rubble at the site on Monday. ANI

Aadarsh, a BTech graduate preparing for the GATE exam, said the food at Parvati’s eatery was hygienic. “She did not increase food prices even during shortage of LPG cylinders.”

Another student, Aarav, added that parathas and cold coffee were among the favourites on the menu. “She always thought about students.”

As rescue teams and excavators removed the debris on Sunday, Parvati’s daughter Neelam and other relatives waited, hoping against hope. After a 16-hour operation, Parvati was pulled out of the debris and rushed to a hospital, where doctors declared her dead.

Ekta (24) was one of the five students who had gathered at her eatery to grab a bite when the building collapsed.

Five years ago, her father Ramesh Chand had sold a portion of his family’s land in Rajasthan’s Alwar district so Ekta could pursue her dream of becoming a doctor in Kyrgyzstan. But fate had other plans.

On Sunday, around 4 pm, Ramesh broke down as rescue workers pulled out Ekta’s body from the rubble. “On Saturday afternoon, we spoke on the phone... We spoke about her exams, which she said had gone well. She was very happy,” said Ramesh, adding that Ekta’s 25th birthday was only days away.

Around 9 pm, he received a call from one of Ekta’s friends informing him that the building has collapsed. Ekta, who had gone to the eatery for

dinner, could not be contacted.

Ramesh rushed from Alwar and reached Delhi around midnight, hoping his daughter would be rescued safely from the debris. Her body was recovered hours later.

Ekta had returned to India after her five-year MBBS course and had been preparing for the Foreign Medical Graduate Examination (FMGE), the mandatory licensing test for foreign-trained doctors seeking to practise in the country.

Aditya Sharma (25), another student who was at the eatery when the building collapsed, was preparing for exams to get a job in the public sector. He managed to survive.

A graduate of Muzaffarnagar Institute of Technology, the engineer had been living at a PG for the last 10 months.

The phone of his brother Rajneesh Sharma — software developer working in Jaipur — rang at about 8.30 pm on Saturday. “Aditya is stuck. The building has collapsed,” said a man, claiming to be a friend of Aditya.

Rajneesh reached Delhi early Sunday, when he was told that Aditya has been shifted to AIIMS trauma centre. “He has a fracture on his thigh. I still think we are lucky. All the students who were brought to the hospital with him are still in the ICU,” said Rajneesh.

“We moved to cities for a better life. Is this the better life? A building, which just falls one fine day. Now, people are saying it was illegal,” he added.

that the overall performance reflected “a high failure percentage and poor achievement level”, which had “adversely affected the school result”.

The teacher was directed to explain the reasons for the poor performance. The notice also asked the teacher to submit details of “corrective measures”.

A memorandum issued to another lecturer described the examination outcome as “unsatisfactory and below the expected standard of the school”. It said that academic performance reflects the quality of “teaching, regular assessment, remedial measures, classroom management, and academic monitoring conducted by the subject teacher concerned”.

When contacted, the office of Education Minister Ashish Sood said no formal action has been taken against teachers by the

DoE. “The notices would have been issued by school principals in their individual capacity... It’s important that academic performance improves. The steps would have been taken in that direction only.”

Last week, the Government School Teachers’ Association (GSTA) approached Sood, saying teachers have been unfairly held responsible for a dip in results that coincided with the CBSE’s introduction of the On-Screen Marking (OSM) system.

In a letter dated May 29, the association alleged that “the primary reason behind the decline in results was the technical and procedural shortcomings of the OSM system implemented for the first time”. It said despite this, teachers were “directly held responsible” and issued show-cause notices and memorandums.

SHOOTING AFTER ALTERCATION IN AMAR COLONY

17-yr-old schoolboy dies four days after he was shot at, relatives want juvenile accused tried as an adult

Express News Service
New Delhi, June 1

FOUR DAYS after a 17-year-old boy was shot in the head outside an eatery in Delhi’s Amar Colony market while he was out with a friend, he succumbed to his injuries on Monday.

The Class 12 student, who had been on ventilator support since the May 27 shooting, died around 11.45 am, police said.

The family of the deceased, meanwhile, demanded that one of the accused, a 16-year-old boy who allegedly pulled the trigger, be tried as an adult.

The juvenile was apprehended on May 28 and an automatic pistol was recovered from his possession. Two other accused — Yash (18) and Jai Kumar (24) — were later arrested for the murder. One accused is still absconding, police said.

On May 27 evening, the Class 12 student had left home telling his parents he was going out for a snack with a female friend. Within hours, the family received a call informing them that he had been shot.

Police have said the dispute



The site where the boy was shot. FILE

began after the victim objected to the accused allegedly staring at the girl accompanying him, leading to a confrontation. The accused left and returned shortly with a firearm and shot the 17-year-old in his temple. “I appeal to the law enforcement agencies to kill the accused in an encounter just like my son was killed. He was not at fault, he stood up for the right thing. This can happen to anyone when they step out with their children, mother, sister or wife,” the boy’s father, who runs a laundry shop, said.

“...If they are old enough to

carry a gun and pull the trigger, they are also old enough to understand what they were doing,” he added.

The Delhi Police Crime Branch, which had taken over the investigation in the case, is now expected to add sections pertaining to murder in the FIR.

“It is not clear if the murder weapon belonged to whom. The accused and the victim did not know each other. The crime was carried out in a sudden fit of rage. There was an argument, the accused pulled out a weapon and fired two rounds at the victim,” an officer said.

Crisis worsens in Gulmohar Park, water contamination spreads across several lanes

Sophiya Mathew
New Delhi, June 1

MORE THAN a week after residents of South Delhi’s Gulmohar Park began complaining of foul-smelling and contaminated water supply in parts of the colony, the crisis has now spread across several lanes, with households reporting illness, hospitalisation and acute shortage of clean water, even as repair work by the Delhi Jal Board (DJB) continues.

Residents said many families have stopped using piped water and are now dependent on DJB and private tankers as well as packaged drinking water.

The latest crisis comes days after authorities inspected possible contamination points near Gate 2 and other parts of Gulmohar Park, developed in the early 1970s.

Local MLA Satish Upadhyay — also the DJB vice-chairman — had earlier told *The Indian Express* that possible contamination sources included illegal makeshift toilets set up behind some houses and an old pipeline near a drain close to Gate 2 that had not been properly sealed.

Officials said the DJB later shifted focus to one of the colony’s primary inlet zones. They added that excavation near an earlier cave-in site showed stagnant contaminated water, which could lead to sewage ingress into old pipelines through damaged joints and seepage points.

Prem Singh Dhingra (85), a resident, said he and his wife had both fallen ill. “The water was very dirty. But we had been using RO for years, so we continued using the water to brush our teeth and take bath... I developed diarrhoea and had to be hospitalised,” he said.

His 78-year-old wife, diagnosed with typhoid, is still in the hospital. “The water is still dirty and smelly. We are staying at our daughter’s place in Uday



(Top) Yellowish water supply received at a household; DJB workers at work. EXPRESS

Park till the situation is fixed at Gulmohar Park. So many of my neighbours and acquaintances are sick,” he said.

Another resident, Nitin Mantri, said the issue has affected many people in his household. “My mother has been unwell with diarrhoea. Our domestic help and my sister have also fallen sick,” he said.

Residents said the crisis, which began last month in parts of Gulmohar Park, has triggered a severe supply problem. Dr Savitri Singh, vice-president of the Residents Welfare Association (RWA), said the RWA has had to prepare a roster to regulate requests for tankers. “A family is getting tanker supply after a minimum of two

days since they requested for the same,” she said.

Singh also said that tanker access itself has become a challenge for several homes. “Those who have built tanks behind their homes cannot be reached by the DJB tanker hose. Some do not have underground tanks. Reaching terrace tanks are also an issue,” she said.

She said supply is being rationed, with around 1,000 litres being provided to one household. Also, only around 40 to 50 houses — Gulmohar Park has over 900 households — get water in a day.

“Everybody is buying Bisleri. Now, no nearby shop has it. I know somebody who even bathed using Bisleri water. Some families have started sending children to relatives’ homes,” Singh added. She maintained that at least 30-40% of the residents are sick. “In every house, somebody is sick.”

Residents said some homes are receiving no water at all, while others continue to receive contaminated supply. Households that were earlier getting clean water have now started reporting foul smell after DJB undertook repair and excavation work, they added.

“DJB officials have dug up roads in many places. The issue is shifting from one part of the colony to another. It is a total mess. It has been around 10 days at least and we are yet to receive a water testing report though samples have been taken from several places,” Singh said.

Subrat Birla, another resident, said residents were losing hope of an early resolution. “The DJB seems clueless about the source of contamination even after 10 days. Every second household has cases of diarrhoea or water-borne disease. Only two water tankers are serving over 900 households and even those are erratic,” he added.

SHOW-CAUSE NOTICES: TEACHERS GET SHOW-CAUSE NOTICES

Delhi govt school teachers face heat over poor scores

Sophiya Mathew
New Delhi, June 1

SHOW-CAUSE NOTICES issued to Delhi government school teachers to explain poor performance in their subjects following the CBSE Class 12 results are yet to be withdrawn, with teachers saying it will adversely affect their service record and annual appraisal.

The overall pass percentage of Delhi schools dropped to 91.97% from the previous year’s 95.18%, making it the lowest since 2019. Yet, it outperformed the national average of 85.2%.

Copies of notices seen by *The Indian Express*, issued by heads of schools part of the Directorate of Education (DoE), show that teachers were asked to explain subject-wise results.

One show-cause notice issued to a Political Science lec-

Post-result portal ‘inaccessible’

Vidheesha Kuntamalla
New Delhi, June 1

AMID COMPLAINTS over errors in this year’s Class 12 board results linked to CBSE’s On-Screen Marking (OSM), a digital evaluation system introduced for the first time this year, the Post-Result Activities portal — that was to become operational from Monday to address re-evaluation concerns — remained inaccessible throughout the day, claimed students and principals.

A CBSE official told *The Indian Express* that the technical

turer said that the result of students in the teacher’s subject

team was working to fix the website and oversee its rollout. “The portal will open soon. IIT Madras and IIT Kanpur teams are working closely with us to make the platform as robust as possible,” the official said.

Amid looming college admission and counselling deadlines, the delay in the re-evaluation has left students in lurch.

A principal of a private school in Southwest Delhi said students had been closely monitoring the portal since morning. “All my students were waiting for the portal to open. They are very worried.”

had been “considerably below the expected standard”. It added

FINANCIAL INCENTIVES TO WOO INVESTORS



CAPITAL AND TAX SUPPORT: Up to 30% capital subsidy, along with net state GST reimbursement to improve project viability.

INNOVATION BOOST: Research and Development (R&D) incentives of up to Rs 50 crore to promote innovation-led manufacturing and integration with global value chains.



CENTRAL SCHEME TOP-UPS: A 50% top-up on incentives received under Centre’s schemes, such as the Production Linked Incentive (PLI).

SUSTAINABILITY SUBSIDIES: Fiscal support for green manufacturing, including renewable energy adoption, zero liquid discharge systems, and carbon credit generation.



EXPORT RELIEF: Special one-time diversification support for export-oriented units affected by geopolitical disruptions.

SPEED AND TRUST: Addressing industry leaders, and foreign delegations, the CM emphasised that ease of doing business is no longer enough and insisted on the need of speed and trust.

and advanced manufacturing. New investments in “non-ToD” areas of Gurgaon, referring to non-transit oriented development zones, are in focus in the GCC & the Data Center Policies 2026 for the sectors related to emerging technologies, officials underlined. Demonstrating immediate industry backing, the state signed MoUs worth Rs 1.10 lakh crore on the very first day, which includes Rs 30,000 crore in Foreign Direct Investment (FDI).

From basic digitisation, the

state has transitioned to “intelligent governance”, the CM said. A revamped “Single Window 2.0” system — the Intelligent Investment Facilitation Portal — has been launched, which uses a “Smart AI Agent” for conversational, real-time troubleshooting, as per the policy.

The portal features an AI-enabled Investment Blueprint generator, allowing investors to calculate potential incentives and regulatory requirements, alongside a geographic information system based platform.



NO BIG SURPRISES AS SWAPAN DASGUPTA, ARJUN SINGH MAKE IT TO CABINET

Suvendu's Team 40: Veterans rub shoulders with freshers

Atri Mitra, Tanusree Bose & Sweety Kumari
Kolkata, June 1

THREE WEEKS after taking charge as the first BJP Chief Minister of West Bengal, Suvendu Adhikari on Monday expanded his Council of Ministers to 41 (including the CM), by inducting 35 new members. There were no big surprises as the party tried to balance regional, caste, and gender representation.

While veterans got the coveted seats in the Cabinet, many first-time MLAs like Kalita Majhi, who worked as house help, and 32-year-old Biraj Biswas were also inducted as Ministers of State.

Of the 35 new ministers sworn in by Governor R N Ravi at the Lok Bhavan, 13 were inducted as Cabinet Ministers, three as Ministers of State with Independent Charge, and 19 as Ministers of State.

The government can have three more ministers as the Constitution caps the size of the Council of Ministers to 15 per cent of the total strength of the Assembly – for West Bengal, with 294 seats, it is 44.

The 13 MLAs, who were sworn in as Cabinet Ministers on Monday, included Tapash Roy, Dipak Burman, Shankar Ghosh, Arjun Singh, Manoj Oraon, Gouri Shankar Ghosh, Jagan-



BJP MLAs Swapan Dasgupta, Sharadwat Mukherjee, Dudh Kumar Mondal and Arup Kumar Das take oath as Cabinet ministers in the West Bengal government on Monday. ANI

nath Chattopadhyay, Swapan Dasgupta, Kalyan Chakraborty, Anup Kumar Das, Ajay Kumar Poddar, Sharadwat Mukhopadhyay, and Dudh Kumar Mondal.

Nineteen were inducted as Ministers of State, including

Ashok Dinda, Umesh Roy, Koushik Chowdhury, Kalita Maji, Moumita Biswas Misra, Gargi Ghosh Das, Dipankar Jana, Purnima Chakraborty, Bishal Lama, Harikrishna Bera, Anandamoy Burman, Shantanu Pramanik, Biraj Biswas, Amiya Kisku, Juyel Murmu, Bhaskar Bhattacharya, Dibakar Gharami, Sumana Sarkar, and Nadhir Chand Bouri.

Malati Rava Roy, Indranil Khan, and Rajesh Mahato took oath as Ministers of State (Independent Charge).

Earlier on May 9, apart from

the CM, five other Cabinet Ministers were sworn-in, including Union Minister-turned-state leader Nisith Pramanik, Agni-mitra Paul, Dilip Ghosh, Ashok Kirtania, and Kshudiram Tudu.

With Monday's expansion, there are six women ministers among the 41, as opposed to nine women ministers in the previous TMC Cabinet.

As for the representation from various castes, the BJP government now has four tribal ministers and eight Scheduled Castes (SC) ministers.

There was also a clear imprint of the RSS in the new Cabinet with at least nine RSS-turned-BJP leaders like Tapas Roy, Dudh Kumar Mondal, Gouri Shankar Ghosh, and Dipak Barman, among others, getting inducted. The inductees

also represented the cross-section of West Bengal's society, with doctors, academics, journalists, and even those who worked in blue-collar jobs.

The BJP inducted Sharadwat Mukherjee, an oncologist who won from Bidhannagar, and Kalyan Chakraborty, a professor from Khardaha, as Cabinet ministers. Another oncologist from Behala Paschim, Indranil Khan, was sworn in as Minister of State (Independent Charge), while Kalita Majhi, who worked as a house help before foraging into politics, has been inducted as Minister of State.

Shankar Ghosh, the MLA from North Bengal who served as chief whip of the party in the previous Assembly, has been made Cabinet Minister.

Barrackpore strongman Arjun Singh, who began his political career with the Congress and hopped between TMC and BJP in the last decade, has been made a Cabinet Minister. Journalists-turned-politicians Swapan Dasgupta, who won the Rashbehari seat in south Kolkata, and Jagannath Chattopadhyay from Suri in Birbhum were also awarded Cabinet berths.

Till late Monday night, there was, however, no word on the portfolios of the new ministers.

Union Home Minister Amit Shah extended his wishes to the ministers who took their oath of office.

TMC expels 2 MLAs after CM says they complained of fake signatures

Atri Mitra
Kolkata, June 1

AMID THE ongoing CID probe into alleged forged signatures of TMC MLAs in a letter to the West Bengal Assembly Speaker, the party on Monday expelled two MLAs — Ritabrata Bandyopadhyay and Sandipan Saha — for anti-party activities.

The TMC announced its decision minutes after Chief Minister Suvendu Adhikari told mediapersons that the two TMC MLAs had filed complaints alleging the party forged signatures of its MLAs in a letter to the Speaker endorsing Sobhandeb Chattopadhyay as the Leader of Opposition.

Countering the Opposition's allegations of political vendetta as the CID summoned TMC general secretary Abhishek Banerjee in connection with the forged signature probe, the Chief Minister said his government was not seeking revenge against the TMC. "It may seem like vengeance to some, but we do not want to do any such thing since the party (TMC) is already defunct," Adhikari said.

"On May 20, the TMC national general secretary sent a copy of the resolution backing Shobondeb as LoP with the signatures of 70 MLAs, of which 14 names were in block letters," Adhikari said, holding that signatures "cannot be in block letters".

"Two TMC MLAs, Ritabrata Bandyopadhyay and Sandipan Saha, complained to the Speaker alleging no resolution was adopted regarding the selection



TMC chief and former West Bengal CM Mamata Banerjee addresses the media in Kolkata on Monday. She said she will go ahead with her sit-in on Tuesday, against the alleged attacks on TMC leaders and workers, despite the police denying permission for it. PTI

of the LoP on May 6," the CM said. Adhikari said the complaints alleged that the resolution dated May 6, 2026, was manufactured and fabricated. "On the direction of the Speaker, the principal secretary filed an FIR at Hare Street police station, and on the direction of the Home Secretary, with my approval as the state Home Minister, the investigation was handed over to the CID," the Chief Minister said.

Soon after, the TMC expelled the two MLAs and wrote a letter to Speaker Rathindra Bose communicating its decision.

Reacting to his expulsion, Saha, the MLA from Entally, said, "The party supports those who do unethical things. And it expels those who do ethical things. We did not even know that a signature in an attendance register would be passed off as a signature on a proposal."

Attacking the rebels, TMC

chief and former CM Mamata Banerjee said: "Someone who earlier was with CPI(M) (Bandyopadhyay) is doing it all. We gave him a ticket by depriving others. My apologies to those who were deprived. Our 2,500 party offices have been vandalised, our 10,000 workers have been arrested. Police are threatening MLAs, asking them not to step out of their homes. Police are asking MLAs to support a person who we have expelled (Bandyopadhyay) and break our party."

Incidentally, both Saha and Bandyopadhyay had asked the TMC leadership to expel Jahangir Khan after he withdrew his name from Falta repoll without consulting the party leadership.

A senior TMC MLA said, "We came to know these two MLAs were involved in propping up a rebel group of MLAs within the party. So, before they could organise such a group, the party decided to expel them."

Stint Stance

'COMPLETING 12 years of trust, development and public welfare' is the tagline of BJP's celebration of the third anniversary of the current Narendra Modi-led government. Party president Nitin Nabin has suggested media interactions at the Centre and state levels, and a special outreach campaign from June 8-14 during which tree-plantation and cleanliness drives, and public welfare camps will be organised. State units have been directed to talk about how Modi "will become the longest-serving continuously elected Prime Minister of the country" in the coming days. Although first Prime Minister Jawaharlal Nehru had held the office for 16 years and 286 days continuously, he was not an elected premier for the first over four-and-half years of his stint.

Cause & Effect

THE NTA chief, Higher Education Secretary, and Health Secretary on Monday appeared before the Parliamentary Standing Committee on Education, Women, Children, Youth and Sports, headed by Congress MP Digvijaya Singh, for the second time on the issue of the NEET-UG paper leak. While the officials did not present anything significantly new before the committee, one of the smaller revelations was that the government has refunded the examination fee to all candidates for the cancelled exam and will not charge for the June 21 paper — something that was already known. What was not known, however, was the financial impact of the decision. It was learnt that the government will forgo over Rs 300 crore on this account.

15 parties to attend INDIA bloc's Delhi meet on June 8

Asad Rehman
New Delhi, June 1

IN A first step towards recalibrating the INDIA bloc after the recent Assembly polls in five states, senior leaders of at least 15 parties will meet in New Delhi on June 8 (Monday) to chart out a plan for the Opposition bloc and ongoing political issues in the country.

Sources told *The Indian Express* that at least 15 Opposition parties will meet at the Constitution Club in the Capital. "Issues regarding the bloc's future and what is happening in the country will be discussed. Current issues like paper leaks, inflation, fuel prices and economic issues are likely to be discussed," said a senior Congress leader.

The Congress top leadership, including general secretary (organisation) KC Venugopal, has been reaching out to senior leaders from the Opposition camp to extend the invitation to parties for the meeting. A total of 15 parties, including the TMC, Samajwadi Party, Shiv Sena (UBT), Left parties are likely to be in attendance at the meeting, said sources.

The meeting will be crucial as questions have been raised regarding INDIA bloc's future after the recent Assembly elections, which saw the BJP defeat the TMC for the first time in West Bengal, the Congress leaving its long-term ally DMK to join hands with the TVK in Tamil Nadu and Congress-led UDF defeating the LDF in Kerala.

NFHS-5 FACTSHEET HAD 131 KEY INDICATORS; NFHS-6 HAS 101

Missing from NFHS: Key indicators linked to sex ratio, cancer screening

Nikhila Henry & Anonna Dutt
Hyderabad, New Delhi, June 1

SEVERAL DATA points from the fifth National Family Health Survey (NFHS) have been omitted from the NFHS-6 factsheet released on May 29, despite questions corresponding to these having been asked during the survey conducted between 2023 and 2024.

The omitted data points include several population-level statistics, indicators related to women's and children's health, family planning, and data on central government schemes such as the Swachh Bharat Abhiyan (sanitation) and the Ujjwala Yojana (cooking fuel).

Sources in the Union Ministry of Health and Family Welfare explained that several data points in the NFHS were being reported by other surveys, and the omissions were an attempt at "data harmonisation".

The NFHS is a large-scale household survey conducted across India to track vital data on health, family welfare, and nutrition. Indicators help policymakers evaluate and design effective public health programmes. The first such survey took place in 1992-93. It is conducted by the International Institute of Population Sciences (IIPS), under the supervision of the Ministry of Health and

Health Ministry rationale: Several data points in NFHS reported by other surveys, omissions an attempt at "data harmonisation"

Family Welfare.

The NFHS-5 (2019-21) factsheet had 131 key indicators or data points at the national level, while the NFHS-6 factsheet has 101.

Omissions include indicators of the population sex ratio, the sex ratio at birth, mortality rates, and the percentages of births and deaths recorded in the civil registration system. The latest factsheet also lacks indicators on access to sanitation facilities, such as toilets, and to clean cooking fuels. Several indicators for women's health were also removed, such as adolescent fertility rate, type of contraceptives being used, whether health workers had counselled women on family planning, and whether they were informed about the side effects of their chosen contraceptive method.

The factsheet also removed an indicator of women's access to healthcare services — the out-of-pocket expenditure for each delivery. Data on the reach of several health programmes were

also removed, including data on children with diarrhoea who received ORS or zinc, HIV awareness and service delivery, and the waist-to-hip ratio, an indicator of abdominal obesity linked to increased risk of diseases such as diabetes and hypertension.

The data points on screening for the three most common types of cancers — cervical, breast, and oral — were also removed. More than 1.5 lakh Ayushman Arogya Mandirs or primary health centres have been upgraded since 2018 to provide screening and care for non-communicable diseases, including the three cancers. However, the uptake of cancer screening services has been poor. NFHS-5 data showed that only 0.9% of people were screened for breast and oral cancers, and 1.9% for cervical cancer.

A Health Ministry source reasoned: "There were several parameters in the NFHS that were being reported by other surveys independently. So, these were removed from the NFHS factsheets in an attempt at data harmonisation between reports produced by the government."

Sources said several of these data points would be provided in other surveys. "Data on cooking fuel is provided in the report on the Ujjwala scheme, and data on sanitation services in the report on Swachh Bharat. When it comes to metrics such as in-

fant mortality, maternal mortality, registration of births and deaths — these are already provided in the Sample Registration Survey. In fact, the total fertility rate (the number of children women have in their lifetime), which is present in this data, is also present in the SRS report," a Health Ministry source said.

The source said data on cancer screening would also be provided by other surveys. The Indian Council of Medical Research usually provides data on cancer prevalence.

The Health Ministry had already announced that indicators about the prevalence and extent of anaemia, which were part of NFHS-5, would not be included in NFHS-6. This was dropped after experts said the current way of measuring it for the survey, using a drop of blood from a finger prick, could overestimate prevalence. A better way, the experts said, was to use venous blood samples. According to sources, data on anaemia using such a method would be reported by the "Diet and Biomarker" survey conducted by the National Institute of Nutrition. NFHS-5 data showed there was an increase in anaemia levels despite the government's 'Anaemia Mukht Bharat' programme that provided iron-folic acid tablets to girls and women to address iron-deficiency anaemia.

His growing responsibilities eventually saw him elevated as Kshetriya Sangathan Mantri, overseeing organisational work across UP, Uttarakhand and Bihar. A turning point in Tripathi's career came in 2002 when he was deputed from the RSS to the BJP and appointed general secretary (organisation) of the UP unit. The move coincided with a significant organisational restructuring within the party. Since the early 1990s, the BJP's organisational structure in UP had been divided into four regions, each headed by a separate general secretary (organisation). In 2002, the party restored a unified structure for the state.

Tripathi was entrusted with the responsibility of overseeing the BJP's organisational affairs across the entire UP, effectively becoming the sole general secretary (organisation) for the state. The position is considered one of the most influential organisational posts in the BJP, serving as the key link between the party and the RSS.

On January 8, following Nitin Nabin's elevation as the BJP's national working president, *The Indian Express* had reported that his incoming team would reflect more synergy and coordination between the party and the larger Sangh Parivar.

According to BJP leaders, Tripathi and a team of senior functionaries are expected to undertake extensive tours to maintain contact with veteran workers, address their grievances and ensure that their contribution to the organisation continues to be recognised. His appointment is also being viewed within the party as an effort to strengthen coordination between the BJP and the RSS while ensuring that experienced organisational hands remain closely connected to the Sangh Parivar's evolving structure.

Speaking to reporters, Amritsar Rural SP Aditya Warrier said they were conducting searches to nab those involved in the incident who took place on Sunday. He said Majithia was not present at his house when police reached there. Warrier said an FIR had been registered in connection with Sunday's incident. "We came here to arrest those who were named in the FIR," the officer said.

Separately, addressing a press conference, SSP Mir said Jobanpreet was arrested on Sunday morning. "He was in lawful custody and was being questioned. Meanwhile, an unlawful assembly gathered outside the police station. They overpowered our employees and gained forcible entry under a conspiracy with an aim to free Jobanpreet," Mir said. He said the entry of the crowd was unauthorised. "Majithia was part of this also and they started searching rooms of police stations without authorisation... They also reached the room where Jo-

banpreet was being questioned. Our employees resisted, but they did not pay heed to us and were brandishing weapons. Our case files kept there were also damaged by them," he said. After this, he said, Jobanpreet was forcibly taken out of that room even though he was in lawful police custody. "The SHO and DSP Majithia reached the spot to control the situation. But the unlawful assembly confronted them. The police officers tried to tell them Jobanpreet's formal arrest has been done. Despite that, attempt was made to take him out of police custody. Assault on police force took place and use of criminal force by the unlawful assembly was made to deter the public servants from discharge of their duty," the SSP said.

He said the police officials managed to take Jobanpreet back into their custody.

Police deployed outside Bikram Singh Majithia's home in Majithia on Monday. RANA SIMRANJIT SINGH



Police deployed outside Bikram Singh Majithia's home in Majithia on Monday. RANA SIMRANJIT SINGH

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BJP picks old RSS hand for outreach to 'neglected' elders

Jatin Anand & Shyamlal Yadav
New Delhi, June 1

SENIOR RSS functionary Nagendra Nath Tripathi, who was appointed on Monday as the BJP's national organiser for its newly created assignment of "outreach to senior karyakartas", has had an organisational career spanning nearly four decades across the RSS, ABVP and BJP.

BJP leaders say Tripathi's latest role draws upon his long organisational experience and extensive network among senior Sangh Parivar workers. The party's outreach initiative is aimed at identifying veteran karyakartas who have devoted decades to the organisation but may not currently occupy organisational or administrative positions, sources said.

"He (Tripathi) and several grassroots stalwarts like him have been associated with the

larger Sangh Parivar for decades, having given their whole lives to the ideology but, given the demands of their respective roles, relegated to the background," a source said.

BJP sources said the party leadership was of the opinion for a few years that because of its priorities of connecting more parties with the NDA fold and focussing on poll preparations, several of its core workers had been feeling "neglected". "It is for this reason that the party decided to deploy Tripathi," sources added.

Tripathi, 71, was until recently serving as Kshetriya Sangathan Mantri (regional organisation secretary) for Bihar and Jharkhand, based in Ranchi. His appointment to the new party role would lead to his base being shifted to Delhi as the BJP seeks to strengthen engagement with senior and long-serving workers of the Sangh Parivar.



Nagendra Nath Tripathi, 71, has had an organisational career spanning nearly four decades across the RSS, ABVP and BJP

Hailing from Uttar Pradesh's Sant Kabir Nagar district, Tripathi began his journey as an RSS pracharak. In 1988, while serving as Vibhag Pracharak in Azamgarh, he was deputed to the ABVP and assigned responsibilities in eastern UP. Over the following years, he worked in various organisational capacities and gradually emerged as one of the RSS's key organisational hands in the Hindi heartland.

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e-Tenders in two packet system are invited from bidders meeting qualifying requirements for the work of "Supply, Installation, Integration, Testing and Commissioning of Audio Video System in 500-Seater new Auditorium Building at Department of Science and Technology, Technology Bhawan, New Delhi-110016" on behalf of Department of Science and Technology.	
Estimated Cost of Work	Rs. 8,55,48,301/- (inclusive of GST)
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Row in Punjab after Congress supporter jailed over 'sacrilege' of AAP symbol

Express News Service
Jalandhar, June 1

A CONGRESS supporter has been sent to judicial custody after police in Punjab detained him for allegedly disrespecting the AAP election symbol, the broom, during municipal election celebrations. While no FIR has been registered in the matter, the Daily Diary Report (DDR) mentions the 'beadbi' (sacrilege) of broom, sparking a political furore in a state where 'beadbi' is a touchy word and is used mostly in connection with sacrilege of holy text.

The incident took place on May 29 in ward No. 1 of Tanda municipal council in Hoshiapur when Congress supporters were taking out a procession after their candidate defeated the AAP nominee. As the procession passed in front of the AAP candidate's residence, they allegedly "scattered a broom", following which local residents submitted a police complaint alleging that AAP's party symbol was insulted, threats issued, and provocative content circulated on social media. The next day, one Arshdeep was taken into custody, produced before the executive magistrate and subsequently sent to judicial custody.

The controversy intensified after the Congress shared a copy of the DDR on social media and accused the ruling AAP government of targeting opponents.

AAP MP Malvinder Singh Kang accepted that describing the alleged act as "beadbi" was inappropriate. "The officer who prepared the DDR should not have used the word 'beadbi' in reference to a political party's election symbol," he said.

Senior Congress leader and Gurdaspur MP Sukhjinder Singh Randhawa said that democracy and freedom of expression in Punjab appear to be under increasing threat.

Out on picnic, IAF sergeant drowns in canal

Pune: A serving IAF personnel posted with the National Defence Academy drowned in the Khadakwasla dam canal on Sunday.

Officials said that when the multi-agency search operation for him was underway, a woman who was drowning was rescued, officials said.

The deceased has been identified as Sergeant Rajesh Kumar Verma (35).

The incident took place on Sunday afternoon when the deceased had come to the Khadakwasla dam canal for an outing.

A press statement issued through Pune Defence Public Relations Officer read, "An incident of drowning of an air warrior of NDA occurred at Khadakwasla canal at around 12.30 pm on Sunday. At about 11.30 am Sergeant Rajesh Kumar Verma and some friends were on a picnic trip on the banks of the Khadakwasla canal outside the NDA Campus. Sergeant Verma accidentally slipped and fell into the canal and was swept away by the strong current." ENS

RIGHT TO BE FORGOTTEN

Do not index legal records online using names, rules Delhi High Court

Ability to seek erasure ensures informational self-determination remains effective, says court

Sohini Ghosh
New Delhi, June 1

EMPHASISING THAT a person being "involuntarily and perpetually" marked in the digital domain violates the right to informational privacy, the Delhi High Court has issued guidelines to search engine operators, such as Google, and legal database platforms to de-index name-based search functionality with respect to judgments, orders or news articles.

The guidelines were laid out in a 144-page verdict delivered on Friday, and made public on Sunday, by Justice Sachin Datta who was hearing a batch of over 38 petitions by individuals seeking removal of digital content involving them.

"The protection under right to informational privacy under

Article 21 (of the Constitution) is not merely against the disclosure of personal information but against an individual being involuntarily and perpetually defined in the digital domain, by such projection, and that too, regardless of the outcome of the underlying legal and judicial proceedings pertaining to such conduct," the court ruled.

While the court denied relief to public figures and individuals convicted of serious crimes, it upheld the right to be forgotten for individuals in matrimonial and private civil disputes, victims of sexual offences and those acquitted or discharged of crimes. As part of the relief, court records will be "de-indexed" and personal identifiers in such orders will be "masked" protecting their identity.

"No legitimate aim of suffi-

cient specificity is served by the unlimited and unrestricted name-based searchability of records whose underlying proceedings have been resolved, in favour of the concerned individual. Moreover, permanent and unlimited name-based digital searchability, is wholly disproportionate to any legitimate aim that might be identified," the court said.

De-indexing does not remove or delete a court judgment from public records. It prevents a person's name from appearing as a search result, making the judgment harder to find through a name-based internet search while keeping it accessible through case details or citations.

"No law authorises Google or any search engine to perpetually index and surface judicial records in a manner that overrides the individual's fundamental right to informational privacy," the High Court ruled.

Directing compliance with the direction within two weeks, the court directed legal database

platform Indian Kanoon to restrict name-based search functionality within its platform with respect to records of petitioners who were before the High Court, while making it clear that the "judgments and orders shall remain accessible on Indian Kanoon by case number, citation, Court details and date".

Justice Datta observed that the right to be forgotten reflects the evolution of privacy in response to the permanence of online information. "... In a society where digital records are virtually indelible, the ability to seek erasure ensures that informational self-determination remains effective. It protects individuals from perpetual exposure to past events that may no longer bear relevance, while preserving their dignity and autonomy in society," the court observed.

In the absence of a comprehensive statutory framework to govern the right to be forgotten, and while noting that court records are accessible otherwise,

the court held that "a private individual's name functions as a permanent and unlimited retrieval key through a commercial search engine, enabling any casual internet user to instantly access the entirety of an individual's engagement with legal/judicial processes..."

The court further said, "... It would be a perverse extension of the concept to hold that open justice facilitates Google (or any other search engine) to thrust an individual's arrest, accusation or legal misfortune in the face of every person who searches that individual's name, and to do so with particular force (to 'satisfy' a query), without regard to the context. An acquittal buried at the bottom of the 'search results', while the arrest dominates the search results, cannot be characterised as an ingredient of 'open justice'."

In 2026, the Supreme Court had stayed a similar order of the Delhi HC in which an accused in the AgustaWestland chopper scam case, who was eventually discharged, was granted relief.

A CASE OF LAXITY, PERVERSION AND BREACH OF PRIVACY

Hackers in hospital labour room: How Gujarat police bust a shocking 'cyberterror' operation

Eight men arrested for 'stealing videos' of women patients, selling them online

Brendan Dabhi
Ahmedabad, June 1

FEBRUARY 17, 2025, around 5 pm, a chilling video began circulating on social media. It showed a nurse administering an injection to a female patient at a private body part.

Police traced the video to a maternity hospital in Rajkot, about 220 km west of Ahmedabad. Over the next five months, they arrested eight men and booked them for cyberterrorism, a section usually applied in cases pertaining to national security and to protect critical assets from cyber attacks.

How did such a video end up online? Police began their probe at the hospital housed in a four-storey building. Couples sit in metal chairs in the waiting room, many with medical reports in their hands. A video playing on a screen shows "success stories" of couples leaving the hospital with newborns in their arms.

The hospital administrator recollected the shock of discovering the crime last year. "A reporter approached us and said footage of our hospital was being shown on the Internet. We were horrified..." "We immediately went to the police station. The Rajkot City police told us they were already aware and an FIR had been registered by the cybercrime branch in Ahmedabad. We had no facts, other than knowing that CCTV footage from our labour room was being sold online," he said.

But it wasn't just one video, and not just one hospital. Investigators soon found that several

CCTV clips from labour room were being sold on closed Telegram groups, with "trailer" clips advertised on YouTube for potential "buyers". Prices ranged from Rs 800 to Rs 2,000.

"The police were here for three-four days," the administrator said. "They interviewed staff, took our gadgets and spoke to patients... We cooperated, even went to Ahmedabad a couple of times as part of the probe. Eventually, they concluded that the CCTV system had been hacked from outside the hospital."

Arrests and uproar

On February 18, the Ahmedabad City Cybercrime Branch found videos on three YouTube channels. They wrote to Google seeking details of the channel operators, and following a prompt response, identified people based in Maharashtra and Uttar Pradesh.

At a press conference on February 19, Joint Police Commissioner, Ahmedabad City, Sharad Singhal, DCP (Cybercrime) Lavina Sinha and DCP (Crime) Ajit Rajian announced that three accused had been arrested — Prajwal Ashok Teli (23) from Latur, Praj Rajendra Patil (19) from Sangli, and Chandraprakash Phoolchand (33) from Prayagraj.

Singhal said the men used virtual numbers to communicate with hackers in Romania and Atlanta in the US. The police alleged that CCTV footage of several hospitals, malls and commercial buildings had been hacked. The accused allegedly clipped videos of women patients while they were being



Ahmedabad City Cybercrime Branch traced the stolen videos to YouTube channels and Telegram groups. EXPRESS PHOTO

examined, uploaded snippet-like teasers on YouTube, and offered them for sale.

"The phones of the arrested accused revealed contacts of the other accused persons. We also found videos, groups, and financial transactions on their devices," an investigator said.

The police unearthed 22 channels that were being run under a Telegram group, 'Megha Demos', where videos were categorised by titles such as voyeurism and exhibitionism. Police also found several other Telegram groups. While previews were shared on 'Demo Group', videos were sold on 'Premium Group', police officers said. They estimated that the accused may have earned more than Rs 8 lakh from the sale of these videos before the racket was busted.

On February 23, police arrested three more accused — Vaibhav Bhandu Mane (24) of Sangli, Parit Ghanshyam Dhameliya (36) of Surat, and Ryan Robin Pereira (20) of Vasai, Maharashtra.

On February 24, Gujarat Home Minister Harsh Sanghavi told the Assembly that two hackers had hacked more than 50,000 CCTVs in the last eight months, and that these videos

were from all across India — including from premises such as corporate offices, schools, colleges, movie theatres and personal videos of homes, apart from hospitals.

On February 26, Delhi resident Rohit Sanjaykumar Sisodia (27) was arrested. Police filed the first chargesheet against the seven on May 17 in Ahmedabad.

An eighth accused, Tushar Anil Santramsingh Bhatia (22) of Dehradun, Uttarakhand, was arrested on June 12 — the same day as the deadly Air India flight AI-171 crash. Police also recovered alleged bank statements and financial paper trails. A supplementary chargesheet was filed on September 12.

Legal provisions

Prajwal, Praj Patil and Chandraprakash were initially booked under Sections 66E (violation of privacy) and 67 (publication of obscene material) of the IT Act. However, these sections carry a maximum sentence of three-five years and fine, and there was fear that the accused could get bail easily since the quantum of sentence was less than seven years.

At a meeting in the cybercrime branch headquarters in

Shahibaug, officers debated how the legal knot around the accused could be tightened. One of the officers flagged Section 66F of the IT Act, sources said. On February 21, 2025, the IO sought the permission of the court to add Sections 61 (criminal conspiracy) and 77 (voyeurism) of the BNS and Sections 43(b) (digital extraction of data), 66 (hacking and data theft), and 66F(2) of the IT Act to the FIR. The last section deals with cyberterrorism and carries a maximum punishment of life imprisonment.

Clause (A) of Section 66F(2) applies when a person illegally accesses or attempts to access a computer system with the intention of threatening the country's unity, security, or to strike terror among the public. Clause (B) covers situations where investigators believe the stolen information can be used to harm national security, foreign relations, public order and morality.

Police have not included hospitals as accused, but officers acknowledged there were "oversights" on their part. They had not changed the default password of the CCTV cameras from "admin@123" after they were installed. And they sometimes failed to draw the privacy curtains in the labour room to shield the patient from the camera.

ACP Hardik Makadia of Ahmedabad City Cybercrime Branch told *The Indian Express*, "... They had no criminal intent. Staff forgot to draw the curtains sometimes... but we did not find their involvement..." The hospital administrator said CCTV cameras were necessary in labour rooms and OTs to protect doctors against possible "allegations". The hospital took patients' consent, he said, and "The government has not issued any guidelines."

• BRIEFLY



Bystanders gather around the statue after it was removed, in Lake Town area of Kolkata on Monday. PARTHA PAUL

WEST BENGAL

70-foot Messi statue removed in Kolkata over safety concerns

A 70-FOOT-TALL statue of Argentine football star Lionel Messi, which had become structurally unstable following recent storms, was removed from Lake Town in Kolkata on Monday. According to PWD officials, the statue was dismantled from its pedestal and loaded onto a truck using a hydraulic crane without any damage. The statue will remain in the PWD's custody, and there has been no official announcement regarding where it will be re-erected. Concerns regarding the statue's stability were first raised a few days ago when locals alerted the Lake Town police station that it was swaying during storms. PTI

3 killed while cleaning sewage tank in Punjab

THREE WORKERS, including a father-son duo, died while two others were taken ill after allegedly inhaling toxic fumes during sewage tank cleaning at a tool manufacturing unit in Ludhiana, police said. The incident occurred at M/S Deep's Tools where the workers had been called to clean sewage, a police officer said, adding it is being probed if there was any delay in taking victims to the hospital. According to police, the incident occurred around 2.30 am the intervening night of Sunday and Monday, but the factory management did not inform them till 10 am. ENS

Woman killed in celebratory firing in MP

A 32-YEAR-OLD woman was killed allegedly in celebratory firing during her son's birthday party in Gwalior on Sunday, police said on Monday. ASP Jayaraj Kuber said Manoj Kushwah's son was celebrating his birthday when Manoj's brother Yogesh allegedly started firing from a country-made pistol. A bullet allegedly struck Manoj's wife Jyoti in the head, killing her on the spot, the officer said. Kuber said the family allegedly tried to conceal the incident and Manoj arranged a deep freezer to keep the body. As police rushed to the spot, the family members fled, leaving the body behind. PTI

AASU leader's murder sparks outrage, accused shot dead in encounter

Sukrita Baruah
Guwahati, June 1

WITHIN 24 hours of a 20-year-old All Assam Students' Union member being killed and his 17-year-old cousin critically injured in an attack that has shaken Assam, the accused was killed in an encounter in Nalbari district Monday afternoon.

According to police, the deceased accused, a Muslim youth, was also likely a teenager but that details of his identity are yet to be ascertained. Nalbari SSP Bibekananda Das said that the family of the injured teenage girl have alleged that the accused had been trying to pursue her romantically. "The girl's mother has alleged that he would call her and message... but she had rejected him. She has alleged that he had threatened her because of this," said SSP Das.

The girl and her cousin, Madhuriya Barman, who was a district level office bearer for the AASU, had been travelling in a two-wheeler when they were assaulted on Sunday evening.

While Barman succumbed to his injuries, his cousin was sent to the hospital for treatment.

SSP Das said that Monday, they received information that the accused was hiding in a *char* (riverine island) area. "After our team apprehended him there, he was leading them to the machete used in the attack. At that time, he snatched an SLR rifle from one of the personnel and fired 4-5 rounds at the police team, in retaliation to which they too opened fire at him."

The attack on the cousins had triggered outrage in Nalbari, with the local AASU taking out a protest Monday. In the midst of the inflamed atmosphere, Nalbari MLA and cabinet minister in the last NDA government Jayanta Malla Baruah termed the assault "love jihad".

"Love jihad" is a chronic social challenge slowly spreading its roots in Assam... I appreciate the... action taken by Assam Police... Their prompt response sends a clear message that those who commit such crimes will not escape the law," he said.

{ SUMAN KALYANPUR • 1937-2026 }

'Na tum humein jaano...': The gentle voice with an uncanny resemblance to Lata's

Suanshu Khurana
New Delhi, June 1

THERE MAY BE no better endorsement for a woman playback singer than being mistaken for Lata Mangeshkar. There possibly cannot be a longer shadow to live under either. For most of her career, playback singer Suman Kalyanpur, 89, who passed away in Mumbai's Lokhandwala on the night of May 31, lugged both.

Kalyanpur had been unwell for a little over a month. She was cremated at 2 pm on June 1 in Mumbai's Santacruz on Monday with full state honours.

Whether it was the playful '*Na na karte pyar*' (*Jab Jab Phool Khile*, 1965), the longing in '*Ajhun na aaye baalmi*' (*Saanjh Aur Savera*, 1964), the soft ro-

mance of '*Na tum humein jaano*' (*Baat Ek Raat Ki*, 1962) or the exuberance of the utterly delightful '*Aajkal teremere pyar ke charche*' (*Brahmachari*, 1968), Kalyanpur came to be known as a singer without any excess, with a clear and delicate voice. Her vocal timbre combined two distinct qualities needed to sing for the leading lady of the time: a sweet tone that could hit the high notes without sounding shrill.

PM Narendra Modi wrote on X, "Anguished by the passing of the popular singer Suman Kalyanpur Ji. Her melodious voice and soulful renditions enriched our cultural world..."

Mangala Khadilkar, who wrote Kalyanpur's biography titled *Suman Sugandh*, said, "I am going to remember what a

gentle person Suman tai was. As for her voice, its sweetness touched one's heart instantly".

Back in the 1960s, Mumbai's remarkably prolific film music ecosystem was producing a huge number of songs, ones that would later go on to define the golden age of Hindi cinema. As for female playback singing, the space was dominated by the Mangeshkar sisters: Lata and Asha. Kalyanpur, with a remarkable control over pitch, somehow, naturally sounded like Lata.

So, when Lata was abroad or unavailable, or if the producers could not afford her rate of at least Rs 100 per song, Kalyanpur, 'the other Lata' as she was called then, was asked to come in to record. In fact, '*Na tum humein jaano*' was recorded with Ka-



Kalyanpur had been unwell for a little over a month

lyanpur because SD Burman famously stopped working with Mangeshkar for a few years. Kalyanpur also sang Mangeshkar's famed number '*Rahe na rahe hum*' (Mamta, 1966) in a duet with Rafi because the two famed artists were not speaking to

each other over royalty issues.

When Kalyanji Anandji's '*Na na karte pyar*', which would go on to become an Antakshari staple, hit the airwaves, many listeners were convinced that Mangeshkar had worked her magic again. The resemblance was so striking that when Door-darshan, in its famous show, Chhaya Geet, credited the song to Lata Mangeshkar and Mohammad Rafi, the attribution passed all checks without any notice. It took Kalyanpur's daughter Charul Hemmady to call up the Prasar Bharati office and request them to rectify the error. "No one believed me. It sounded like Lataji's," Charul had told *The Indian Express*.

Kalyanpur, who was a Noorjehan and Mangeshkar acolyte, spoke to this writer in a rare in-

terview about the comparison. "In my college days, I used to sing Lataji's songs. *Meri aawaaz nazuk aur patli thi* (My voice was fragile and thin). Also, when Radio Ceylon relayed the songs, the names were never announced. Even the records sometimes gave the wrong name. Maybe that caused more confusion... We were living in different times then," she said in 2016, a conversation that took months of convincing.

Growing up in a pre-Partition Mumbai, Kalyanpur was the eldest of five sisters. The girls, growing up in a conservative family, sang at home. She was still a teenager when she began singing at Ganapati Mahotsav. After listening to her, Pandit Keshav Rao Bhole, a family friend who worked with Prabhat Films,

trained her. She began at All India Radio in 1952, and that got Kalyanpur inside a recording studio and her first song in a Marathi film *Shukra Chi Chandni* (1953). Her first Hindi song was in Nisar Ahmed Ansari's *Mangu* (1954).

At 16, while studying at Sir J J School of Art, she sang at a college function where celebrated singer Talat Mahmood happened to be in the audience. Impressed, he helped connect her with HMV. Despite many from the industry calling her voice "amateurish", Kalyanpur bagged a song in *Darwaaza* (1954) and debuted alongside Mehmoond with the delicate and melodious '*Ekdil, dohain talab-gaar*'. This was followed by '*Na tum humein jaano*', '*Mere sang ga, gunguna*' (*Janwar*, 1965), and

very popular '*Tumne pukaara aur hum chale aaye*' (*Rajkumar*, 1964), among others.

Her last popular number in the industry was '*Behnae bhai ki kalai pe*' (*Resham Ki Dori*) in 1974. She also sang for composers Anu Malik and Bappi Lahiri in the '80s but bowed out of the industry in 1986, after singing for almost 100 films. Her final song, which was for *Love 86*, actor Govinda's debut, was never released. Laxmikant Pyarelal didn't use her version. They rerecorded it in Alka Yagnik's voice. In 1997, she got behind the microphone again to rerecord some of her older numbers in an HMV album. In her last years, however, Kalyanpur returned to another lifelong passion of painting and spent a lot of her time at the easel.

‘They poured hot water, chilli powder on him’: Third case of ‘custodial torture’ emerges in Odisha

Sujit Bisoyi
Bhubaneswar, June 1

The death of a person with disabilities has sparked allegations of custodial torture in Odisha’s Ganjam district, with his family alleging he was illegally detained, making it the third allegation of police excess in the state in the past week.

The family of 32-year-old Sushant Sahu from Subalaya village claimed he and another relative, Iswar, were picked up on May 25 over a dispute at a stone quarry where they worked. The family claimed Sahu was kept in police custody for a week.

Police said in a statement that the services of a trainee IPS officer, who was in charge of the Kabisuryanagar police station, have been “withdrawn”.

“While Iswar was formally arrested and produced in court, Sushant was illegally detained by the police and tortured to death. They poured hot water on him and used red chilli powder,” his wife Mamajini Sahu alleged. His family said Sahu was disabled in one leg.

Mamajini said the family received a call at 8.30 pm Sunday asking them to pick up her husband. By then, he was already in a serious condition, they claimed.

“When his father and brother objected to taking him home in that condition, the police threatened them and forced them to sign a blank paper. We called an ambulance and rushed my husband to the nearest hospital at Aska. As his condition was serious, doctors referred him to MKCG Medical College and Hospital, where he was declared dead at 1.30 am,” Mamajini said.

She claimed that her husband was healthy when he was picked up and questioned why he was detained when his name was not mentioned in the FIR.

Bal Gopal Behera, the medical officer at Aska, confirmed that Sahu was in a serious condition when he was brought to the hospital.

When contacted, Ganjam Superintendent of Police Harisha B C said that all allegations against the police would be independently investigated. “Appropriate action will be taken against those found guilty,” the SP told *The Indian Express*.

The director general of police (DGP) has also ordered the Human Rights Protection Cell (HRPC) of Odisha Police to probe the allegations of custodial torture and unnatural death.

Two other cases of alleged police excess have been reported in Odisha over the past week. A woman police inspector was suspended last week over allegations of custodial torture of a mother and son in Kendrapada district.

DEFENCE MINISTERS’ DIALOGUE

India, Australia agree to advance maritime awareness activities

Amrita Nayak Dutta
New Delhi, June 1

DEFENCE MINISTER Rajnath Singh and his Australian counterpart Richard Marles have agreed to advance collaborative maritime domain awareness activities using maritime patrol aircraft and to explore opportunities to enhance undersea domain awareness. The two leaders on Monday co-chaired the second edition of the India-Australia Defence Ministers’ Dialogue in New Delhi.

According to a joint statement issued by the two countries, the ministers welcomed the significant progress in bilateral relationship and reflected on the enhanced consultation and cooperation since the inaugural edition of the dialogue on October 9 last year.

The joint statement noted that the two sides discussed efforts to finalise the Joint Maritime Security Collaboration Roadmap.

“They agreed to progress the collaborative maritime domain awareness activities by maritime patrol aircraft and explore opportunities to enhance undersea domain awareness,” it said, adding that they also encouraged further cooperation between the Indian Coast Guard and Australia’s Maritime Border Command.

Marles also met External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar on Monday. After the Meet, Jaishankar posted on X: “A pleasure to meet Deputy Prime Minister & Defence Minister Richard Marles of Australia today. Shared assessments on regional developments, Indo Pacific and further advancement of our Comprehensive Strategic Partnership.”



Defence Minister Rajnath Singh with Australian Deputy PM and Defence Minister Richard Marles in New Delhi on Monday. PTI

Singh and Marles, during the meet, affirmed the importance of enhancing cooperation with regional partners to help maintain a free, open, peaceful, stable and prosperous Indo-Pacific.

“They underscored the importance of freedom of navigation and overflight, and their strong support for unimpeded trade in the region & other lawful uses of the sea consistent with international law, particularly the 1982 United Nations convention on the Law of the Sea (UNCLOS),” the statement noted.

The statement further said India and Australia, as co-leads of the Indian Ocean Rim Association Working Group on Maritime Safety and Security, look forward to jointly host a Search & Rescue and tabletop exercise at Maritime Rescue Coordination Centre, Chennai this month to strengthen maritime safety and security cooperation in the Indian Ocean Region.

“The two sides undertook to explore arrangements to enhance procedural interoperability for exercises and operations, building on the 2020 Mutual Logistics Support Arrangement,” it said, adding that they also agreed to continue aircraft deployment from each other’s territories to build operational familiarity. The ministers announced that India and Australia would begin developing a

E. EXPLAINED

Boost to bilateral ties

India-Australia relations gained significant momentum following PM Narendra Modi’s visit to Australia in 2014. The relationship has since produced several key security agreements, including the Comprehensive Strategic Partnership and the Mutual Logistics Support Agreement (MLSA).

Memorandum of Understanding regarding the Provision of Defence Articles and Defence Services as the next step in deepening defence industrial collaboration. The two sides agreed to explore further exchanges, including through the Joint Working Group on Defence Industry, Research and Materiel.

The Ministers are keen on exploring future defence science and technology research cooperation in new technology areas like sensor technologies,” the statement.

The Australian Deputy Prime Minister invited India to participate in the 2026 Australian Defence Science, Technology and Research Summit.

Both sides also discussed the growing engagement between their defence forces, including in the upcoming Exercise Talis-

man Sabre 2027, Australia’s participation in India’s Exercise Milan and Australia’s Exercise Kakadu in February and March this year.

“They looked forward to their countries’ participation in each other’s multinational air exercises in 2026, including operationalising the bilateral Implementing Arrangement on Air-to-Air Refuelling at Exercise Pitch Black,” the statement said. It added that the two sides noted with satisfaction the expansion of military cooperation into new areas.

“They welcomed the evolution of Army Exercise Australia this year to focus on amphibious combat and littoral manoeuvres. Australia welcomed India’s inaugural participation in Operation Render Safe 2026,” the statement said, adding that India welcomed Australia’s invitation for participation in submarine rescue exercise Black Carillon.

The Ministers welcomed increased information sharing between operational headquarters and said they are looking forward to the inaugural Joint Staff Talks later this year, the statement said. The two leaders encouraged their officials to finalise arrangements for the deployment of an Indian visiting instructor at the Australian Defence College in 2028-2029 to strengthen professional military engagement, knowledge exchange, and strategic alignment.

ASHA worker dies during childbirth in UP, doctor booked

Manish Sahu
Lucknow, June 1

A 34-YEAR-OLD ASHA worker died during childbirth at a private hospital in Uttar Pradesh’s Sonbhadra district, with her family alleging that the doctor and his team abandoned the woman in the operation theatre, with her stomach left unstitched after the C-section, and fled.

Police said they have booked Dr Naseem Ahmad, who allegedly performed the surgery, and members of his medical team, under BNS sections 105 (culpable homicide not amounting to murder) and 318 (cheating) at Kon police station. Police have also invoked Section 34 of National Medical Commission Act, 2019. Police said on Monday, a nurse, Salma, and a helper were arrested in connection with the case. Police have also announced a reward of Rs 25,000 for Naseem and Rs 10,000 for Salma, a nurse, an officer said.

Harsh Pandey, Circle Officer, Sonbhadra, said police teams are conducting raids to arrest the accused. He said the hospital has been sealed, adding that police are gathering records and other details about the facility from the health department.

According to police, the woman’s husband, Dev Narayan, alleged in his complaint that Seema went into labour on the night of May 29. Concerned about her condition, he rushed her to a government-run Primary Health Centre (PHC) but found no doctor on duty.

The only medical staff present was an Auxiliary Nurse Midwife (ANM), who examined Seema and administered some medicines. The ANM reportedly told the family that Seema’s condition was serious and a normal delivery appeared unlikely.

Narayan, in his complaint, said the ANM advised him to go to a private hospital in the Koria, claiming she knew the doctors there and better treatment could be arranged. She then called a government ambulance and referred the patient to the facility. The complainant alleged that when they reached the private hospital, he was alarmed by its condition as the infrastructure and medical arrangements appeared inadequate. Narayan claimed he expressed his concern to the hospital staff, but was ignored. Police said Narayan claimed Dr Naseem Ahmad and his team insisted on carrying out the procedure and took his wife into the OT, where they performed a C-section and a baby boy was delivered. The husband further claimed Seema’s condition rapidly deteriorated but the doctor failed to provide post-operative care. “Dr Naseem and his team abandoned her, leaving her abdomen unstitched, and fled. As a result, my wife died,” he alleged in the complaint.

Speaking to *The Indian Express*, Narayan, a farmer, claimed only three people were present at the hospital — a man who identified himself as a doctor and two women who said they were nurses.

J&K L-G’s anti-drug drive gets unlikely ally — Jamaat splinter group JDF

Bashaarat Masood
Srinagar, June 1

AS JAMMU and Kashmir Lt Governor Manoj Sinha led a ‘Nasha Mukht (Drug-free) J&K’ march in south Kashmir’s Kulgam on Monday morning, it received support from an unlikely quarter, the Justice and Development Front (JDF) — a splinter group of the banned Jamaat-e-Islami.

On Monday, JDF members, including general secretary Sayar Ahmad Reshi, walked shoulder to shoulder with the Lt Governor at Kulgam.

While a large number of government employees, school children and village residents participated in the rally, the presence of the JDF leadership and workers was significant.

The JDF, a political organisation, is a splinter group of the banned Jamaat-e-Islami that was born out of the panel formed by the party to engage in talks with the Centre and to devise a strategy for lifting the ban on Jamaat.



Jammu and Kashmir Lt Governor Manoj Sinha takes part in the ‘Drug-Free J&K’ padyatra in Kulgam on Monday. ANI

However, in the 2024 Assembly elections, the panel decided to jump into the electoral fray and fielded 10 candidates as Independents. But after the panel formally announced the formation of the JDF as a “political wing” of Jamaat-e-Islami, most of the top Jamaat leaders distanced themselves from it. “JDF remains committed to building a healthier and safer society and calls upon all sections of the community to join this movement,” the

group said on Monday after attending Sinha’s padyatra.

“Thousands of workers, members and supporters of the Justice and Development front participated in the ongoing Nasha Mukht Abhiyan at Kulgam, an initiative organised under the guidance of Lieutenant Governor of Jammu and Kashmir, Manoj Sinha ji... The campaign aims to eliminate the growing menace of drugs from society and advocate for a Jammu and Kashmir free from

all forms of intoxication,” the statement said.

The party has called for a ban on the sale and consumption of alcohol as well. “The party believes that the true freedom from addiction requires addressing not only narcotics but also alcohol, which has devastating social and health consequences,” it said.

The JDF workers at the drug-free rally were led by the party general secretary Sayar Ahmad Reshi, Kulgam district patron Mohammad Yousuf Rather and district president Bilal Ahmad Mir.

Reshi, a resident of Kulgam, contested the 2024 Assembly elections against Communist leader M Y Tarigami. Though he lost the election by around 8,000 votes, he was the only JDF candidate who not only managed to save his deposit but also secured over 25,000 votes. Over the last few days, the JDF published online posters welcoming Lt Governor Sinha and asked the people of Kulgam to join the event.

Rank wasn’t my focus: Pune’s Arohi tops JEE (Advanced) among girls

Soham Shah
Pune, June 1

AROHI DESHPANDE from Pune emerged the topper among female candidates in the Joint Entrance Examination (Advanced), results of which were announced on Monday.

Arohi, who secured an All India Rank of 77, said that the JEE (Advanced) is an emotional journey and it is difficult to stay on path.

She told *The Indian Express*, “JEE is not just about studying. It’s also a mental and emotional journey. It’s difficult to keep on that path, constantly studying and doing your work diligently. You will face a lot of downs. But you don’t have to feel bad or let it affect you. Many times I got low marks in practice tests, but I used them as learning opportunities.”

A big factor of support for Arohi was that her parents shifted from Pune to the coaching hub city of Kota with her after class 9, where she studied at the ALLEN Career Institute. Her father Prasad Deshpande is



Arohi Deshpande secured AIR 77

an IT professional and her mother Amita Deshpande is an environmental engineer, and both were able to work from home to be with their daughter.

Arohi says, “Having your family with you makes it a very familiar environment. You don’t actually feel like you are somewhere else. You are just home and you are studying. I respect my friends who stay alone here for being with themselves for like 2, 3 years. Because for me, it feels difficult to even think about that.” “My focus was never to bring a specific rank. It was always to give my best performance on that day. So, whatever

rank I was going to get, I was going to be happy with it,” she said. Her goal was always to crack JEE Advanced and therefore she never prepared separately for JEE Mains. Apart from studies, Arohi likes to paint, read, and listen to music.

Earlier in JEE Mains, Arohi achieved 99.996 percentile. She also scored 96.7% in class 10 and 97.8% in the class 12 board examinations. She intends to choose the B.Tech Computer Science branch at IIT Bombay. Her family has now shifted to Hyderabad. Out of the 1,79,694 who appeared for the JEE Advanced on May 17, 56,880 candidates qualified the examination. A total of 10,107 of the qualified candidates are females. Zone-wise top female candidates are: IIT Bombay — Sanvi Patidar (Rank 158), IIT Delhi Arohi Deshpande (77), IIT Guwahati — Agrima Singh (857), IIT Kanpur — Anushka Agrawal (859), IIT Bhubaneswar — Reddi Sai Sahithi (230), IIT Madras — Korukonda Sravya (111), and IIT Roorkee — Aashi (781).

[FROM PAGE 1]

For 2 yrs, rape convict Asaram kept getting bail, citing failing health — until HC drew the line

minor’s rape case, cancelled his bail, and directed him to surrender, observing that his frail health “cannot justify ignoring the victim’s voice. Quiet. Devastating. Irrefutable.”

Strong words, not without reason. When Asaram surrendered on May 28, he had been out on interim bail for seven months. Before that stretch, he had spent long periods in various hospitals since March 2024. Taken together, records show, Asaram received court-sanctioned medical relief more than a dozen times between March 21, 2024, and May 25, 2026.

Medical plea

In January 2024, going into Asaram’s medical history before declining his fourth suspension of sentence application for bail, the Rajasthan High Court said that while ordinarily, a convict who has undergone a sentence of 10 years or more can get bail, “In the present case, the allegation against the appellant is... that he sexually assaulted a minor disciple... Apart from that, the appellant has also been convicted by a criminal court in (the) State of Gujarat in a rape case. Looking (at) the above facts... his sentence is not liable to be suspended.”

Asaram’s lawyers then moved another petition seeking permission for a “bypass surgery/angioplasty”. In February 2024, the court rejected the hospitals listed by Asaram as prefer-

ence, and suggested that he take treatment at AIIMS, New Delhi, as recommended by AIIMS, Jodhpur.

In March 2024, Asaram’s lawyers told the Rajasthan HC that he is “willing to undergo his treatment at Madhavbaug Multidisciplinary Cardiac Care Clinics and Hospitals, Khopoli, Maharashtra, under police custody and is prepared to bear all the expenses that may be incurred in providing police aid...”

The court noted that Asaram has co-morbidity (heart ailment and chronic kidney disease) and has been hospitalised two-three times. Listing his history of ailments, Madhavbaug hospital told the court that Asaram “seems to be in critical condition”.

However, a report by the Raigad District Superintendent of Police, under whose jurisdiction Madhavbaug fell, said it was not safe to shift Asaram there “in view of security and law and order”.

Finally, on March 21, 2024, the HC cited Asaram’s age and noting that “the right to get appropriate treatment is his fundamental right”, allowed him to be taken to the Arogyadham Ayurvedic Centre in Jodhpur in police custody, while permitting doctors from Madhavbaug to supervise his treatment here. One of the conditions was that Asaram bear the cost of his own security.

Asaram was in hospital for a

week, from March 25, 2024, until April 2. Then again, on April 16, the HC allowed him to get admitted at the Jodhpur centre for “7-10 days”, after Asaram’s lawyers said his health had improved after the first stay.

On July 26, following a plea by his lawyers, the HC removed the condition that he pay for his security — “considering that providing security to the applicant and other citizens is otherwise a responsibility of the State”.

On August 13, Asaram got another relief, with the HC granting him “emergent parole” for seven days so that he could this time get treatment at Madhavbaug hospital in Maharashtra. The court cited Asaram’s age, “prolonged actual custody”, “recommendations made in the reports of AIIMS, Jodhpur”, and “recommendations made by the seven-member Medical Board Committee to the convict to undergo Coronary Artery Bypass Grafting (CABG)”, among other things.

On September 3, the HC extended Asaram’s emergent parole by five days, commencing the same day.

On November 7, 2024, the court eased the conditions of Asaram’s bail, and modifying its April 16 order, said he could stay at Arogyadham, Jodhpur, for a “period deemed appropriate” by hospital authorities, subject to a maximum period of 30 days at a stretch, “whereafter he shall

again be lodged in the jail”.

Just when the month had got over, on December 10, the HC allowed Asaram to take medical treatment at Madhavbaug hospital, under police custody, for 17 days. The court said Asaram need not be brought back to jail in the interim.

Supreme Court relief

On January 7, 2025, Asaram got relief from the Supreme Court, which granted him interim bail till March 31 for his medical treatment, stating that “we are not inclined to go into the merits of the case... we have no hesitation in holding that the petitioner does require interim bail on medical ground.”

Subsequently, the Rajasthan HC too gave him bail on January 14, till the same date, March 31, 2025.

The Gujarat HC followed suit. It first gave Asaram bail till June 30, 2025, and on April 7, extended it till July 1.

Arguing against his bail in the Rajasthan HC, the complainant’s counsel P C Solanki had said Asaram “is misusing the liberty which was granted to him by this Court and he is not only meeting disciples but also giving sermons”.

However, Additional Advocate General Deepak Choudhary pointed to the testimony of two constables, who had been with Asaram throughout his interim bail, that the self-styled godman “had not given any sermon”.

The HC then said: “We find that there are stray instances of certain disciples meeting the applicant, but the same... cannot be taken to be a breach (of the Supreme Court bail).” The HC also considered an affidavit by Asaram, where “he clearly asserted that neither any organized speech/sermon was given nor had he met with disciples in groups”.

After the Gujarat HC extended Asaram’s interim bail, the Rajasthan HC, on April 7, 2025, too extended his bail till July 1, 2025. Then, as Gujarat HC extended Asaram’s bail till July 7, Rajasthan HC too extended it till July 9, 2025.

On July 8, the Rajasthan HC issued yet another order, extending Asaram’s bail till August 12, while observing that “no further indulgence shall be granted to the applicant”.

However, on August 11, after Asaram’s lawyers submitted that the Gujarat HC had extended his interim bail up to August 21, the Rajasthan HC extended his bail till August 29.

A medical certificate submitted by Jodhpur’s Arogyam Ayurvedic Hospital to the court on October 13, 2025, stated that Asaram is suffering from multiple serious illnesses: heart disease, kidney disease, severe bone thinning with high risk of fractures (osteoporosis), muscle loss leading to difficulty in performing day-to-day activities (sarcopenia), and recurrent gas-

trointestinal bleeding, loss of control over bladder and bowel... He is frail and wheelchair-bound, needing assistance for feeding, toileting, and daily care.”

The HC held that the State shall have to ensure that Asaram “remains in Arogyam Hospital, where he is presently admitted, subject of course to unavoidable circumstances, such as emergency or deterioration of his health conditions”.

Fifteen days later, while Asaram was admitted at Arogyam Hospital, the Rajasthan HC released Asaram on interim bail for six months.

The HC noted that Asaram had served 12 years, 11 months and 27 days of his sentence, including remission — the actual custody period hence being “11 years, 6 months and 3 days” — and that at 86 years of age, he was suffering from several ailments and was “in a vegetative condition”.

As per Rajasthan Prison Rules, remission is “reduction in sentence granted as a reward for good conduct and behaviour in prison, as well as for labour special contributions and cooperation of the prisoner”. The different kinds of remissions include “ordinary”, “special” and “by the state government”, with different rules for different prisoner categories, including those serving life terms.

Two months after Asaram got bail, the complainant in the

case against him moved the Supreme Court, saying that apart from receiving medical treatment while out on bail, Asaram had been touring various cities and giving “pravachan (sermons)”. In videos on social media, a wheel-chair bound Asaram has been seen in the past few months at pilgrimage cities such as Ujjain and Ayodhya, apart from on multiple visits to Gujarat.

Advocate Shobha Gupta, representing the complainant, said Asaram had violated his bail conditions — which forbid him from meeting his followers in a group — by participating in public events, and that his health condition was not so severe as to justify continued medical bail. She also questioned the Rajasthan HC’s decision to grant bail despite the gravity of the offences against Asaram.

In a subsequent suspension of sentence application, Asaram’s lawyers, led by Devdatt Kamat, told the court that it may take time to pronounce the judgement in his appeal against his 2018 conviction and that the interim bail be allowed to be continued.

Subsequently, on April 29, 2026, the HC granted him bail till May 25, or up to the date the judgement is delivered in his appeal, whichever is earlier; on May 25, this was extended till July 7.

In the meantime, on May 27, 2026, the Rajasthan HC pro-

nounced its judgement on Asaram’s plea. Upholding Asaram’s life term in the minor’s rape case, the court said: “The appellant was 73 at the time. He is now 86. He thus stands before us bent by age and burdened by ailment, imploring a fresh look at his plea for leniency. We have considered his plea and applied our mind. We are unable to grant any indulgence, since in the shadow of his frailty cannot justify ignoring the victim’s voice. Quiet. Devastating. Irrefutable. To ignore it would be to shake society’s faith in the criminal justice system, and send wrong a message no court must ever send, least of all when the perpetrator hid behind the cloak of a self-styled godman.”

Asaram’s lawyer Nishant Bora said that they will file a Special Leave Petition in the Supreme Court soon. On Asaram’s health, Bora said: “He is not doing very well, there has been no improvement in his condition.” On allegations that Asaram was violating bail conditions by giving sermons, Bora said the HC had said Asaram could not meet people in groups, and that he was only meeting two-four persons at a time.

The victim’s lawyer, Solanki, said the sentencing of Asaram — “with life imprisonment which shall be for the remainder of his natural life” — was a big victory for justice and that the fact that Asaram was now back in jail proved their case, he said.

Karnataka CM-designate D K Shivakumar gets 2-yr foreign travel relief in 2018-I-T case

Bengaluru: A special court recently granted Karnataka Chief Minister-designate and state Congress chief D K Shivakumar an extended exemption for two years from legal curbs imposed on him in 2018 from leaving the country without court clearances in connection with an income tax evasion case. Shivakumar, set to take oath as Karnataka CM on June 3, is currently facing trial in a Rs 8.59-crore income tax evasion case and was granted bail by a special court in Bengaluru in 2018, on the condition that he cannot leave India without court permission. **ENS**

Court allows CBI to arrest Anil Ambani's ex-aide Jhunjhunwala

Express News Service
Mumbai, June 1

THE SPECIAL Court on Monday allowed the CBI to formally arrest Amitabh Jhunjhunwala, a former top executive of the Reliance-ADAG group, in connection with a probe into a bank loan fraud case.

A Delhi court last week had allowed the CBI to produce Jhunjhunwala before the Mumbai court. A transit production warrant had already been issued by the court and on Monday, he was produced by Tihar Jail officials before the special court in Mumbai.

Jhunjhunwala, the former vice-chairman of Reliance Capital, was earlier arrested by the Enforcement Directorate in connection with an alleged multi-crore financial fraud involving siphoning of funds through group entities controlled by industrialist Anil Ambani.

The CBI had alleged that on Jhunjhunwala's directions, loan funds were misused, causing wrongful loss to the banks. The CBI has not named him in the charge-sheet in the case related to the alleged misuse of a nearly Rs 2,000 Crore worth term loan and letters of credit sanctioned by three banks. However, it said the probe against Jhunjhunwala

was ongoing. The special court designated under the CBI Act, presided over by Judge JP Dandekar, noted that Jhunjhunwala has "no complaints of ill treatment" by the producing Tihar jail authority or the CBI.

His advocates, Reeti Upadhyay and Mudit Jain, argued that as per the production warrant, he was required to be produced on June 5 and his appearance prior to that was illegal.

"After hearing both sides, the application is allowed and the CBI is permitted to arrest the accused formally" as per provisions of law, the special judge noted on Monday evening.

As the proceedings continued beyond court working hours, the CBI lawyer said that the arrest procedure would take time and that he would be produced on Tuesday after completing formalities. The court said that in the meantime, he can be sent to judicial custody at Arthur Road Jail in Mumbai.

"This is a peculiar situation as the accused is produced from a far distance, i.e., from Central Prison No. 07, Tihar, New Delhi. Further, there are medical issues concerning the accused. Considering all these facts and circumstances, accused Amitabh Jhunjhunwala is taken into judicial custody," the court noted.

‘Comprehensive appraisal done’: Minister defends Great Nicobar project in response to Jairam letter

Nikhil Ghanekar
New Delhi, June 1

UNION ENVIRONMENT Minister Bhupender Yadav has rejected allegations made by Congress MP Jairam Ramesh that the statutory environmental clearances granted to the Great Nicobar Islands (GNI) project were based on studies that relied on inadequate baseline data.

In a written response to the Congress MP's May 10 letter, he asserted that concerns raised on environmental impact assessment, biodiversity impacts have 'already been examined in detail during the statutory appraisal and subsequent judicially mandated review process'. In his May 27 letter to Jairam, Yadav said that environmental appraisal of the project was undertaken in a 'comprehensive and multi-tiered manner in accordance with the EIA (Environment Impact Assessment) Notification, 2006, the Island Coastal Regulation Zone Notification (ICRZ), 2019 and other applicable provisions.

The GNI project will be spread over 166 sq km and include a transshipment container port, an international military-civilian use airport, power infrastructure and a



Union Environment Minister Bhupender Yadav. FILE

greenfield coastal city. It will require felling of 13,000 hectares of pristine forest on the ecologically sensitive islands.

Ramesh had called the studies considered during the project's appraisal as a mockery of the EIA process and an insult to science, while responding to a detailed FAQ and statement issued by the Environment Ministry on May 1. He had also urged the government to make public the report of the NGT-mandated High-Powered Committee, tasked with revisiting the project's environmental clearances.

On the multi-season EIA studies, the Minister stated that while primary field data was collected over a single seasonal cycle, the analysis was integrated with long-term historical datasets maintained by reputed institutions including the Zoological Survey of India, the Botanical Survey of India, the Salim Ali Centre for Ornithology and Natural History, and the Wildlife Institute of India, all of which, he said, possess decades of ecological research experience in the Andaman and Nicobar Islands. In his May 10 letter, Ramesh

had alleged that the project's environmental and coastal regulation zone clearance was granted on the basis of baseline studies done contrary to requirements of the ICRZ notification and the EIA manual for ports and harbours.

On the allegation that norms were not followed in carrying out comprehensive studies for low or medium eroding stretches, including Galathea Bay where a transshipment port is planned, Yadav said this requirement was not attracted as Galathea's eastern flank is stable. "The shoreline change assessment carried out by NCSCM using six time-series satellite datasets over a 17-year period concluded that the eastern flank of Galathea Bay, where the proposed port is located, is predominantly stable to moderately accreting due to offshore sheet rock formations and favourable sediment deposition patterns," he said.

He also sought to point out that the environmental studies and baseline data issues were also examined by the NGT in its February 16 judgment.

On the confidentiality of the HPC report, a key appeal in Ramesh's letter, Yadav maintained that the report contains information of strategic, defence and national importance, and that certain details were therefore exempt under Section 8(1)(a) of the RTI Act 2005.

On biodiversity, Yadav said the project had been examined in detail for its impact on corals, leatherback turtles, megapodes, shoreline stability, marine ecology and tribal welfare by expert institutions, the EAC and HPC.

Ladakh eases excise policy rules, expands liquor sales to boost tourism

Naveed Iqbal
Srinagar, June 1

IN AN overhaul of its excise regime, the Ladakh administration has approved a liberalised liquor policy allowing retail sale of hard liquor and expanding liquor outlets in the region from 2 to 20. Lieutenant Governor V J Saxena approved the policy stating the reforms are intended to reduce dependence on narcotic substances, strengthen regulation and support tourism-led economic activity.

The LG has argued that the policy primarily aims at curbing the growing dependence on narcotics and drugs and giving people, "a wider choice of low-alcoholic content liquor" in the Ladakh region. The policy also seeks to optimise excise revenue in a transparent, accountable and regulated manner.

The Ladakh administration has also argued that the existing "restrictive regime", which had resulted in limited availability of brands and outlets, created an "artificial scarcity" that often deterred the tourists visiting Ladakh. This, the administration says, often prompted tourists to carry liquor with them, from outside the Ladakh region, also causing revenue loss to the UT.

Highlighting the new policy as a "significant reform" in the excise regime of the UT, the administration has stated that the new policy comes after extensive meetings with civil society organisations, NGOs, religious organisations, public representatives and government officials, in recent months.



DISTRICT POLICE HEADQUARTERS
KATHUA
E- mail: sspkathua@jkpolice.gov.in Fax/Phone No.: 01922-234010

LOOK OUT NOTICE

On 17-05-2026, one Balbir Chand S/O Hari Ram R/O Ward No. 13 Kainthan Tehsil Dasuya District Hoshiyarpur Punjab lodged a written report at P/S Lakhampur stating therein that his son namely Rajan Sindhu, age 32 years went missing from Venky India Limited at Maroli Kathua on 13-05-2026. The complainant tried his best to search his son but all in vain. On this, missing report vide DD No. 20 dated 13-05-2026 has been entered at Police Station Lakhampur. During the course of investigation, best efforts were made to locate missing individual, whereas he is still un-traced.

As such Description Roll/Photograph of said missing individual is being shared with the appeal that anybody having clue/information about his whereabouts may inform us accordingly. The informer will be rewarded suitably:-

DESCRIPTION ROLL	PHOTOGRAPH
Name Rajan Sindhu Father Balbir Chand Permanent Address Ward No. 13 Kainthan Present Address A/P Maroli Kathua Tehsil Dasuya District Hoshiyarpur, Punjab Police Station Lakhampur Age 32 years Height 05 feet 6 Inch Complexion Wheatish Built Normal Face Oval Eyes Black Languages known Hindi/ Punjabi	

Any information related to the whereabouts of the subject may be communicated on following contacts:-
1. DPO Kathua- 01922-234010 (Phone/Fax)
2. dpo.kathua@jkpolice.gov.in (Mail ID)
3. PCR Kathua- 01922-234311 (Phone/Fax)
4. Police Station Lakhampur – 9103007518

Sd/-
Sr. Superintendent of Police,
Kathua.

DIP/J-2962/26, Date 1 June 2026



उत्तर प्रदेश पावर ट्रान्समिशन कार्पोरेशन लिमिटेड,
कार्यालय मुख्य अभियन्ता (पा०द०प०), आगरा, जैम बिड संख्या एवं कार्य का सक्षिप्त विवरण, 1. जैम बिड संख्या- Gem/2026/B/7598447 - Work of Supply, Retrofitting, Testing & Commissioning of Different Relays at Various Substations under ETD Mathura/ETC Mathura धरोहर राशि ₹ 38,500.00 मात्र। निविदा जैम पोर्टल पर स्वीकार करने की अन्तिम तिथि एवं समय-24.06.2026 समय 12:00 बजे तक। 2. जैम बिड संख्या- Gem/2026/B/7601828 Installation and Supply Of Battery Set(Exide make) 110V 200AH, 300AH, 48V200AH & 48V300 AH Tubular Lead Acid Type OPzS with Standard Accessories (each of 02 Volt) for various Sub-Stations Under Transmission South West Zone Agra धरोहर राशि ₹ 81,000.00 मात्र। निविदा जैम पोर्टल पर स्वीकार करने की अन्तिम तिथि एवं समय-24.06.2026 समय 12:00 बजे तक। विस्तृत जानकारी एवं प्रपत्र जैम पोर्टल पर उपलब्ध है। अग्रेष्ठ समस्त सूचनाएं जैम पोर्टल पर ही प्रदर्शित की जायेगी। हस्ता./- (शैलेश गुप्ता) मुख्य अभियन्ता (पा०द०प०), पत्रांक: 1569/मु०अभि०(पा०द०प०) आ०/जैम निविदा, दिनांक: 01/06/2026



CENTRAL RAILWAY
OPEN TENDER NOTICE

Divisional Railway Manager (S&T), 1st Floor, Parcel Office Building, Near P.F. No. 13, Central Railway, Mumbai CSMT 400 001, for and on behalf of the President of India Invites E-Tender (Open tender) from the reputed contractors. The last date and time for submission of tender is 30/06/2026 till 15.00 Hrs. **SN:- 1. Tender Notice no:- CR-BB-TELE-2026-27. Name of work:-** "Supply, installation, Testing and commissioning of various network equipments to provide data connectivity and provision of other telecom assets at various locations/offices/buildings in Mumbai division." **Approximate Cost (in Rs.):** 18804716.85/-, **EMD (in Rs.):** 376100.00/-, **Date & Time of Closing:-** 15:00 Hrs. on 30/06/2026, **Validity:-** 60 days, **Completion Period:-** 12 Months, Complete details of tenders with corrigendum are available at Indian Railway official website www.ireps.gov.in. The complete tender documents can be downloaded from the website. The complete details of tenders are also available in the "Notice Board" of the Divisional Railway Manager (S&T)'s Office, Mumbai CSMT. **This tender complies with Public Procurement Policy Order 2017 dated 15.06.2017** **210**

Unsafe and unauthorized work near the railway line is a punishable offence



GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA
OFFICE OF THE CHIEF CONSTRUCTION ENGINEER, RURAL WORKS CIRCLE, SAMBALPUR.
E-mail Id:- serwircirclesbp@yahoo.com

E-PROCUREMENT NOTICE
BID IDENTIFICATION NO. ROAD TENDER ONLINE RWCSBP-10/2026-27

- Name of the Work** : Road Works
- Total No. of works** : 05 nos Bridge work
- Estimated Cost** : Rs.105.37 lakhs to Rs.831.08 lakhs
- Class of contractor** : 'B', 'A' & Spl. Class
- Other details** : As mentioned in DTGN

Procurement Officer	Bid Identification No.	Availability of Tender Online for Bidding	
		From	To
Chief Construction Engineer Rural Works Circle, Sambalpur	Road Tender Online RWCSBP-10/2026-27	05.06.2026 11.00 A.M.	24.06.2026 5.00 P.M.

* Further details can be seen from the website www.tendersorissa.gov.in)

Sd/-
Chief Construction Engineer
Rural Works Circle, Sambalpur

OIPR- 25001/25091/1/26-27/0010



ALIGARH SMART CITY LTD
NOTICE INVITING TENDER (NIT)
NIT No.: 7432/RFP-Pond/ASCL/2026-27 Date: 01/06/2026

Aligarh Smart City Limited (ASCL) invites online bids through a two-bid system from eligible bidders for the Selection of Concessionaire for Operation, Maintenance and Management of Lal Diggi Pond at Kalyan Singh Habitat Centre, Aligarh on a concession basis for a period of 15 (Fifteen) years, further extendable by 5 (Five) years, subject to terms and conditions of the RFP as per following schedule:

Minimum Reserve Concession Fee	Tender Fee	EMD	RFP Download Start Date	Last Date for Submission	Opening of Technical Bids
Rs. 30,00,000/- per annum (excluding taxes)	Rs. 4,500/- + GST	Rs. 1,50,000/-	02.06.2026	09.06.2026 03:00 PM	09.06.2026 05:00 PM

The detailed RFP document shall be available on the e-procurement portal: <https://etender.up.nic.in>. Interested bidders are required to submit their bids online only on the above portal within the stipulated time.

ASCL reserves the right to accept or reject any or all bids without assigning any reason thereof.

Sd/-
Chief Executive Officer
Aligarh Smart City Limited



JEEVIKA
Bihar Rural Livelihoods Promotion Society
State Rural Agro Producer Company, Bihar

INVITATION FOR BID FOR SUPPLY OF PACKAGING MATERIAL FOR PACKAGING OF TEA ON BEHALF OF MAHANANDA JEEVIKA MAHILA AGRO PRODUCER COMPANY LIMITED

BRPLPS invites bid for procurement of Packaging Materials for packaging of Tea on behalf of Mahananda Jeevika Mahila Agro Producer Company Limited. Interested bidders may download bidding document from www.brpls.in /procurement. Other information is as follows:

Date for start of downloading Bid document	02/06/2026 through www.brpls.in/procurement
Pre-Bid Meeting	09/06/2026 at 03:00 PM at BRPLPS Office, Patna, Bihar.
Last Date/Time for submitting sealed bid (Technical and Financial)	16/06/2026 till 03:00 PM at BRPLPS Office, Patna, Bihar.
Date/Time for Opening of Bid	16/06/2026 at 0 3:30 PM at BRPLPS Office, Patna, Bihar.

Chief Executive Officer cum Mission Director

PR- 004542 (B & C) 2026-27

For further details please visit : www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar

नशे से बचने का है एक ही उपचार, दृढ़ संकल्प और परिवार से प्यार



बिहार सरकार

आधारभूत संरचना विकास प्राधिकार

(बिहार सरकार का एक उपक्रम)
प्रथम तल, उद्योग भवन, पूर्वी गांधी मैदान, पटना
Email-md@idabihar.com, Web-www.idabihar.com, phone: 0612-2675933, 2675935, Fax no-2675934
पुनर्निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना संख्या : 16/TEN/IDA/26

सूचित श्रेणी में निविदा संवेदकों से प्रतिष्ठित दर/मद दर निविदा (केवल ई-टेंडर पद्धति वेबसाइट www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in के माध्यम से)

- विज्ञापनदाता का पदनाम एवं पता : कार्यपालक अभियन्ता (पीडिओ), आधारभूत संरचना विकास प्राधिकार, प्रथम तल, उद्योग भवन, गांधी मैदान के पूरव पटना- 800004
- निविदा डाउनलोड करने की अवधि एवं समय : दिनांक 11.06.2026 से 24.06.2026 को 17:00 बजे तक (on website www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in)
- प्री-बिड मीटिंग की तिथि, समय एवं स्थान : दिनांक 15.06.2026 को 15:00 बजे आधारभूत संरचना विकास प्राधिकार, प्रथम तल, उद्योग भवन, गांधी मैदान के पूरव, पटना।
- निविदा अपलोड करने की अंतिम तिथि एवं समय : दिनांक 25.06.2026 को 17:00 बजे तक (on website www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in)
- तकनीकी बीड खोलने की तिथि एवं समय : दिनांक 27.06.2026 को 11:00 बजे (on website www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in)
- वित्तीय बीड खोलने की तिथि एवं समय : तकनीकी बीड के निमादन के पश्चात (on website www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in)
- निविदा वैधता की अवधि : 120 दिन
- कार्य का विवरण :-

क्र	कार्य का नाम	प्राक्कलित राशि (₹00 में)	अग्रचन की राशि (₹00 में)	परिमाण विवरण का मूल्य (अग्रचनीय ₹00 में)	कार्य समाप्ति की अवधि (माह में)
1	(Re-Tender) बागेली परिसर में अवस्थित प्रशासनिक भवन एवं छात्रावास की मरम्मत, विभूत कार्य, रंग-रोशनी एवं ड्रेनेज सिस्टम का कार्य	3,31,15,805.00	6,62,500.00	11,800.00	06 Months

कार्यपालक अभियन्ता (P.D.A.)
PR. No. 004552 (B&C) 2026-27

विस्तृत जानकारी www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar से प्राप्त की जा सकती है।

अगर मन में हो एच.आई.वी. अथवा यौन जनित रोग से जुड़े सवाल तो सुख्त 1097 पर करें कॉल।



बिहार शहरी आधारभूत संरचना विकास निगम लि०
Bihar Urban Infrastructure Development Corporation Ltd.
(बिहार सरकार का उपक्रम)
पता : पानी टकी, बेतिया बाजार समिति परिसर-845438
E-mail : dudawestchamparan@gmail.com, website: <http://buidco.in>
CIN – U45200BR2009SGC014600

निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना (ई-टेंडरिंग द्वारा www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in)
संख्या- NIT No. 03/2026-27

- विज्ञापन दाता का पदनाम एवं पता : परियोजना निदेशक, बुडको, पश्चिम चम्पारण, बेतिया।
- निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना निर्णय की तिथि : दिनांक-27.05.2026
- प्री बीड मीटिंग का समय स्थान/ तिथि : समय 11:00 बजे स्थान- कार्यालय कक्ष, पश्चिम चम्पारण, बेतिया, बुडको, दिनांक- 12.06.2026
- परिमाण विवरण प्राप्त करने की तिथि एवं समय : दिनांक-12.06.2026 से 17.06.2026 के 15:00 बजे तक। (on website www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in)
- संवेदक द्वारा निविदा अपलोड करने की अंतिम तिथि : दिनांक- 17.06.2026 के 15:00 बजे तक (on website www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in)
- तकनीकी बीड खोलने की तिथि/समय : दिनांक- 17.06.2026 के 15:30 बजे। (on website www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in)
- वित्तीय बीड खोलने की तिथि/समय : तकनीकी बीड के मूल्यांकन के बाद। (on website www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in)

क्र	कार्य का विवरण:-	अग्रचन की राशि (Online में माग्य से WWW.Eproc2.bihar.gov.in)	परिमाण विवरण का फीचर का (Online में माग्य से WWW.Eproc2.bihar.gov.in)	Bid Processing Fee (Through online payment)	कार्य समाप्ति की अवधि
1	नरकटियागंज नगर परिषद पुरानी बाजार एक्स्पान्डीशन के रोड से परिसर टीओपी एवं महाविद्यालय जाने वाली पथ को ठीकिकरण कर पीसीसीगंज रोड महाविद्यालय तक निर्माण कार्य। (24-25)	58,79,000.00	1,17,800.00	11,800.00	तीन माह।
2	जनकटिया नगर पंचायत, चण्डीगढ़ अन्तर्गत वार्ड संख्या-12 में बरहज टोला से श्री मृगिम महतो के घर के तरफ जाने वाली सड़क में सड़क निर्माण कार्य (25-26)	39,75,300.00	79,600.00	11,800.00	तीन माह।

विस्तृत निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना विभागीय वेबसाइट www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar एवं www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in पर देखा जा सकता है।

परियोजना निदेशक
बुडको, पश्चिम चम्पारण, बेतिया
PR-004582 (B & C) 2026-27

नशे से बचने का है एक ही उपचार, दृढ़ संकल्प और परिवार से प्यार।



कार्यालय जबलपुर विकास प्राधिकरण, जबलपुर
क्र.जविप्रा/तक./2026/949
जबलपुर दिनांक : 01.06.2026

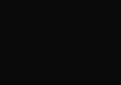
निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना

निम्नलिखित कार्य की ऑनलाइन निविदा ई-प्रक्रयमैट सिस्टम पर आमंत्रित की जा रही है। कार्यालय जबलपुर विकास प्राधिकरण के निम्न कार्य का विवरण वेबसाइट www.mptenders.gov.in पर देखा जा सकता है।

क्र.	यो. क्र.	कार्य का विवरण	निविदा राशि	धरोहर राशि	निविदा प्रपत्र का मूल्य	पंजीयन श्रेणी तथा ऊपर	समयावधि (वर्षांकाल सहित)
1.	16 द्वितीय आमंत्रण	ब्लॉक ए बहुमंजिला आवासीय सह-व्यवसायिक परिसर के निर्माण कार्य के फिनिशिंग का कार्य।	22,30,28,065/-	11,15,140/-	50,000/-	केन्द्रीयकृत	18 माह

- उपरोक्त निविदा प्रपत्र उपरोक्त वेबसाइट पर ऑनलाइन भुगतान कर दिनांक 02.06.2026, 05:30 PM से 03.07.2026, 05:30 PM तक क्रय किये जा सकेंगे।
- निविदा संबंधी विस्तृत विवरण नियम/शर्तों व अन्य जानकारी उक्त वेबसाइट पर देखी जा सकती है।
- निविदा में जो भी संशोधन होंगे, वे उक्त वेबसाइट पर ही अपलोड किये जायेंगे, पृथक से समाचार पत्रों में प्रकाशित नहीं किये जायेंगे।
- निविदा सूचना दिनांक तक जारी समस्त संशोधित नियम/परिपत्र आदि मान्य रहेंगे।

म.प्र. माध्यम/126129/2026 **कार्यपालन यंत्री**



GOVERNMENT OF JHARKHAND
OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER NATIONAL HIGHWAYS DIVISION, DEOGHAR.
Request for Proposal for Performance based Maintenance Contracts.
E-mail: ceehdeoghar@gmail.com

Corrigendum

Tender Ref. No. NH/DEOGHAR/PBMC/01/2026-27 Dated 26/05/2026, which was published in daily newspaper [PR No.- 380914 (Deoghar) 26-27 (D)] the following corrigendum has been made.

Tender Ref. No. NH/DEOGHAR/PBMC/01/2026-27 Dated. 01.06.2026

Application in the prescribed format from eligible contractors for Request for Proposal Performance based Maintenance Contracts (PBMC) mode are invited for following project in two bid systems, (Technical & Financial)

Sl. No.	Name of Work	State	Length	Approximate Cost (Excluding GST & LC)	Cost of RFP document in Rs	Bid Security	Contract Duration* (Month)
1	PBMC work of NH-133A from Km 0.00 to Km 41.420 (Total Length = 41.420 Km) in the State of Jharkhand under National Highway Division, Deoghar.	Jharkhand	41.420 Km	343445607.50	10,000/-	34.34 Lakh	60

Important Dates.

1.	Date of Issue of Notice Inviting RFP	01.06.2026
2.	Last Date For Receiving Queries	22.06.2026
3.	Pre-BID Meeting At Venue (as mentioned in RFP)	23.06.2026 at 02:30 PM
4.	Authority Response To Queries Latest by	29.06.2026
5.	Period of Sale of Bid Document	From 09.06.2026 (03:00 PM) to 08.07.2026 upto 05:00 PM Through official portal of : [https://eprocure.gov.in]
6.	BID Due Date	Date 08.07.2026 Up to 05:00 PM Through official portal of : [https://eprocure.gov.in]
7.	Last date of physical submission of bid security, POA and other documents in original	08.07.2026, up to 03.00 PM
8.	Time and Date of Opening Technical Bid (RFP)	Date 10.07.2026 03:30 PM Through official portal of : [https://eprocure.gov.in]
9.	Time and Date Opening Financial Bid	To be notify. Through official portal of : [https://eprocure.gov.in]
10.	Place of Opening of Bids	Office of the Chief Engineer, NH Wing, Jharkhand, Ranchi Through official portal of : [https://eprocure.gov.in]
11.	Bid Validity	120 Days From the Bid Due Date.
12.	Officer Inviting Bids	Executive Engineer National Highway Division, Deoghar.

(a) Bid Document Fee (Cost of RFP document) which **Rs. 10,000/-** (Rupees Ten thousand only) shall be paid only through NTRP (Non-Tax Receipt Portal) Portal <https://bharatkosh.gov.in> to Pay & Accounts Officer (PAO: 034756 in "Regional Pay Accounts Officer [RPAO (NH), Kolkata code No. 034756 and DDO Code No. 202122 Purpose: Sale of Tender Documents.) The GST of **Rs. 1800/-** (Rs. One Thousand Eight hundred only) applicable on the sale of tender document shall be submitted in the form of Demand Draft favouring "Regional Pay & Accounts Officer (NH), MORTH, Kolkata", payable at Kolkata.

(b) Bid Security "Bid Security of Rs. **34.34 Lakh** (Rupees Thirty Four Lakh Thirty Four Thousand only) in the form Original Bank Guarantee in the format as mentioned in RFP from a scheduled Bank in favour of Executive Engineer, National Highway Division, Deoghar. Bid Security in the form of B.G. only will have to be deposited in any office of the (i) Executive Engineer, National Highway Division, Deoghar (ii) Superintending Engineer, National Highway Circle, Dhanbad (iii) Chief Engineer, National Highway Wing, Ranchi (iv) Regional Officer, Ministry of Road Transport & Highway, Jharkhand Ranchi on before 17:00 HRS on 08.07.2026 failing which the bid will be rejected.

Sd/-
Executive Engineer
National Highway Division, Deoghar

PR 381237 (Deoghar) 26-27 (D)

✕ f @ieExplained

#ExpressExplained

If there are questions of current or contemporary relevance that you would like explained, please write to explained@indianexpress.com

• HEALTH

Codeine crisis: In dry Bihar, why cough syrup addiction is rising

Himanshu Harsh
Patna, June 1

AS MANY as 7,500 bottles of codeine-based cough syrup were seized in Patna last week by the Directorate of Revenue Intelligence (DRI).

As Bihar approaches a decade of alcohol prohibition, codeine cough syrups have surged as a cheap substitute, with seizures and addiction cases rising, especially among youngsters and in rural areas.

What is codeine?

Codeine is a naturally occurring opioid derived from morphine, a compound found in the opium poppy. Used primarily as a cough suppressant, it is found in various medicines, particularly cough syrups, where it works by suppressing the brain's cough centre.

It is commonly prescribed for upper respiratory infections or chronic conditions like bronchitis, which cause persistent dry coughs. It is not the first-line treatment for common cold.

In therapeutic doses, codeine helps manage severe, persistent coughs that don't respond to common treatments like antihistamines. The recommended dosage for adults is typically from 10-20 mg every 4-6 hours, up to a maximum of 120 mg daily. Children under the age of 12 are generally advised to avoid it.

Even within the prescribed limits, codeine can cause side effects including drowsiness, constipation, nausea, and dizziness. Misuse can lead to respiratory depression — where breathing becomes dangerously slow — as well as tolerance, addiction, and withdrawal symptoms such as anxiety, sweating, and irritability.

Codeine can also be intoxicating, especially when combined with depressants like alcohol. Overuse can damage the

liver, kidneys, and mental health, leading to psychiatric disorders. Hospitals in Bihar are reporting more young people suffering these long-term effects.

Why codeine?

Codeine syrups are attractive as an alcohol substitute due to their affordability and powerful sedative effects. Their easy availability has contributed to this.

Despite stringent laws and penalties, including life sentences for alcohol-related offences, the black market for codeine syrup thrives. Recent raids by the Anti-Narcotics Task Force uncovered large illicit stocks, including syrup worth crores of rupees stored in Patna godowns, often controlled by interstate trafficking networks.

In response to the rising misuse, Bihar tightened the regulation of codeine syrups by designating them as "intoxicants" under the Bihar Prohibition and Excise Act in 2016. This restricts sale and possession without a permit, with penalties including fines, confiscation of goods, and imprisonment.

Despite these measures, enforcement remains difficult. Authorities are considering stricter measures, including a total ban on codeine syrups, mandatory e-prescriptions, and more rigorous pharmacy audits. However, experts argue that addressing the root causes of substance abuse like unemployment, poverty, and lack of education could go a long way toward mitigating the issue in the long term.

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• ECONOMICS

‘Cheap’ global money flow into India drying up



HARISH DAMODARAN

THE RESERVE Bank of India's annual report for 2025-26 has expressed concern over "elevated" sovereign bond yields and possible "reversal" of monetary easing (read interest rate hikes) by global central banks, in response to the West Asia crisis-induced inflationary pressures.

That concern has also been articulated by the government's chief economic advisor V Anantha Nageswaran. In a recent opinion piece for *The Indian Express*, he has pointed to the "end of the era of quantitative easing and near-zero interest rates", while calling it "perhaps the single most consequential development in global capital markets" in recent times.

To understand what is being said, one must look at yields on 10-year government bonds. A government bond is basically a debt instrument issued by a sovereign authority to borrow money for a specific, predetermined period. In return, the issuer promises to pay a fixed annual interest over the life of the bond and also return the original borrowed amount on its maturity date.

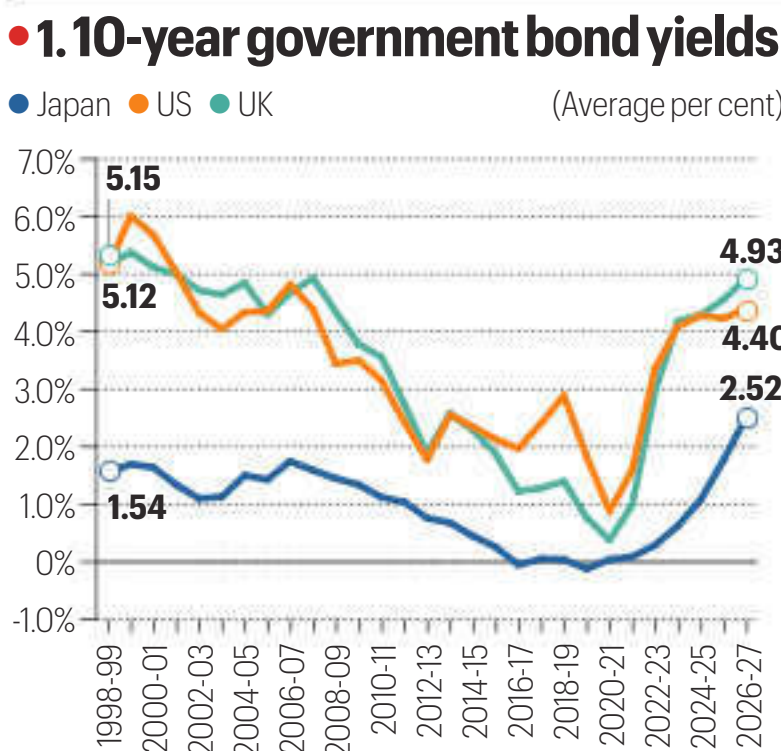
Government bonds are considered to be the safest or close to "risk-free" assets, as their payments are backed by the sovereign's power to tax or even print money. Government bond yields, in turn, serve as a benchmark for setting interest rates across other fixed-income securities — by establishing the "minimum" return investors would expect for their money over a comparable period.

How yields have moved

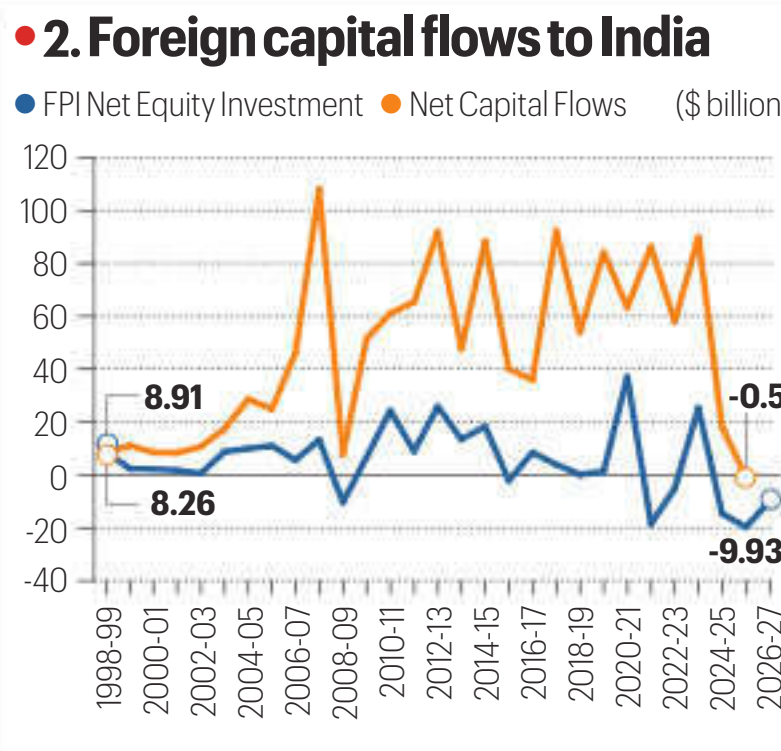
Chart 1 shows the yields or effective annual interest on 10-year government bonds of three major economies — the United States, the United Kingdom, and Japan — since 1998-99.

In 1999-2000 (April-March fiscal year), these averaged over 6% for the US, 5.4% for the UK and 1.7% for Japan. The yields remained relatively high for Japan till 2006-07, averaging 1.75% and almost 2% in April 2006.

From those highs, bond yields steadily



NOTE: 2026-27 DATA IS THE AVERAGE YIELD FOR APRIL-MAY 2026. SOURCE: FEDERAL RESERVE BANK OF ST. LOUIS.



NOTE: 2026-27 FPI INVESTMENT DATA IS FOR APRIL-MAY 2026; 2025-26 NET CAPITAL FLOWS ARE FOR APRIL-DECEMBER 2025. SOURCE: NATIONAL SECURITIES DEPOSITORY LTD AND RESERVE BANK OF INDIA.

declined over the next decade and more, plunging to an average of 0.9% for the US, 0.4% for UK and practically zero for Japan in the COVID-19 pandemic year of 2020-21. Average yields were actually negative in 2016-17 and 2019-20 for Japan. In other words, investors were willing to pay the Japanese government for keeping their money, rather than expect any return from lending to it.

Negative yields are possible in scenarios of deflation (falling prices of goods and services) or the issuing country's currency appreciating (like the Japanese yen was prone to). The investor will make money if the inflation rate is even more negative or converts the same Japanese yen into more of his own currency (say, dollar). Negative yields are also common in times of extreme economic uncertainty, when investors choose safety over returns; a minus 1% bond yield would be less of a loss than a double-digit fall in stock market values.

But cut to the present, where 10-year bond yields averaged 1.8% for Japan, 4.2% for US and 4.6% for UK in 2025-26. They have gone up further in the current fiscal to 2.5%, 4.4% and 4.9%, with highs of 2.8%, 4.7% and 5.2% respectively scaled on May 18-20.

Why the situation changed

There are two broad explanations. The first has to do with the return of in-

‘Risk-free’ assets

Government bonds are considered to be the safest or close to “risk-free” assets, as their payments are backed by the sovereign's power to tax or even print money.

Their yields, in turn, serve as a benchmark for setting interest rates across other fixed-income securities.

flation, with supply chain disruptions from the pandemic (2020 and 2021), followed by Russia's invasion of Ukraine (2022), US President Donald Trump's unilateral tariff actions (2025) and, now, the unresolved US-Israel versus Iran conflict.

This is reflected in year-on-year consumer price inflation for Japan moving from negative territory to positive in September 2021, reaching 4.3% in January 2023 and hovering at 2-4% thereafter till December 2025. Even the latest 1.4% rate for April 2026 is high by its standards for most of the 1990s, 2000s, and 2010s.

It's worse for the UK, which registered 9-11% annual inflation from April 2022 to March 2023, and the April 2026 rate at 2.8%. The 3.8% inflation rate in April for the US was the highest since May 2023.

The current inflation levels — and the prospect of their rising further on the back of the higher fuel, fertiliser, and food prices from the West Asia supply shock — have made the ultra-low interest rates and bond yields prevailing till around 2020-21 unsustainable.

The second is the end of the so-called quantitative easing policies of central banks such as the US Federal Reserve to boost economic activity. They resorted to this measure of creating new money for purchasing government bonds and other long-term assets (like mortgage-backed securities) from commercial banks, es-

India was a beneficiary of ultra-low interest rates and quantitative easing by major global central banks. That era is over now

pecially post the 2008 global financial crisis and the pandemic. The objective was to flood the financial system with liquidity, lower long-term rates, and encourage banks to lend more to businesses and consumers.

That regime was also difficult to sustain, given the potential inflationary consequences from the supply of the newly created money increasing faster than the physical production of goods and services. Also, by making government debt cheaper than the interest rates that the markets would otherwise have demanded, it encouraged more borrowing. In the process, governments tended to take on too much debt relative to their capacity to pay back.

The effects of both — high inflation and public debts — are being seen today in the form of elevated sovereign bond yields.

Why this matters for India

When global money was cheap, India was a beneficiary of capital flooding emerging markets in search of higher yields.

Net capital flows into India surged from \$8.3 billion in 1998-99 to a record \$107.9 billion in 2007-08. It collapsed to \$7.8 billion in the 2008-09 financial crisis year, but averaged \$67.3 billion annually between 2009-10 and 2023-24. The tide turned in 2024-25, with net inflows of just \$18 billion. The first nine months of 2025-26 saw net capital outflows of \$580 million.

The trend is even clearer for inflows from foreign portfolio investors (FPI) into Indian equity markets. From 1998-99 to 2020-21, there were only two years of net negative inflows: 2008-09 and 2015-16. Since 2020-21, five out of the six years have witnessed FPIs pulling out more than putting in money (*Chart 2*).

Currently, 10-year government bond yields in India are at about 7%. With US 10-year Treasury note yields at 4.5%, the differential of 2.5 percentage points has significantly narrowed from the historical decade average of 4-plus percentage points. The yield gap is even less if one factors in rupee depreciation and the greater “safe-haven” value from holding US Treasuries.

Foreign capital may still return to India. But it would probably require India offering a more compelling “pull” story (higher GDP and earnings growth prospects) than a “push” from cheap global money that is now history.

• ENVIRONMENT

Gir lion deaths not alarming but flag need for multiple populations



EXPERT EXPLAINS

YADVENDRADEV V. JHALA

SENIOR SCIENTIST, INDIAN NATIONAL SCIENCE ACADEMY, TIFR - NATIONAL CENTRE FOR BIOLOGICAL SCIENCES, BENGALURU

IN GUJARAT'S Gir region, eight lions, including cubs, have died due to a suspected Babesiosis infection caused by the *Babesia* parasite, the state's Forest and Environment Minister Arjun Modhwadia said Friday. The state Forest Department has isolated lions residing within a 10-km radius of affected areas in Gir Somnath and Amreli districts as a preventive measure, while lions suspected to be affected were being treated, Modhwadia added.

Yadvendra Dev V. Jhala, who is one of India's foremost wildlife scientists with experience in research on lions and tigers,

spoke to **Nikhil Ghanekar** about how this infection is transmitted and how it impacts lions.

How does Babesiosis get transmitted to lions? What are the symptoms and when does it cause fatality in lions?

Babesia (the parasite) is endemic and prevalent in low levels in livestock, wild ungulates (refers to large mammals with hooves), and even in lions, without causing mortality and without causing symptoms in most cases. Babesiosis is a tick-borne parasitic infection that lions and other wildlife can get from the bite of ticks infected with the *Babesia* parasite.

In nature, there is a host-parasite equilibrium, so that both co-exist, and this rarely needs an intervention. Domestic livestock along with wild ungulates such as chital, nilgai act as asymptomatic reservoirs of *Babesia*. Under nutritional, physiological stress or with other infections, it (Babesiosis) can cause mortality.

Babesia acts much like malaria. It is a protozoan, like Plasmodium, and it infects and ruptures red blood cells. The symptoms include lethargy, anaemia, enlarged spleen, and high fever. In conditions of

Protected areas

● The only exclusive space for Asiatic lions is a 250 sq km national park in Gir.

● In contrast, there are 58 tiger reserves within India, each having a human-free space of 800-1,000 sq km.

stress, co-infections, or genetic predisposition, the infection can cause organ failures and mortality.

What is the emergency response in case of suspected Babesia-linked deaths? Do they need intervention?

Natural processes are best left unmanaged in wild populations. As mentioned, wild animals are also reservoirs of several pathogens including *Babesia*. In nature, disease and hosts reach an equilibrium so that both coexist and rarely do need intervention.

There is no need to treat wildlife, and there is no emergency in addressing a few deaths when we have a population of about 1,000 lions. In the case of lions, it would be always nice to spread the risk of epidemics like rabies, canine distemper that can cause catastrophic mortality. This can be done by having multiple un-connected populations (which would act as safety-net populations).

When have such episodes occurred in the past and which has been the most serious one, in terms of mortality?

The epidemic in the lions of Serengeti (Africa) in the mid-1990s is a vivid example of mass mortality wherein almost one-

third of the lion population died within three months. Asiatic lions cannot sustain such an epidemic, and an event like that would risk extinction.

Asiatic lions are also genetically compromised due to a severe historical bottleneck (low genetic diversity) and therefore can easily succumb to disease outbreaks. This is all the more reason to establish several safety-net populations.

Is this a wake-up call to translocate lions to another territory outside Gujarat to safeguard conservation?

The only exclusive space for Asiatic lions is a 250 sq km national park in Gir. In all other parts of its range in Saurashtra including the Gir protected area, they share space with people and livestock and live off human subsidies.

In contrast, tigers occur in 11 countries and have 58 tiger reserves within India, each having a human-free space of 800-1,000 sq km. Conservation biology principles dictate that multiple populations have a much lower risk of extinction compared to any single population. Asiatic lions should be re-established as multiple populations across their historic range.

• GLOBAL

The overlooked conflict: Civil war and humanitarian disaster in South Sudan

Yashee
New Delhi, June 1

AMONG THE United Nations Peacekeepers to be honoured with the Dag Hammarskjöld Medal this year, given to those who lost their lives on UN peacekeeping missions, is Indian national Naib Subedar Sujit Kumar Pradhan, killed in South Sudan last year.

India is the second-largest troops contributor to United Nations Mission in South Sudan (UNMISS), with 4,268 personnel as of March 31. Only Nepal has sent more.

South Sudan is the youngest country in the world, created only 15 years ago. The nation's short history is marked with such conflict that today, more than half its population faces acute food shortage. The latest round of fighting has been raging since March last year, in which hundreds are estimated dead while thousands have been displaced, though exact figures are hard to come by.

The humanitarian organisation Médecins Sans Frontières (MSF), also called Doctors Without Borders, has been operating in South Sudan almost since the country's inception. Its Head of Mission, Yashovardhan, told *The Indian Express*, “I was in South Sudan in 2014, in Unity State, when the civil war first broke out in December 2013. Hundreds of thousands of people were displaced and put up in the UN peacekeeping mission compound. This time, I went to Jonglei. After 12 years and in two regions, the situation is the same. People live under the sun with the bare minimum, surviving on wild leaves, berries, and fish. In fact, the UN runs one of its largest food programmes in South Sudan, a country of 12 million people [around the population of Chennai]. People mainly rely on food drops to survive.”

Born of a violent struggle

South Sudan was created after a long struggle for independence from the Republic of Sudan, itself created in 1956 after British and Egyptian colonial rule ended. The



UN staff assist refugees at the Doro camp in South Sudan. WIKIMEDIA COMMONS

southern region of this nation felt sidelined and unfairly treated, leading to the birth of South Sudan in 2011.

Two leaders of the independence struggle, the Sudan People's Liberation Movement, were Salva Kiir, the current

President of South Sudan, and Riek Machar, who served as his Vice President when the country gained independence. Kiir accused Machar of plotting to overthrow him, and the leadership tussle between them flared up into a civil war in 2013, fuelled by local-level tensions and grievances.

Kiir belongs to the Dinka community, while Machar is from the Nuer group. Their supporters rallied behind them, and the two sides fought brutally.

The latest escalation

After five years of fighting, a peace agreement, ‘Revitalised Agreement on the Resolution of the Conflict in the Republic of South Sudan’, was signed in 2018. Machar came back as Vice President.

However, many clauses of the agreement, including holding an election, disarming various groups, and punishing those responsible for grave crimes during the war, were never implemented. Tensions between Machar and Kiir continued

to simmer.

Then in March 2025, the White Army, a militia that supports Machar, had a skirmish with the Army. Within weeks, Machar was placed under house arrest and over the next few months, charged with various crimes, including murder and treason. Fighting has been raging ever since.

Both sides have attacked civilians, and destroyed homes, schools, and civic and medical infrastructure.

Yashovardhan said there have been targeted attacks on medical facilities. “One of our facilities, in Lankien, was bombed. Our medical stores were looted and burnt. The air conditioners were torn down. Essentially, it was left in a shape where it could not be restarted. This was the only facility providing secondary care to 250,000 in Lankien and Jonglei states.”

Humanitarian crisis

A UN report from April says, “Hunger is pushing 56 per cent of South Sudan's population into high levels of acute food inse-

curity between April and July 2026... Through July this year, 700,000 children are projected to face severe acute malnutrition, the deadliest form.”

The UN mission

UNMISS was set up on July 8, 2011, under Security Council Resolution 1996.

According to the mission's website, “UNMISS' most recent mandate, under Resolution 2820 (2026), requires the mission to protect civilians, create the conditions conducive to the safe, timely and unimpeded delivery of humanitarian assistance, use targeted good offices to support the peace process and prevent escalation of political violence, and monitor and report on human rights and international humanitarian law violations and abuses.”

This was the mission Naib Subedar Sujit Kumar Pradhan was deployed with. Another Indian, Lance Havildar Harbhajan Singh, who died last year serving in Congo, is also being honoured with the Dag Hammarskjöld Medal.



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● **WHAT THE OTHERS SAY**
Instead of recognising the limits of force in Gaza and Lebanon, Israel is expanding both battlefields.
— *Haaretz, Israel*

India needs more schools, medical colleges, entrepreneurship in education



MANISH SABHARWAL

SCOTT ANDERSON'S excellent book *King of Kings* documents the Shah of Iran's curt reaction to food shortage warnings in 1978 as "There are no shortages, only hoarding by greedy businessmen." The technocratic reply that "hoarding depended on shortages" angered the emperor, who then ordered people to "stop complaining and work harder". This royal delusion — the Shah was unemployed within 12 months — echoes the regulatory cholesterol holding back a massive entrepreneurial response to India's voracious demand for education. While tactical responses are necessary before 21 lakh-plus students retake the NEET-UG exam on June 21, the only lasting solution is to expand supply through deregulation that empowers education technocrats, such as principals and deans, to set up institutions.

India's inability to create mass prosperity arises from the low productivity of our employers and youth. Reforms over the past decade have focused on employer productivity; we must now tackle outdated regulations choking the expansion of schools, colleges, and universities. The Radhakrishnan Commission of 1948 and the Kothari Committee of 1968 responded to educator John Gardner's challenge to design education systems that are equal and excellent. But India's youth population today is larger than America's total population. We are no longer a poor, new, and hesitant republic, and our education policy should stop behaving like one. This entails ending five false binaries.

Quantity vs Quality: India has run a randomised control trial in education regulation. The Medical Council of India was bribed to keep medical capacity down, while the All India Council for Technical Education was bribed to expand engineering capacity. This means we have 16 lakh engineering seats every year, but only 1.3 lakh MBBS seats. Capitation fees have largely disappeared in engineering but ex-

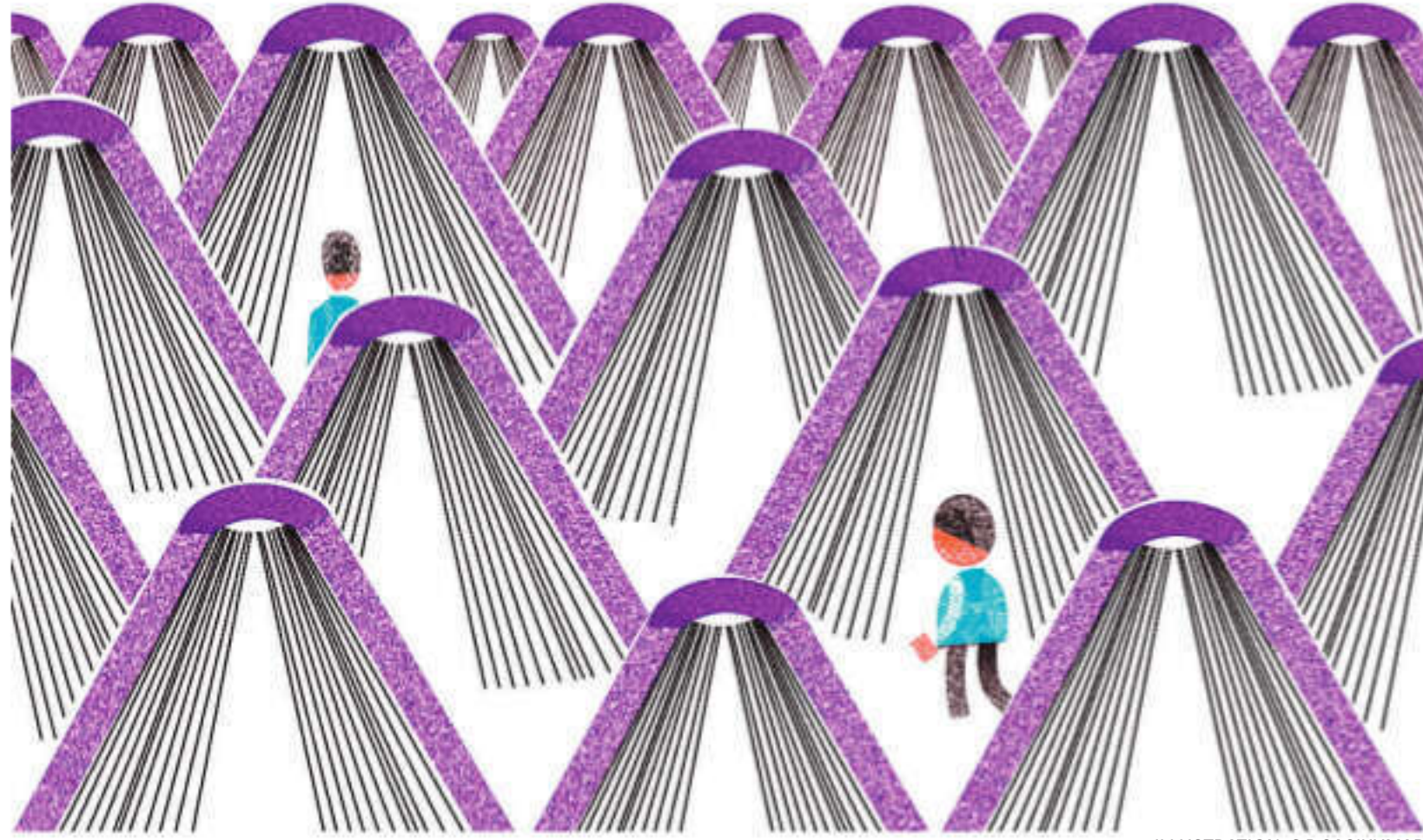


ILLUSTRATION: C.R SASIKUMAR

ploded in medicine. Unlike Athena, who sprang fully formed from the head of Zeus in Greek mythology, educational institutions are not born adults. Over time, the goofy engineering colleges set up in the 1980s in Andhra Pradesh, Karnataka, and Tamil Nadu have improved, providing the supply chain for India's software industry. Nearly 30 per cent of engineering seats now lie vacant. Weak colleges are closing, and good colleges are raising faculty salaries.

Public vs Private: The debates over public vs private, or foreign vs domestic, institutions are juvenile. We should only care about good vs bad schools. But India's education regulations are obsessed with hardware over software, legal structures over learning, and input metrics over outcomes. This creates adverse selection among education entrepreneurs because success requires lying at birth (not unlike legislators' election-spending affidavits) and lifelong regulatory "management" skills (creating a gap between how the law is written, interpreted, practised, and enforced).

Repair vs Prepare: Few disagree with Mark Twain's quip that education is not the filling of a bucket but the lighting of a fire. But ad-

ressing poverty needs learning for earning as much as learning for living. This does not mean India must vocationalise school education or imitate Singapore by streaming children too early, but it does mean recognising that what we can teach someone in six months (a plumber, mason, salesperson or customer service worker) takes 15 years to learn (confidence, curiosity, creativity or communication skills). The most important vocational skills are the old four Rs: Reading, writing, arithmetic and relationships, and too many government schools (50 per cent of enrolment) fail at these basics. Why are half of our kids paying for something to avoid something free? Because a 21st-century education makes the strange familiar through knowledge, but also the familiar strange through questioning.

Price vs Cost: The challenge for great educational institutions is reconciling high costs for faculty and infrastructure, but low fees for diversity and inclusion. Predictably, debates around fair fees and reasonable profits provoke outrage. But India already knows price controls don't work; private schools simply invent 20 different fee categories. The most expensive

Coaching factories, exam leaks, nursery-school interviews and unemployability mean an Indian child's most important decisions are choosing their parents and pin code wisely

school is no school at all.

Excellence vs Inclusion: India's inequality of opportunity means our most valued institutions inhabit two extremes — either the IITs and IIMs, with narrow entry gates (99 per cent fail) and wide-open exits that require elimination rather than selection entry exams, or the chartered accountant qualification with wide entry gates and narrow exits (99 per cent fail). But weak competition for most schools means their wide-open entry and exit gates lead to poor learning outcomes, weak signalling value and rotten employability.

The solution is clear: More education entrepreneurship through deregulation. Removing the state government NOC requirement for Central Board recognition — state registration is already mandatory under the Right to Education Act. Deleting the RTE clause that prescribes jail for schools that conduct admission evaluations — should we select IIT or IIM students by lottery? Allowing all companies, not just Section 8 ones, to open schools and colleges so that education technocrats can become entrepreneurs by legally raising external capital. Scrapping minimum land requirements that confuse building schools with school buildings ensures that most education entrepreneurs are politicians, crooks, and landowners. Regulations that reward legal shenanigans or regulatory "management" handicap talent without capital and capital without talent.

My job in a people supply chain company involved hiring someone every five minutes for 25 years. But only hiring 5 per cent of applicants converted me to Amartya Sen's idea of development as freedom. An uneducated Indian is not a free Indian. Coaching factories, exam leaks, nursery-school interviews and unemployability mean an Indian child's most important decisions are choosing their parents and pin code wisely. The solution is not licensing but supply. Competition will drive innovation in teaching, fees, productivity, multilingual instruction, gifted students, teacher training and employability. India doesn't need fewer cooks in the kitchen; it needs more cooks, more recipes and fewer bureaucrats guarding empty plates.

The writer is co-founder of Teamlease Services and co-author of Made in India

Delhi Gymkhana takeover is not about ending elitism



YASHOVARDHAN AZAD

THE PROPOSED takeover or closure of the Delhi Gymkhana Club has triggered familiar slogans — elitism versus egalitarianism, colonial hangover versus decolonisation, privilege versus social justice. Few institutions in India offer such an inviting target: Sprawling green lawns in the heart of Lutyens' Delhi, old-world architecture, diplomats and retired officials in blazers, and a membership long accused of exclusivity. It is, therefore, politically convenient to portray action against the club as a moral correction, favouring the common citizen.

But beneath the rhetoric, it is important to examine plain facts. The selective demolition of an old institution has very little to do with social justice. If the issue is genuinely privilege, misuse of public land, or elite culture, then the logic must be applied consistently across the capital's many protected islands of influence.

The first argument advanced in favour of public security and defence requirements appears unconvincing. The club has remained there through some of India's most turbulent decades — the Punjab insurgency, Kashmir militancy, the Parliament attack, and multiple terror alerts in the national capital. Every Prime Minister except Chandra Shekhar functioned from the same PM house. The current Prime Minister, too, has occupied the adjoining complex for 12 years without the club suddenly becoming an intolerable security threat. With the PM shifting to the new complex, the urgency for reclaiming the land raises legitimate questions. If the intention is to absorb the Gymkhana with the present PM's house, into yet another government complex in already overcrowded Lutyens' Delhi, it would be deeply unfortunate. Lutyens suffers from vanishing open spaces and the steady erosion of urban grain. The idea of suddenly locating a defence establishment there too, appears odd.

The second argument targets "elite culture". But who exactly is elite in modern India? Is it only a retired civil servant surviving on pension and occasional club lunches? Or, is it also the powerful politician occupying sprawling Lutyens' bungalows at nominal rents, with layers of security and influence? One rarely hears similar outrage over the vast government estates, dotted with official clubs like the Ashoka Hotel, state bhavans, Western Court, institutions that function as exclusive enclaves in their own right.

If club culture itself is objectionable, then let the government announce a transparent national policy on all such institutions — government clubs, defence clubs, officers' clubs, constitutional clubs, press clubs, and numerous state-run establishments occupying prime urban land. Selectivity weakens the moral argument.

Certainly, mismanagement at the Gymkhana cannot be ignored. Property tax liabilities reportedly climbed to nearly Rs 49 crore but the matter is in court. Questions were raised over finances, administration, and membership rules. But these issues were already under the purview of a government-nominated management committee for the past five years. If mismanagement persisted, then what corrective action was taken?

The language of "decolonising Lutyens" is perhaps the most emotionally charged part of the debate. Yet reducing every historic structure to colonial baggage displays intellectual despair. Lutyens' Delhi is among the few surviving examples of thoughtful urban planning in the country — tree-lined avenues, balanced density, architectural symmetry, and public aesthetics rarely replicated in our modern construction. Gymkhana is not simply a refuge of privilege. It is one of the few remaining social spaces where retired soldiers, diplomats, bureaucrats, academics, CEOs, journalists, and politicians interact outside the rigid formality of offices. Such spaces matter to the cultural life of a capital. Investment and global engagement depend not only on infrastructure but also on the vibrancy and confidence of urban life.

Finally comes the argument of rich versus poor. Every society contains inequality, but populist symbolism rarely solves it. If this 27-acre land were genuinely being converted into low-cost housing, slum rehabilitation, public green space, or for public welfare purposes, few would object. But not if the outcome is merely another fortified government complex. Institutions should be reformed, transparency should be enforced and access can be broadened. But destroying civic legacy, riding on a catchy slogan, is rarely wise. Nations mature not by erasing remnants of their past, but by learning how to adapt heritage to contemporary purpose and without reducing governance to symbolic conquest.

The writer is former IPS officer who has served as Central Information Commissioner, secretary, Security Cabinet Secretariat and special director, Intelligence Bureau

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

RBI's Catch-22

THE RBI finds itself in a Catch-22 situation ('Amid rising inflation, RBI cannot neglect growth', *IE*, June 1). Amid supply constraints in crude oil and other petroleum products, and with the much-anticipated US-Iran peace deal remaining in limbo, it would be naive to expect a hike in the repo rate when the MPC meets this week. While the central bank can ill afford to be complacent about its fast-depleting forex reserves, largely intended to prevent any sharp fall in the external value of the Indian rupee vis-à-vis the US dollar, it may also face the double whammy of a steep rise in both wholesale and retail inflation.

S K Gupta, via email

THE RESERVE Bank faces a delicate balancing act between curbing inflation and sustaining economic momentum ('Amid rising inflation, RBI cannot neglect growth', *IE*, June 1). With global oil prices and monsoon uncertainties driving costs upward, a hasty rate hike could stifle investment and weaken the recovery. Prudence demands a calibrated approach that protects both price stability and growth. India's challenge lies in managing external shocks while nurturing domestic resilience. The RBI must ensure adequate liquidity for productive sectors and maintain confidence in the rupee without discouraging capital inflows.

K Chidanand Kumar, Bengaluru

Digital sovereignty

CONTROL OVER data, computing capacity and digital networks increasingly shapes economic competitiveness, national security and technological innovation ('The cloud is the new frontier of digital sovereignty', *IE*, June 1). Today, governments, corporations and citizens depend on cloud services for communication, commerce and governance. India's aspiration to become a leading digital power requires sustained investment in data centres, semiconductor ecosystems, cybersecurity and skilled manpower.

Harsh Pawaria, Rohtak



PETER KYLE

STRONG PARTNERSHIPS are more important than ever. The global economy is being buffeted by shocks on all sides and businesses are being forced to grapple with ever greater complexity and volatility. At times like this, it is hard to overstate the value of providing certainty, stability, and long-term opportunity with trusted trading partners.

These are the values embedded in the relationship between India and the UK. Less than a year ago, Prime Ministers Narendra Modi and Keir Starmer set a new course for our relationship — the UK-India Vision 2035, which set the direction for the next 10 years.

This plan covers everything from growth and jobs to education, technology, climate, and defence. Throughout every aspect is woven the same clear message — we are both better for working together. I have the privilege of delivering part of that vision alongside my friend and counterpart, Minister Piyush Goyal. It is our responsibility to work closely, both with business and with each other, to help turbo-charge our trading relationship and unlock new opportunities — driving growth and creating jobs.

In many respects, our relationship is already delivering on this ambition. In 2025, trade between the UK and India was £48bn — almost double in current prices what it was in 2019. And I am confident that we will only see this trend continue when we bring the Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement, or CETA, into force.

In today's world, growth will be driven not just by the movement of goods, but by ideas, data, and technology. This is where the UK-India partnership is especially powerful

Satire to prophecy, Homelander to Trump



SAPTARSHI BASAK

WHAT DOES one make of a TV show originally adapted from comics and conceived as satire that has since been outpaced by the very reality it sought to lampoon?

The Boys, whose finale premiered just a few days ago, is about superheroes who belong to the multi-billion-dollar superhero and pharmaceutical conglomerate Vought, going rogue while presenting themselves as champions of the innocent, as a small band of ordinary humans mounts a resistance. Where it goes further than other TV shows grappling with the Trump era is in how its satire has served

more like prophecy than commentary.

Creator Eric Kripke has acknowledged that Homelander, the show's most dangerous villain, was "always a Trump analogue". The comparison becomes less subtle with scenes like Homelander being cheered after using his laser eyes to blow a man's head open in public ("I could stand in the middle of Fifth Avenue and shoot somebody, and I wouldn't lose any voters"). Yet if the US president's actions over the past two months are any indication, one might be forgiven for suspecting that Trump is secretly taking cues from the show, rather than the other way around.

Much of the parallel in Season 5 centres on Homelander's self-proclaimed ascent to godhood — achieved after he is injected with a compound that renders him almost im-

mortal — because the American people, in his telling, deserve "a God who doesn't die." Trump stops short of claiming immortality, of course, but his repeated assertions about personal destiny and a quasi-divine sense of mission carry the same instinct.

Things would probably be less unsettling if the timeline did not keep aligning so precisely, like when Trump posted an AI-generated image of himself resembling Jesus Christ. An episode revealing a giant golden statue of Homelander aired the same day that "Don Colossus" — a 22-foot, 3.1-ton

If 'The Boys' has been so prophetic about Trump, what are we to make of Homelander's defeat?

bronze effigy of Trump, covered in gold leaf — was erected in Florida.

So what, right?

Satire works by exaggeration, by taking what exists and stretching it past the point of comfort, into absurdity. The point of satire is that this is where we are headed, if we are not careful. *The Boys* stuck to that in its first three seasons. By the fifth, it stopped holding up a satirical mirror. It is just a mirror.

Which makes the ending complicated. If the show has been so prophetic about Trump, what are we to make of Homelander's defeat, of the rare spectacle of the good guys, more or less, winning?

The problem is not so much about who loses as what wins. *The Boys* makes no secret that while Homelander and other heroes and villains die, Vought survives, with

The writer is deputy copy editor, The Indian Express. saptarshi.basak@expressindia.com

NEW IIP SERIES UPGRADES INDUSTRIAL GROWTH RATE FOR LAST THREE YEARS

April industrial growth at 4.9% vs 3.2% in March

Siddharth Upasani
New Delhi, June 1

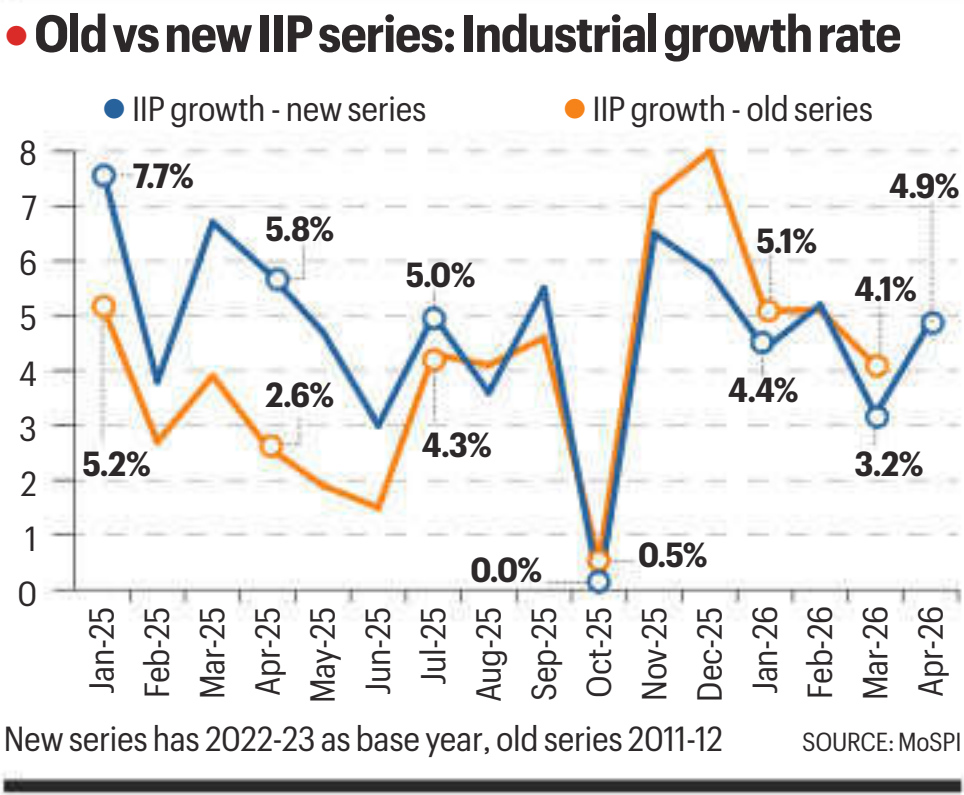
INDIA'S INDUSTRIAL output grew by 4.9% in April, higher than the 3.2% growth recorded in March, according to the new Index of Industrial Production (IIP) data series released by the Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MoSPI) on Monday.

The new IIP series, which has 2022-23 as the base year as against 2011-12 in the old one and updates various methodologies used in the compilation of the index and broadens the coverage of the economic indicator, also upgraded the industrial growth rate for the last three years. IIP growth in 2023-24, 2024-25, and 2025-26 is now estimated at 6.7%, 6.4%, and 4.3%, respectively.

In the old 2011-12 series, the respective industrial growth rates were 5.9%, 4%, and 4.1%.

The higher industrial growth in the past three years as per the new series is primarily due to upward revisions in manufacturing and electricity growth. In April, industrial growth was driven by manufacturing sector, whose output rose 6.2% from same month last year. The manufacturing sector has a 76% weight in the new series, up from 78% in the 2011-12 series.

Meanwhile, output of 'water supply, sewerage & waste management' and 'electricity & gas



supply' rose 6.6% and 4.9%, respectively, in April. However, 'mining and quarrying' output contracted 5.1%.

Within electricity and gas supply, MoSPI now provides a break-up of electricity generated through renewable and non-renewable sources. In April, electricity generation from renewable sources was 18% higher compared to only 2.8% growth for electricity from non-renewable sources. But electricity from non-renewable sources has a much higher weight of 7.8% in the IIP compared to 2.3% for renewable sources.

The impact of West Asia war was seen in the supply of gas, which was down 11.2% compared to April 2025.

According to Barclays econ-

omists Aastha Gudwani and Amruta Ghare, the recovery in 'manufacture of chemicals' — whose output rose 0.4% in April following a 4.9% fall in March — "corroborates our view that peak shortages for industrial inputs (from gas and petrochemicals rationing) seen in March saw gradual improvement in supply in April and May". And while the manufacture of coke and refined petroleum products was 0.5% lower in April compared to last year, "the sector growth was generally subdued even prior to the conflict".

"As such, we would not entirely attribute the Middle-East-related disruptions to output weakness here," the economists added.

In terms of use-based classifi-

Centre's April fiscal deficit at 26-month high; FY26 target met

New Delhi: Amid mounting pressures from the West Asia war, the Centre's fiscal deficit surged to a 26-month high of Rs 3.62 lakh crore in the first month of FY27, accounting for 21.4% of the full-year target of Rs 16.96 lakh crore, data showed Monday.

While the fiscal deficit in April was up 94% on year, the revenue deficit nearly quadrupled to Rs 1.82 lakh crore as receipts fell 24% and expenditure rose 23%. Meanwhile, the Centre also said it met the fiscal deficit target of 4.4% of GDP for 2025-26. ENS

cation of goods produced, output of primary goods was 0.8% higher in April, while that of capital goods rose 1.6% and intermediate goods 7.7%. Infrastructure goods' production was 7.1% higher. On the consumer front, 4.3% more durable goods were produced in April, while growth in non-durables was 2.8%.

Going forward, economists expect industrial growth to remain subdued due to weaker global demand and supply chain disruptions. **FULL REPORT ON** [WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM](http://www.indianexpress.com)

Seafood exports hit record high in 2025-26: Official

Kochi: India's seafood exports hit a record high in both volume and value during 2025-26, reaching 19,72,018 metric tonnes worth Rs 73,890.46 crore despite global challenges, Marine Products Export Development Authority (MPEDA) Chairman P Jawahar said on Monday.

MPEDA is a statutory body under the Ministry of Commerce and Industry to promote and regulate the export of marine products. According to MPEDA figures, the US and China remained top importers of Indian seafood during the fiscal year, while frozen shrimp continued to dominate the export basket. PTI

May GST collections up only 3%, revenue from imports jumps 19%

Siddharth Upasani
New Delhi, June 1

THE CENTRE collected Rs 1.94 lakh crore as Goods and Services Tax (GST) in May, 3.2% more than it did in the same month last year, the Ministry of Finance said on Monday, adding that the year-ago indirect tax number was boosted by a one-time payment of Rs 10,000 crore by a telecom operator for spectrum allocation.

"Adjusted for this one-time payment, gross GST revenue grew 9% in May 2026 with domestic gross GST growth being 5%. Adjusted net GST revenue growth in May 2026 was 10.1%.

With no one-time payment in May 2026, adjusted growth is therefore the right measure to evaluate the GST performance for the month," the finance ministry said in a footnote to the GST data release.

Net GST revenue is arrived at after accounting for refunds. The gross GST collected in May was 20% lower than April's record Rs 2.43 lakh crore.

While the total GST collection last month was up 3.2% year-on-year, the gross domestic revenue was down 2.6% at Rs 1.35 lakh crore. Government sources argued that taxable supply of goods rising 27% from Rs 31.71 lakh crore to

Rs 40.1 lakh crore in April — data for May is for transactions done in April — is indicative of the "breadth and durability" of domestic demand.

While domestic GST revenue fell in May, that from imports jumped 19.1% to Rs 59,654 crore.

This comes at a time when the country's import bill is rising due to elevated energy prices and the depreciation of the rupee. Government officials said that the rise in Integrated GST revenue from imports "signals industrial capacity expansion".

FULL REPORT ON [WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM](http://www.indianexpress.com)

MSMEs ACCOUNT FOR 75% OF APPLICATIONS

ECLGS 5.0: Govt gets over 2.62 lakh applications

Siddharth Upasani
New Delhi, June 1

MORE THAN 2.62 lakh applications for loans worth Rs 1.71 lakh crore have been received under the Centre's Emergency Credit Line Guarantee Scheme 5.0 (ECLGS 5.0), launched last month to tackle the stress being faced by Micro, Small, and Medium Enterprises (MSMEs) and the aviation sector as a result of the ongoing West Asia conflict.

A finance ministry official said on Monday that around three-fourth of applications have come from MSMEs.

The Rs 2.55-lakh crore scheme, announced on May 5 in response to the continued war in West Asia, lets banks give additional loans worth up to 20% of the existing working capital limits of borrowers.

For MSMEs, 100% of the additional credit is guaranteed by the government, with non-MSMEs getting a guaran-

tee of 90%.

Manoj Muttathil Ayyappan, a Joint Secretary in the Ministry of Finance, told reporters that almost 80,000 applications worth Rs 35,194 crore have already been sanctioned, while guarantees worth Rs 15,720 crore have been issued.

Noting the rapid pace with which applications had come in and loans sanctioned, Ayyappan said this was down to the outreach programmes as well as the quick implementa-

tion of the scheme. Around 10 outreach programmes have been planned, with five of them already completed.

"Most of the time, it is also a question of customers applying for it and keeping it so that they don't miss out on the scheme rather than (any) immediate requirement," he said, adding that there wasn't any industry concentration in the applications that had been received.

FULL REPORT ON [WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM](http://www.indianexpress.com)

ATF price for overseas flights cut by 27%, no change for domestic ops

Sukalp Sharma
New Delhi, June 1

IN A bid to insulate domestic airlines from the surge in international oil and fuel prices due to the West Asia crisis, the public sector oil marketing companies (OMCs) have kept the price of aviation turbine fuel (ATF), or jet fuel, unchanged for scheduled domestic flights for the second month in a row.

Additionally, relief also came for Indian carriers in the form of a 27% cut in jet fuel price for international flights. With this cut, the price of jet fuel for international flights has come down to levels similar for domestic flights.

Indian airlines had made repeated pleas to the government to cap the hike in jet fuel prices, while also seeking parity between fuel prices for domestic and international flights. The three OMCs — Indian Oil, Bharat Petroleum, and Hindustan Petroleum — usually revise prices of ATF and some other fuels in tandem on the first of every month in line with international prices.

However, a senior Petroleum Ministry official said the cut in jet fuel prices for international flights was primarily in line with changes in global benchmark prices, and not due to pressure from the airlines.

On April 1, the government had announced that the OMCs were hiking the ATF price for



Jet fuel price for overseas flights has come down to levels similar for domestic flights. REUTERS

scheduled domestic flights only partially — by 25% or Rs 15,000 per kilolitre (kl) — to Rs 1,04,927 per kl, at the country's largest and busiest airport Delhi. However, the full pass-through was announced for international flights, translating to a steep hike of about Rs 73,000 per kl.

This market-linked price is also charged for non-scheduled flight operations, like private jet operations.

For May, ATF price for domestic flights was kept unchanged, while for international flights, it was hiked by \$76.55 per kl to \$1,511.86 per kl.

For June, while the price of jet fuel for domestic flights continues to be the same, for international flights, it has been cut by about \$400 per kl to around \$1,100 per kl, according to OMC sources. In rupee terms, it comes out to be around

• MARKETS

 Sensex 74,267.34 -508.40 -0.68%	 NIFTY 23,382.60 -165.15 -0.70%	 Gold ▼ ₹1,55,536	 US Dollar ▼ ₹95.00
 Silver ▼ ₹2,63,250	 Oil ▼ \$96.60	NOTE: GOLD, SILVER RATES AS PER INDIA BULLION AND JEWELLERS ASSOCIATION DATA GOLD PER 10G, SILVER PER 1 KG; CRUDE OIL (INDIAN BASKET) AS OF MAY 29, 2026	


JODHPUR VIDYUT VITARAN NIGAM LIMITED
(MATERIAL MANAGEMENT & CONTRACT WING) NEW POWER HOUSE,
INDUSTRIAL AREA, JODHPUR-342003 PHONE: (0291) 2742223, FAX: (0291) 2746539

E-PROCUREMENT TENDER NOTICE
E-Procurement Tender is invited for supply of 9.0 M Long (400 KG) PCC Poles TN-2156 (UBN JV2627GLOB00139) & 33 KV 800 Amp. Isolator with Post Insulator without Earth Blade (Assembled) TN-2157 (UBN JV2627GLOB00138).
Details regarding Quantity, Tender cost, Earnest Money, Schedule date of tender opening for aforesaid tenders are available on our website at energy.rajasthan.gov.in/jdvnl and also at <http://spppp.rajasthan.gov.in>.
Raj.Samwad/C/26/3833 SUPERINTENDING ENGINEER (MM&C)
फ़ोन: 2742223, 2746539



Office Of the Chief Engineer

Nagar Nigam Bareilly

E-Procurement Re-Tender Notice

NIT No - CMGRID/72 /C.E./N.N.B./2026-27

Municipal Commissioner, Nagar Nigam Bareilly invites percentage-rate bids on <http://etender.up.nic.in> from eligible bidders for the following package under the CM-GRID Scheme.

Sl. No.	Nagar Nigam	Package No.	Included Roads	Length of Road (Km)	Estimated Cost Excluding GST (Rs. Lakh)	Total Estimated Cost of Work (Rs. in Lakh)	Earnest Money Deposit (Rs. in Lakh)	Duration of Construction Work (in Months)	Tender Fee Including GST
1	NAGAR NIGAM BAREILLY	BLY/CMG 2025-26 / PKG-1	Integrated development and upgradation work from Shyamganj Bridge to Maharishi Kashyap Square.	1.50	2520.12	44.91	2565.02	51.30	41300.00

Sl. no	Events	Date/Time
1.	Availability of tender documents one-tender in e-tendering portal	Date-02/06/2026 Time-03:00 PM
2.	Pre-Bid meeting Date & Venue	08/06/2026, 03:00 PM at 3rd floor URIDA, Sector-7, Gomti Nagar Extension, Lucknow-226010
3.	Last date of Submission of e-Bids on E-tender Portal	11/06/2026, 03:00 PM
4.	Date of Opening of tender	11/06/2026, 04:00 PM
5.	Tender ID	CMGRIDS

The Bareilly Municipal Corporation reserves the right to issue addendums/corrigendum online as per ITV Clause 10, which will not be published in any newspaper.

All prospective bidders are advised to regularly monitor the e-tendering portal.

For more information, please log on to <https://etender.up.nic.in> and download the bid document.

The security deposit and tender form price for the said tender must be paid through the payment link available on the Bareilly Municipal Corporation website <https://bareillye-tender.com> and the receipt must be enclosed in an envelope.

Any questions regarding the tender may be sent to the following email address up to 24 hours prior to the scheduled pre-bid meeting, until 08.06.2026, so that relevant replies can be presented at the meeting to be held on that date. chiefengineernnb@gmail.com AND urida.goup@gmail.com No question/complaint regarding the tender will be considered after 09.06.2026 Time 03:00 PM.

Sd/
CHIEF ENGINEER
NAGAR NIGAM BAREILLY

• NEW RTX SPARK CHIP PUTS AI CAPABILITY DIRECTLY IN PCs; '2026 TURNING POINT FOR AGENTIC AI'

Nvidia's new chip to 'reinvent PCs' for AI era

Reuters
Taipei, June 1



Nvidia CEO Huang introduces RTX Spark GPU at the Computex trade show in Taipei. REUTERS

centric PC to a real useful Agentic AI personal computer which will eventually be in every home in coming years as private edge AI agents become pivotal," said Neil Shah, Counterpoint Research co-founder. "This is going to be the 'RTX Spark' moment

for the personal computing segment like how iPhone, ChatGPT or DeepSeek have been."

The new chip and Nvidia's Vera central processing unit underscore the company's increasing focus on PC and CPU products, with Huang spending much of his keynote address highlighting the RTX Spark chip and the Vera CPU.

The Vera CPU is designed for AI agents and its early adopters include OpenAI, Anthropic and SpaceX, according to the \$5 trillion chip firm's boss.

Huang was speaking ahead of Computex, where leaders of some of the world's largest technology firms are gathering. Nvidia's highlight on AI agents running locally on PC hardware echoed comments laid out by Qualcomm's CEO Cristiano Amon who also spoke ahead of Computex, framing 2026 as the turning point for agentic AI.

AI giant Anthropic confidentially files for US IPO

Bengaluru: AI giant Anthropic said on Monday it has confidentially filed for a US initial public offering, teeing up what may become a watershed moment for Wall Street's AI frenzy.

The move sets up a high-stakes test of whether investor appetite for the AI revolution that has reshaped white-collar work globally can match the sky-high expectations surrounding the booming sector.

Anthropic did not disclose the size or terms of the offering. It last raised \$65 billion at a post-money valuation of \$965 billion in late May, putting it ahead of rival OpenAI. REUTERS

NETANYAHU ORDERS ATTACKS ON BEIRUT’S SOUTHERN SUBURBS; HEZBOLLAH ROCKETS HIT NORTHERN ISRAEL

Trump: Spoke to Hezbollah via intermediaries

Reuters
Washington, June 1

US PRESIDENT Donald Trump on Monday said he spoke with Iran-aligned Lebanese militia group Hezbollah through intermediaries and secured a pledge that it would not attack Israel.

Trump said he also spoke to Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu, and Israel has agreed to pull back any troops that were preparing to attack southern Lebanon. “I had a very productive call with Prime Minister Bibi Netanyahu, of Israel, and there will be no Troops going to Beirut, and any Troops that are on their way, have already been turned back,” Trump said in a post on Truth Social.

“Likewise, through highly placed Representatives, I had a very good call with Hezbollah, and they agreed that all shooting will stop.” A Lebanese official told *Reuters* that Hezbollah had informed the US, through Lebanon’s parliament Speaker Nabih Berri, that it was willing to halt attacks on northern Israel in exchange for Israel sparing Beirut and its suburbs any strikes.

In the latest advance, Israeli troops on Saturday seized the 900-year-old Beaufort Castle and a strategic ridge in southern Lebanon, the military said. That occurred a day after one of the heaviest days of Hezbollah fire toward northern Israel.

Ceasefire very likely to end if Israeli attacks on Lebanon persist: Report

Mistrust, changing US positions delay diplomacy: Tehran

Reuters
Dubai, June 1

A CEASEFIRE agreed between Iran and the United States in early April is very likely to end if Israeli attacks on Tehran-backed Hezbollah in Lebanon persist, Iranian state TV said Monday.

Earlier, the Iranian state news agency *Tasnim* said Tehran was halting indirect negotiations with the US after Israel ordered its troops to push deeper into Lebanon, complicating diplomatic efforts to end three months of war.

There was no immediate confirmation of the reports from Iranian officials, while US President Donald Trump told an *NBC* reporter that he had not heard from Iran on any suspension of talks. Trump also said too much was said publicly, adding: “I think going silent would be very good”.

In its report, *Tasnim* said Iran’s negotiating team was stopping exchanging messages with Washington through mediators over attacks on Lebanon, where the US-Israeli



Smoke billows from southern Lebanon following an Israeli strike, as seen from Marjayoun on Monday. REUTERS

war against Iran has reignited Israel’s conflict with Hezbollah.

The move poses a further obstacle to hopes of a swift end to the crisis, after Iran said it had attacked a US air base following weekend US strikes on Iranian military targets that put further strain on a fragile ceasefire.

Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu ordered attacks on the Hezbollah-controlled southern suburbs of Beirut on Monday, prompting another wave of displacement in a conflict that has already uprooted more than 1 million

people in Lebanon. Netanyahu’s office accused Hezbollah of repeated violations of a ceasefire agreed in late April.

Trump earlier reiterated on social media that he believed Tehran wants to reach a deal. But hopes of a breakthrough were tempered by comments by Iranian officials criticising the “constantly changing” US negotiating stance.

Iranian Foreign Minister Abbas Araqchi also raised Lebanon, where another ceasefire is in place, as a stumbling block. “Violation on one front is

E. EXPLAINED
Resistance Front widens conflict

The conflict is widening beyond Iran-US exchanges, with Tehran’s state media saying the Resistance Front, including allies in Yemen, Lebanon and Iraq, may open new fronts. It warned that pressure on Hezbollah and the Bab El Mandeb Strait could be used to punish Israel and its supporters.

set an agenda to completely block the strait and activate other fronts, including the Bab El Mandeb Strait, to “punish” Israel and its supporters.

If the Houthis, Iran’s allies in Yemen, open a new front in the conflict, one obvious target would be the Bab El Mandeb Strait off the coast of Yemen, a shipping chokepoint and narrow passageway that controls sea traffic towards the Suez Canal.

Referring to Iran’s demands on Lebanon, *Tasnim* said “there will be no talks until Iran and the resistance’s views on this matter are met.”

• BRIEFLY

MALAYSIA

Govt enforces ban on social media accounts for under-16s



Companies that fail to comply could face fines of up to \$2.5mn. FILE

MALAYSIA ON Monday began enforcing rules barring millions of children younger than 16 from owning social media accounts, joining a global effort to tighten online safety protections for young users. The rules require social media platforms to implement age-verification systems and block users under 16 from creating accounts. They apply to platforms with at least 8 million users, including Facebook, TikTok and YouTube. Companies that fail to comply could face penalties of up to \$2.5 million. AP

SOUTH KOREA

5 dead, 2 injured after blast at aerospace plant

FIVE PEOPLE have died and two others were injured on Monday after an explosion and fire on a South Korean production line for rocket propellant at a factory operated by Hanwha Aerospace in the city of Daejeon, officials said. The two survivors, including one who was badly burned, had escaped from the facility themselves, a fire official told a briefing. REUTERS

ITALY

53 rescuers save man trapped in 120-metre cave

A CAVER whose leg had been trapped under a boulder at a depth of about 120 metres has been rescued from a cave in north-west Italy, emergency services said on Monday, adding that the effort involved 53 people in total. The overnight rescue operation took place in the Grotta dei Cinghiali Volanti (Cave of the Flying Wild Boars), one of Italy’s main caving areas, in the province of Cuneo. AP

• NEIGHBOURHOOD WATCH

SRI LANKA

6 killed, 13 hurt after car ploughs into festival goers

AT LEAST six people were killed and 13 others injured after a pickup truck driven by an allegedly intoxicated motorist rammed into a queue of revellers, who were celebrating the Buddhist festival Wesak, on the outskirts of Sri Lanka’s capital, police said on Monday. The accident occurred Sunday night when the vehicle ploughed into people waiting at a food stall. PTI

BANGLADESH

Fuel prices raised again as global costs climb

BANGLADESH HAS raised retail fuel prices for the second time in six weeks, increasing petrol and kerosene prices by 5 taka per litre in a move that could add to inflationary pressures in the import-dependent economy. The new rates, effective from Monday, set petrol at 140 taka (\$1.15) per litre and kerosene at 135 taka per litre. REUTERS

Protests erupt against planned US ebola facility in Kenya

Reuters
Nairobi, June 1

HUNDREDS OF people took to the streets in the central Kenyan town of Nanyuki on Monday to protest moves by the United States to set up an Ebola quarantine facility at a military base there, residents told Reuters, days after the High Court ordered the government to suspend the plan temporarily.

The court ordered the temporary suspension on Friday after a lawsuit was brought ar-

guing that the site could endanger public health.

Senior US officials said the 50-bed unit at an air force base in Laikipia county would serve Americans who have been exposed to the virus but are still asymptomatic. Kenya’s government has also confirmed plans to set up the facility, with Health Minister Aden Duale saying in a statement on Saturday that it was part of a wider push to strengthen emergency response systems.

The US officials said the site



A demonstrator holds a Kenyan flag during a protest against a proposed US-backed Ebola facility in Nanyuki, Kenya, on Monday. AP

was expected to have become operational last Friday.

A number of military aircraft flew in and out of Nanyuki late last week and over the weekend, in what diplomats and experts said appeared to be part of ongoing US preparations for the quarantine unit despite the court order.

A *Reuters* witness on Saturday said police and military had increased their presence on roads leading to the air base.

Footage obtained by *Reuters* on Monday showed a crowd of

about 100 people standing about 4 km from the site of the planned facility, blowing whistles and some riding atop a pickup. Smoke could be seen rising from something burning on the road. Local residents put the number of protesters in the hundreds.

NTV Kenya and Citizen Kenya television channels showed footage of people standing by a wall outside the air base, with a tank stationed there and a handful of soldiers on guard.

French Navy seizes sanctioned Russian tanker with UK support

Associated Press
Paris, June 1

THE FRENCH Navy, with support from the United Kingdom, has intercepted an oil tanker under international sanctions that was travelling from Russia, the most recent effort by nations that support Ukraine to target Russian oil exports helping to finance President Vladimir Putin’s war.

French President Emmanuel Macron announced the interception in a post Monday on X, saying the *Tagor* was boarded on Sunday in the Atlantic.

The post included a video showing a person rappelling from a helicopter onto a ship. It is the latest in a series of French naval interceptions of tankers suspected of links to Russia.

“It is unacceptable that boats skirt international sanctions, violate the law of the sea and finance the war that Russia has been waging for more than 4 years against Ukraine,” Macron wrote. “These ships, that don’t



An NH90 helicopter intercepts an oil tanker that was travelling from Russia under international sanctions, on the Atlantic Sea, Sunday. AP

respect the most elementary rules of maritime navigation, are also a threat to the environment and everyone’s security.”

Oil revenue is a key part of Russia’s economy, allowing Putin to pour money into the war effort against Ukraine without worsening inflation for everyday people and avoiding a currency collapse.

Russia is believed to be using a fleet of hundreds of ships to

evade international sanctions imposed over the war. France and other countries have vowed to crack down on the sanction-busting so-called “shadow fleet.”

Responding to the latest French interception, Kremlin spokesman Dmitry Peskov said Monday that Russia considers such actions illegal. “We absolutely disagree that they are being carried out in full compliance with international law.”

UK releases second batch of files on Mandelson’s appointment as US envoy

Reuters
London, June 1

THE BRITISH government published on Monday a second batch of documents relating to the appointment of Peter Mandelson as ambassador to Washington, a saga which has led to questions over Prime Minister Keir Starmer’s judgment and leadership.

Starmer sacked Mandelson last year, but the prime minister’s decision to hand Britain’s top diplomatic post to a man with known ties to the late US sex offender Jeffrey Epstein, prompted calls for Starmer to resign earlier this year. Mandelson is under police investigation for allegedly leaking government documents to the late Epstein. He does not face allegations of sexual misconduct.

An initial tranche of documents was released in March, which showed Starmer was warned of the risks of the ap-



Former British ambassador to the US Peter Mandelson. FILE

pointment, not just from his ties to Epstein but over Mandelson’s previous resignations from government and his support for closer ties with China.

Starmer’s position has weakened further since the furore over Mandelson. Last month, he faced a new challenge to his leadership after dozens of Labour lawmakers called on him to step down after defeats in local elections.

Austria puts Syrian ex-intelligence chief in Raqqa on trial for torture

Vienna: A former Syrian intelligence chief in the city of Raqqa went on trial in Austria on charges of torture and sexual abuse on Monday over the mistreatment of opponents of then-leader Bashar al-Assad more than a decade ago.

It is a relatively rare case of a European country claiming jurisdiction for alleged crimes committed by agents of Assad’s government. The trial, due to last a month, will include alleged victims’ testimony.

The primary defendant, identified only as Khaled al-H under Austrian privacy rules, was head of Syria’s General Intelligence Directorate in Raqqa from the uprising against Assad in 2011 until the Free Syrian Army took over the city in 2013, which he says he helped facilitate before fleeing the next day.

The second defendant was a senior police official nicknamed “the Angel of Death,” as per prosecution. REUTERS

• CUMANÁ WAS ONCE AN ECONOMIC HUB, PRODUCING TOYOTA LAND CRUISERS AND EXPORTING FOOD ACROSS SOUTH AMERICA; NOW IT’S ON THE BRINK OF DISASTER AS PUBLIC SERVICES COLLAPSE

From an industrial gem to ruined shell: A city reveals Venezuela’s gradual decay

Simon Romero
Cumaná, June 1

DRINKING WATER in Cumaná is running extremely low. Daily blackouts plague the city. Wind howls through the looted remains of its once illustrious university. Scavengers sift through garbage dumps for scraps of food.

Much of Cumaná, a city in eastern Venezuela once a crown jewel of the country’s industrial base, has the air of a battle-scarred war zone.

This coastal city is a starkly different world from Caracas, the capital, which is on the cusp of an upswing that is largely insulated from the decay across

much of Venezuela.

After US forces ousted and captured the former leader, Nicolás Maduro in January, oilmen and crypto tycoons have been rushing to Caracas to explore deals.

Cumaná tells a very different story — that of the gutted economy in the rest of the country that might take generations to rebuild.

“You know those missile strikes in Ukraine they’re always talking about?” said José Luis Sánchez, 56, the president of Cumaná’s Association of Economists, a business group. With a hint of gallows humor, he added, “Sometimes we say our city looks like Kyiv.”

It was not bombing that laid waste to much of Cumaná. Instead, one-party rule, disastrous economic management and ideological vengeance campaigns are to blame, say those now openly expressing dissent in the city of half a million people as Venezuela’s authoritarian restrictions on freedom of expression start to ease.

When Hugo Chávez rose to power 27 years ago, Cumaná figured among other industrial hubs like Ciudad Guayana and Valencia in helping make Venezuela a regional power. Cumaná was an epicenter of the industrial fishing and canning industry for the entire Caribbean basin, processing a stag-



People gathering water from a polluted stream in Cumaná. NYT

gering amount of the tuna and sardines consumed across South America.

Shipyards that built com-

mercial fishing vessels were thriving. Cumaná’s major point of pride was a Toyota plant churning out Land Cruisers,

the legendary four-wheel drive vehicles that became a staple across Venezuela.

Then Chávez embarked on a wave of state takeovers of private companies, a linchpin in his plan of building a socialist economy under his control. Cumaná and the surrounding state of Sucre, a Chavista bastion, became a laboratory for these efforts.

Expropriations initially aimed at guaranteeing domestic food security starved Cumaná’s canning industry of private capital. Collapsing production at other state-owned companies elsewhere in Venezuela then deprived the canneries of what they needed

most: metal cans.

Many canneries are now either limping along or temporarily shut down or completely abandoned, like one in the Caiguire neighborhood, adding to Cumaná’s landscape of ruin.

Toyota’s assembly plant, paralyzed repeatedly by government-supported strikes and union standoffs, scaled back in phases.

The spiraling of the economy into hyperinflation a decade ago finally forced it and its entire ecosystem of local suppliers to close.

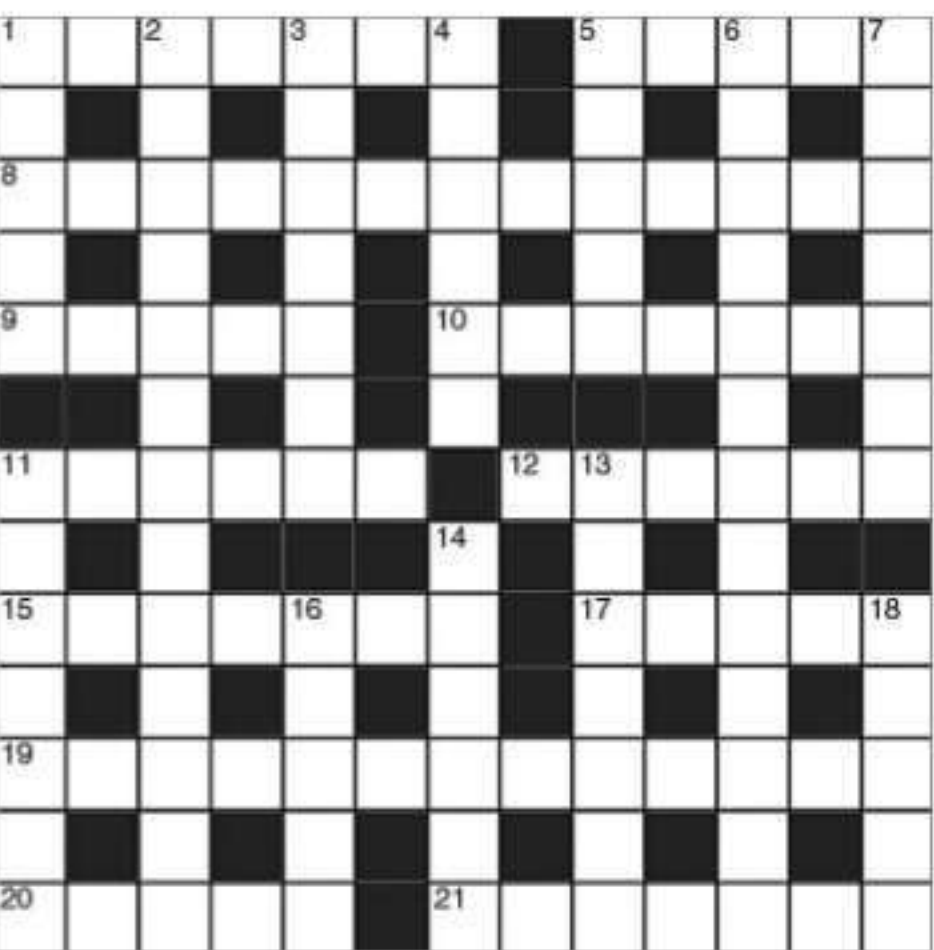
With its manufacturing sector eviscerated, Cumaná now relies, like much of the country, on Venezuela’s government for

its basic needs.

This new chapter is not going well. A rockslide in February inside a tunnel at the reservoir supplying Cumaná’s water triggered a collapse across the system. Unable to fix the problem, officials ordered a severe rationing program aimed at preserving whatever water could be trucked in.

When public trucks do not arrive, private tanker trucks fill the gap. But inflationary pressures have caused water prices to skyrocket, with a single 20-liter jug costing as much as \$8 — a significant burden for families already subsisting on low wages and a \$240 monthly subsidy from the government. NYT

CROSSWORD



- ACROSS
- 1An idea of self-importance (7)
- 5Dad gets out of bed to appear unexpectedly (3,2)
- 8A bit rusty like a retired doctor (3,2,8)
- 9Bad weather is said to be the rule here (5)
- 10Medical problem for a seaside resort (7)
- 11I am seen in unusual anger but recover possession (6)
- 12Stop a criminal proceeding? (6)
- 15Watch for a chance of success (7)
- 17Pole taking meat around for sale? (5)
- 19It cuts both ways (3-5,5)
- 20Car, or a person in it (5)
- 21Resentment shown when a futile plan has gone astray (7)
- DOWN
- 1Nothing among the new rich can be got for a song (5)
- 2No criterion for what a red light should be (7,2,2,2)
- 3Find fee appropriate for Turkish official (7)
- 4A long speech from one in business (6)
- 5Selects what sounds like small films (5)
- 6Soldier gets pay for work; others get it without work (7,6)
- 7Avert a Public Relations incident (7)
- 11Told of a family connection? (7)
- 13Corrected derives from it (7)
- 14Be present and listen (6)
- 16It collapses when there's anarchy or Red revolution (5)
- 18Having charged the French retreat (5)

SOLUTIONS CROSSWORD 6003 ACROSS: 1 Bound, 8 Well kept, 9 Agate, 10 Cupboard, 11 India, 12 Jet, 16 Asthma, 17 Adored, 18 Mix, 23 Let on, 24 Sea songs, 25 Plain, 26 Interval, 27 Idols DOWN: 2 Organist, 3 Not right, 4 Peruse, 5 Globe, 6 Debar, 7 Study, 12 Jam, 13 Tax, 14 Modelled, 15 Memorial, 19 In gear, 20 Astrir, 21 Haste, 22 Board

JUMBLED WORDS

Given below are four jumbled words. Solve the jumbles to make proper words and move them to the respective circles below. Select the letters in the shaded circles and jumble them to get the answer for the given quip.

Patients know in a heartbeat if they're getting a _____. - Abraham Verghese (6,4)

JNAES

COMICS

KSLUY

EEHUMX

ANSWER: Patients know in a heartbeat if they're getting a clumsy exam.- Abraham Verghese

OVER THE HEDGE



CALVIN & HOBBS



MARVIN



DIFFICULTY LEVEL 1s INSTRUCTIONS

To solve a Sudoku puzzle, every digit from 1 to 9 must appear in each of the nine vertical columns, in each of the nine horizontal rows and in each of the nine boxes.

DIFFICULTY LEVEL

1s = Very easy; 2s = Easy; 3s = Medium; 4s = Hard; 5s = Very Hard; 6s = Genius

SUDOKU 6337

	8		4		2			1
5			7		9			2
		7		8		9		
7	9			4				5 1
8 1			3				7 6	
		9		6		1		
6			2		3			4
	4		5		1		2	

SOLUTION SUDOKU 6336

2	8	7	9	4	5	1	6	3
5	4	3	6	8	1	7	2	9
6	9	1	7	2	3	5	4	8
4	5	9	1	6	7	8	3	2
3	6	2	8	5	4	9	1	7
7	1	8	2	3	9	4	5	6
1	7	4	3	9	2	6	8	5
8	2	5	4	7	6	3	9	1
9	3	6	5	1	8	2	7	4

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita-2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused persons **1. Sufiyan Mirza & 2. Faizan Mirza** both S/o Sharif Mirza R/o H. No. 1663, Gali Takhat Wall, Suiwalan, Delhi have committed (or are suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 151/2025, U/s 20/29 NDPS, P.S. Timarpur, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Rishi** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Rishi** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Rishi** accused of **FIR No. 151/2025, U/s 20/29 NDPS, P.S. Timarpur, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **15.07.2026**.

By Order
Special Judge (NDPS)
Central District, Room No. 222
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/7175/NI/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSONS

See Section 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused persons **1. Sufiyan Mirza & 2. Faizan Mirza** both S/o Sharif Mirza R/o H. No. 1663, Gali Takhat Wall, Suiwalan, Delhi have committed (or are suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 289/2025 u/s 318(4)/3(5) Bhartiya Nyaya Sanhita at P.S. Darya Ganj, New Delhi** and it have been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **1. Sufiyan Mirza & 2. Faizan Mirza** cannot be found and whereas it have been shown to my satisfaction that the said **1. Sufiyan Mirza & 2. Faizan Mirza** has absconded (or are concealing themselves to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proceeding u/s 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita have been initiated in the case. Proclamation is hereby made that the said **1. Sufiyan Mirza & 2. Faizan Mirza** accused of **FIR No. 289/2025 u/s 318(4)/3(5) Bhartiya Nyaya Sanhita at P.S. Darya Ganj, New Delhi** Delhi is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on **10.07.2026**.

By Order: Dr. Raj Kumar Singh,
Judicial Magistrate First Class-05 (Central),
Room No. 241,
Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

DP/6972/CD/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.PC / 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused **Pawan Kumar, S/o. Om Prakash, R/o.:H.No.F-54A, Gali No.6, Vijay Vihar Phase-2, Rohini, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in a case vide **FIR No.76/2024 U/S 356/379/411 IPC** registered at **P.S. KNK Marg, Rohini District, Delhi** and it has been returned on a warrant of arrest thereupon issued stating that the said accused **Pawan Kumar** could not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that accused **Pawan Kumar** is absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Pawan Kumar, accused of 76/2024 U/S 356/379/411 IPC, P.S. KNK Marg, Rohini District, Delhi** is required to appear before the court to answer the said complaint on or before **18.07.2026 at 10.00 A.M.**

By Order, Sh. Himanshu Sehloth
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03 (North)
Court No.213, North District
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/7123/RD/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person(s) **Babloo S/o: Satvir, R/o L-429 JJ Colony Wazirpur, Delhi** , has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No.: 25/23, U/s: 379/411/IPC, 179 IR ACT P.S.: Old Delhi Railway Station, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Babloo**, cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Babloo**, has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person(s) **Babloo**, of **FIR No.: 25/23, U/s: 379/411/IPC, 179 IR ACT P.S.: Old Delhi Railway Station, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **02.07.2026**.

By Order
Mansi Malik
Addl. Chief Judicial Magistrate-02
Room No.296A, Second Floor
Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

DP/7235/RLY/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(See Section 82 Cr. P.C./84 BNSS)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused **Kuldeep @Gullu S/o Raj Kumar R/o H. No. C-58, Part-5, Karan Vihar, Kirari, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 279/2024 U/s 356/379/34 IPC, PS Shahbad Dairy, Delhi** and it has been returned to warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said accused **Kuldeep @Gullu** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Kuldeep @Gullu** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that **Kuldeep @Gullu** in **FIR No. 279/2024 U/s 356/379/34 IPC, PS Shahbad Dairy, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **03.07.2026**.

By order
Ms. Bharti Beniwal
Judicial Magistrate First Class-05 (North)
Court Room Court 114, 1st Floor
Rohini Court, Delhi

DP/7249/ON/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.PC.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person, namely, **Moses, S/o John, R/o H.No 42-D.U.G.F Guru Nanak Vihar, Nilothi, Nihal Vihar, Delhi**, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No.: 1100/2024, U/s: 14/14C F. ACT**, registered at **P.S.: Nihal Vihar, Delhi**, and the warrant has been returned writing upon that the said accused person, **Moses**, cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person, **Moses**, has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said, accused person, **Moses, FIR No.: 1100/2024, U/s: 14/14C F. ACT**, registered at **P.S.: Nihal Vihar, Delhi**, is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **07.07.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Komal Garg, Ld.
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03,
West District, Room No. 292,
Tis Haszari Courts, Delhi

DP/7229/OD/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 CrPC

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Vishal Rana @ Hunny S/o Sh. Vikram Rana R/o House No. T-69-70, Subhash Nagar Crossing, Shyam Nagar, Tilak Nagar, New Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case registered vide **FIR No. 475/2022 U/S 356/379/411/34 IPC, PS Hari Nagar, New Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest their upon issued that the said accused **Vishal Rana @ Hunny** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Vishal Rana @ Hunny** has absconded (or is concealing Themselves to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Vishal Rana @ Hunny** of **FIR No. 475/2022 U/S 356/379/411/34 IPC, PS Hari Nagar, New Delhi** is required to appear before this court (or before me) to answer the complaint on or before the day of **13.07.2026**.

By Order,
Sh. Moksha Bains
Judicial Magistrate First Class-II
West District, Room No. 31
Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

DP/7161/WD/2026(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.PC.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person, namely, **Pradeep Raykwar S/o Panna Lal Raykwar R/o KM-15, 1605, J.P., Kosmos, Sector-134, Noida Also At: G-92, Sector-63, Noida, U.P.**, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **CC NI Act. 2357/2022, U/s: 138 NI Act**, registered at **P.S.: Nihal Vihar, Delhi**, and the warrant has been returned writing upon that the said accused person, **Pradeep Raykwar**, cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person, **Pradeep Raykwar**, has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said, accused person, **Pradeep Raykwar, CC NI Act. 2357/2022, U/s: 138 NI Act**, registered at **P.S.: Nihal Vihar, Delhi**, is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **17.07.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Komal Garg,
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03
Room No. 292, West District,
Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

DP/6954/OD/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused persons Namely **Neeeraj Kumar S/o Ram Singh R/o H.No. 642, Gali No. 15, Jeevan Park, Siraspur, New Delhi**. has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in Case **FIR NO. 745/2016 U/S 279/337 IPC PS: Shahbad Dairy, Delhi**, and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Neeeraj Kumar** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Neeeraj Kumar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Neeeraj Kumar** accused of **FIR NO. 745/2016 U/S 279/337 IPC PS: Shahbad Dairy, Delhi**, is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **14.07.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Bharti Beniwal
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03
Room No. 114, 1st Floor
Rohini Court, Delhi

DP/7167/ON/2026
(Court Matter)

JMF-05, Room No. 114, 1st Floor
Rohini Court, Delhi

ROYAL STARS

BY GEORGIA NICOLS

♈

ARIES (MAR 21 - APR 20): Today you will think very clearly. However, someone in authority might say something that makes you doubt yourself or question your decisions. Don't fall for it. Tonight: You're noticed.

♉

TAURUS (APR 21 - MAY 21): You are energised today. When it comes to finances, you will be conservative and practical. Media news or information related to travel might be dicey. Tonight: Learn something new.

♊

GEMINI (MAY 22 - JUNE 21): This is an excellent day for getting things done. You're sensible. You might feel confused about shared property, taxes or something to do with shared responsibilities. Tonight: Check your finances.

♋

CANCER (JUNE 22 - JULY 23): Research will go well today because you have the patience and stamina to seek solutions to your problems or answers to your questions. Be skeptical about what a friend or partner might have to say. Tonight: Be cooperative.

♌

LEO (JULY 24 - AUG 23): You might lead a group today. People see you as sensible and ready to assume the responsibilities of the position. You also might seek the advice of someone older. Tonight: Get better organised.

♍

VIRGO (AUG 24 - SEP 23): You have lots of energy to play and assert yourself in social situations today. This high energy will help you to be competitive in sports and physical activities. Meanwhile, a boss or someone in authority might have practical advice. If you're confused about romance, wait a day. Tonight: Socialise and be friendly.

♎

LIBRA (SEP 24 - OCT 23): Double-check anything that a partner, spouse or close friend says today because issues could be blurred or cloudy. Be confident about dealing with shared property, taxes or inheritances. Trust legal advice or someone from afar. Tonight: Relax at home.

♏

SCORPIO (OCT 24 - NOV 23): This is a tricky day. In one way you feel confident, assertive and even persuasive. And yet, something might make you doubt yourself. Trust your common sense. Issues related to shared property and the resources of others are solid. Tonight: Study something.

♐

SAGITTARIUS (NOV 24 - DEC 22): You're happy to work hard today to boost your earnings. You might take on the responsibilities related to kids or something to do with the hospitality industry or sports. If something makes you doubtful, check it out. Tonight: Maintain your belongings.

♑

CAPRICORN (DEC 23 - JAN 20): When it comes to your job or dealing with your kids or something related to the entertainment world, you feel confident today. Someone at home, or a family member might create self-doubt within you. Trust your instincts. Tonight: You're in charge.

♒

AQUARIUS (JAN 21 - FEB 19): This is an excellent day to deal with kids or to lead sports or to give practical suggestions. You know what you're doing. Don't let yourself be derailed by some self-doubts. Stick with what you know. Tonight: Enjoy privacy.

♓

PISCES (FEB 20 - MAR 20): Because a parent or a family member has assured you of something, you feel confident about sharing this information with friends or a group. Don't let someone discourage you. Trust your instincts. Tonight: Friendships.

CHOLAMANDALAM INVESTMENT AND FINANCE COMPANY LIMITED

Corporate Office: "CHOLA CREST", C54 & 55, Super B-4, Thiru Vi Ka Industrial Estate, Guindy, Chennai - 600 032.

POSSESSION NOTICE (Rule 8 (1) (For Immovable Property))

Whereas the undersigned being the Authorised Officer of M/s CHOLAMANDALAM INVESTMENT AND FINANCE COMPANY LIMITED, under the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 and in exercise of powers conferred under Section 13(2) read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest Enforcement Rules, 2002 issued a Demand Notice Dated 09.03.2026 (Loan Account No. TL01NDL0000060678 & TL01NDL0000061558) calling upon the Borrower / Co Borrowers (1.M/s. Chauhan Cold Drink 2. Mr.Vivek Chauhan, 3.Mrs.Pinki, 4. Mrs. Preeti Chouhan to repay the amount mentioned in the notice being Rs.78,70,326/- (Rupees Seventy Eight Lakhs Seventy Thousand Three Hundred Twenty Six Only) as on 09.03.2026 together with further interest and charges thereafter within 60 days from the date of receipt of the said notice. The borrower / Co Borrowers having failed to repay the amount, notice is hereby given to the borrower / Co Borrowers and the Public in general that the undersigned has taken possession of the property described herein below in exercise of the powers conferred on him under Sub-Section (4) of Section 13 of Act read with Rule 8 of the Security Interest Enforcement) Rules, 2002 on this 29th Day of May 2026.

The borrower's / Co Borrowers' attention is invited to provisions of sub-section (8) of section 13 of the Act, in respect of time available, to redeem the secured assets. The borrower / Co Borrowers in particular and the public in general are hereby cautioned not to deal with the property and any dealings with the property will be subject to the charge of M/s CHOLAMANDALAM INVESTMENT AND FINANCE COMPANY LIMITED, for an amount Rs. 78,70,326/- (Rupees Seventy Eight Lakhs Seventy Thousand Three Hundred Twenty Six Only) as on 09.03.2026 and interest thereon.

DESCRIPTION OF THE IMMOVABLE PROPERTY

All that a piece and parcel of the House No. 37, Area Measuring 140 Sq.yards., Out of Khasra No. 175, Situated at Abadi Rajender Prasad Marg, Under Municipal Corporation Baghat Teshil and District Baghat, Uttar Pradesh, and Which is bounded as under: East: Rajender Prasad Marg, West: Other Plot, North: House of Rajender Sharma, South: House of Vishnu Kumar.

Date : 29.05.2026 M/s. Cholamandalam Investment and Finance Company Limited
Place: Baghat Authorised Officer

दक्षिणांचल विद्युत वितरण निगम लि०
विद्युत नगरीय वितरण मण्डल
लाल डिग्गी, अलीगढ़
CIN: U31200UP2003SGC027460

पत्रांक: 3285/वि.न.वि.च./ अली, विज्ञापन दिनांक: 01.06.2026

जैम निविदा सूचना

- जैम निविदा संख्या GEM/2026/B/7480769:** मुख्य अभियन्ता (वितरण), अलीगढ़ के विभागीय कार्यों के प्रयोगार्थ 01 अदद वाहन मय ईंधन व चालक किराये पर उपलब्ध कराने सम्बन्धी कार्य ।
- जैम निविदा संख्या GEM/2026/B/7599631:** विद्युत नगरीय वाणिज्यिक खण्ड-प्रथम, अलीगढ़ के अधिशासी अभियन्ता एवं अधीनस्थ सहायक अभियन्ताओं के विभागीय कार्यों के प्रयोगार्थ 04 अदद वाहन मय ईंधन व चालक किराये पर उपलब्ध कराने सम्बन्धी कार्य । (ई-निविदा प्रपत्र शुल्क रु० 1,180/- एवं धरोहर राशि रु० 14,000/-)
- जैम निविदा संख्या GEM/2026/B/7599779:** विद्युत नगरीय वाणिज्यिक खण्ड-द्वितीय, अलीगढ़ के अधिशासी अभियन्ता एवं अधीनस्थ सहायक अभियन्ताओं के विभागीय कार्यों के प्रयोगार्थ 03 अदद वाहन मय ईंधन व चालक किराये पर उपलब्ध कराने सम्बन्धी कार्य । (ई-निविदा प्रपत्र शुल्क रु० 1,180/- एवं धरोहर राशि रु० 18,000/-)
- जैम निविदा संख्या GEM/2026/B/7599891:** विद्युत नगरीय वितरण मण्डल, अलीगढ़ के अधीक्षण अभियन्ता एवं विनोन्मासं० एवं रेड्स खण्ड, अलीगढ़ के अधिशासी अभियन्ता एवं अधीनस्थ सहायक अभियन्ताओं के विभागीय कार्यों के प्रयोगार्थ 04 अदद वाहन मय ईंधन व चालक किराये पर उपलब्ध कराने सम्बन्धी कार्य । (ई-निविदा प्रपत्र शुल्क रु० 1,180/- एवं धरोहर राशि रु० 15,500/-)
- जैम निविदा संख्या GEM/2026/B/7600032:** विद्युत नगरीय तकनीकी खण्ड-प्रथम, अलीगढ़ के अधिशासी अभियन्ता एवं अधीनस्थ सहायक अभियन्ताओं के विभागीय कार्यों के प्रयोगार्थ 03 अदद वाहन मय ईंधन व चालक किराये पर उपलब्ध कराने सम्बन्धी कार्य । (ई-निविदा प्रपत्र शुल्क रु० 1,180/- एवं धरोहर राशि रु० 11,000/-)
- जैम निविदा संख्या GEM/2026/B/7600076:** विद्युत नगरीय तकनीकी खण्ड-द्वितीय, अलीगढ़ के अधिशासी अभियन्ता एवं अधीनस्थ सहायक अभियन्ताओं के विभागीय कार्यों के प्रयोगार्थ 05 अदद वाहन मय ईंधन व चालक किराये पर उपलब्ध कराने सम्बन्धी कार्य । (ई-निविदा प्रपत्र शुल्क रु० 1,180/- एवं धरोहर राशि रु० 18,000/-)
- जैम निविदा संख्या GEM/2026/B/7600147:** विद्युत नगरीय वितरण मण्डल, अलीगढ़ के अधीन प्रवर्तन दल, विद्युत स्रोत निरोधक थाना एवं पुलिस उपाधीक्षक के विभागीय कार्यों के प्रयोगार्थ 03 अदद वाहन मय ईंधन व चालक किराये पर उपलब्ध कराने सम्बन्धी कार्य । (ई-निविदा प्रपत्र शुल्क रु० 1,180/- एवं धरोहर राशि रु० 13,500/-)

जैम निविदाओं के खुलने की तिथि: 09 जून, 2026

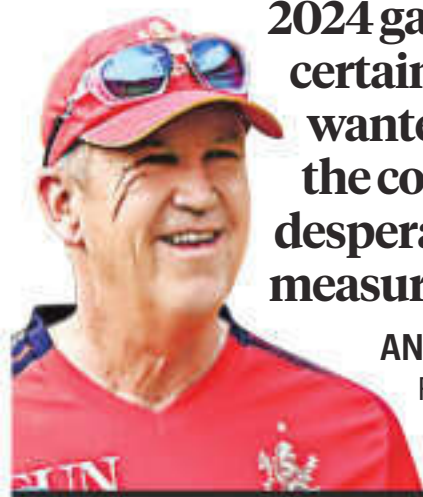
निविदाओं से सम्बन्धित विस्तृत जानकारी जैम पोर्टल पर उपलब्ध है। अग्रेतर समस्त सूचनाएं वेबसाइट पर ही प्रवर्तित की जाएगी।

हस्ता./—
अधीक्षक अभियन्ता

epaper.indianexpress.com

New Delhi

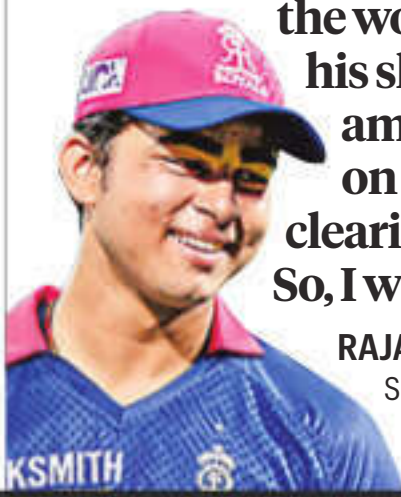
Definite differences between 2025 and 2026 campaigns. But I would also mention the 2024 season, because that was instrumental in setting our determination to do things a little bit differently. The very tough first half of 2024 gave us real clarity about certain strategic things that we wanted to employ, and it gave us the courage, almost through desperation, to take those measures.



ANDY FLOWER, HEAD COACH, ON TURNING RCB INTO A WINNING TEAM.

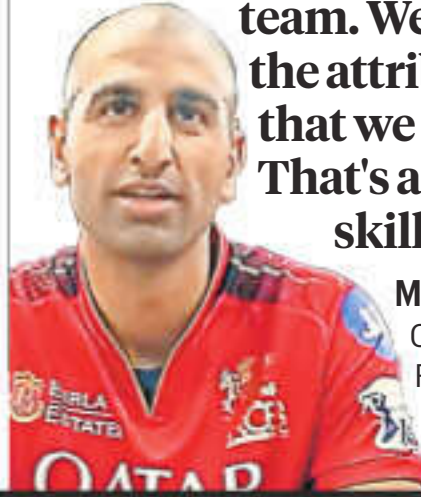
FROM THE WINNER'S CIRCLE

It's pretty clear, you know, Vaibhav Sooryavanshi. Because he is so young and the way he has dominated in this tournament, he has not just played, he has dominated every bowler – top bowlers of the world. So, the way he played his shots, you know, he is amazing. Whenever I see him on the TV, the way he was clearing the rope, it was superb. So, I wish him luck for the future.



RAJAT PATIDAR, ON WHY VAIBHAV SOORYAVANSHI IS THE IPL'S STANDOUT PERFORMER

I don't know whether you can win a competition at the auction. I think you can probably lose one at the auction. It's quite hard to undo things that you then either regret or don't like about your team. We were quite clear on the attributes and characteristics that we wanted from players. That's a combination of skill and character.



MO BOBAT, DIRECTOR OF CRICKET, ON IMPORTANCE OF RCB'S AUCTION.

Shift from red ball to pink approved to deal with bad light

Venkata Krishna B
Chennai, June 1

THE INTERNATIONAL Cricket Council (ICC) has approved the trial run for a switch from red ball to pink ball midway through a Test deal with the issue of bad light reducing playing time. Both teams would have to agree before the start of the game to the change in the colour of the ball if the weather dictated so and play under lights.

The ICC board approved the recommendations of its Chief Executives Committee during the meeting in Ahmedabad on Sunday. The proposal to use different balls during a Test was among the many that the ICC board has approved. So far in Test matches, teams can either use the red ball or pink.

The pink ball was first used in a day-night Test between Australia and New Zealand at Adelaide in 2015. Though Australia continues to host a day-night almost every season Down Under, the innovation hasn't taken off in other parts of the world. India hasn't hosted a day-night Test since the game against Sri Lanka in Bengaluru in 2022. England, another venue where there are enough takers for Test cricket, has only staged one - against the West Indies in 2017.

Hence, it would be interesting to see how many teams actually take the trial run, considering World Test Championship (WTC) points would be up for grabs. The pink ball has a history of favouring seam bowlers, with batters finding it tough, especially during the twilight period.

As per current playing conditions, if both teams agree before the start of a Test series, they can use floodlights in case of bad light. But artificial light shouldn't dominate the natural one. With the new recommendation, if both teams agree, they can play with a pink ball under floodlights to avoid losing time.

In India, Test matches in Kolkata and Guwahati have seen bad light intervening due to the early sunset in the eastern region. During the winter months, natural light can be an issue at some venues in north India. With India scheduled to play a Test in Guwahati against Australia next year, given the latter's familiarity with the pink ball, whether the hosts agree to the new recommendation remains to be seen.

The ICC has said that it is undertaking research in lighting technology for match officials and venues to reduce time lost due to poor light. The world body will be co-funding the R&D project along with the Marylebone Cricket Club (MCC).

In other decisions, the ICC



With 81 wickets at an average of 17.08, Mitchell Starc is the most lethal bowler in pink-ball Tests. REUTERS/FILE

• OTHER DECISIONS

• ICC Women's Champions Trophy 2027 has been moved forward from June-July to February 14-28.

• The ICC will pilot the Women's Emerging Nations Trophy 2026 as a 10-team event featuring five Full Members and five Associate Members, selected based on rankings and prior T20 World Cup qualification.

• To establish a Global Qualifier for ICC Men's T20 World Cups. The competition structure and qualification pathway for a 16-team Global Qualifier to be revealed soon.

• The ICC Board resolved to suspend Cricket Canada from ICC membership with immediate effect due to serious breaches of its membership obligations.

will grant its match officials access to Hawk-Eye data for reporting illegal bowling actions.

Also, a ball that passes the popping crease between the leg stump and the protected area marker will not be called a wide from now on. In case the batsman moves before the ball is delivered, the deemed markers will also move correspondingly as was seen during the IPL.

The leg-side wide rule has now become a permanent part of the Laws of Cricket. After trials since last October, it has now been introduced in white-ball cricket.

In other changes, the head coach or support staff can enter the field of play during scheduled interval breaks in ODIs, as they do in T20Is.

With T20 leagues mushrooming across the world, with two new tournaments upcoming in Europe, the ICC has expressed concerns and decided to form a committee to ensure it doesn't affect the international calendar adversely.

After title defence, Patidar eyes three in a row for RCB

Shankar Narayan
Ahmedabad, June 1

RAJAT PATIDAR sat in the press conference room of the Narendra Modi Stadium as a satisfied man, having become only the third captain after Rohit Sharma and MS Dhoni to lift back-to-back titles after Royal Challengers Bengaluru defeated Gujarat Titans in Ahmedabad by five wickets on Sunday.

Yet, on a day when the celebrations could have easily taken over, the 33-year-old's thoughts remained measured, even as he marked a personal milestone alongside the team's success. "It feels really good. It is the best gift because it is my birthday today, so it cannot be better than this," he said after winning the final. But even in that moment, the RCB captain quickly pulled the conversation back to what lies ahead, reflecting the same present-focused mindset that has defined his leadership through the season. "But I try to stay in the present. We now have to focus on how we can do three in a row," Patidar added.

"We will celebrate today, but then focus moves on again."

For Patidar, however, winning the title was more important than anything else on Sunday. "Nothing can be better than this. When you win an IPL trophy two times, no matter how much individual performance you do, it does not matter," he said. "Winning the trophy is everything. Nothing is better than this. I have learned a lot as a captain and as a batsman."

The victory also reinforced the dressing-room environment that Patidar has repeatedly highlighted throughout the season – one built on clarity of roles and collective responsibility rather than dependence on a few individuals.

"The culture has definitely changed, but I cannot compare with before because I have only played since 2021," he said. "What I see now is a change in mindset."

NEW STYLE FOR NEW AGE

Kohli evolves again: Adds a bit of Vaibhav, Abhishek to his game

Veteran takes his strike rate up a notch, without compromising on his basic batting fundamentals

Lalith Kalidas
New Delhi, June 1

THE LEARNING doesn't stop for Virat Kohli. Not after 19 IPL seasons, and not even after a title in 2025. The game has moved on significantly in just a year, and this time, Kohli moved with it.

In IPL 2026, Kohli synced his batting fundamentals with the frenzied striking rhythm his younger peers have embraced.

Kohli's shot-making repertoire may not match up to the flash of Vaibhav Sooryavanshi and Abhishek Sharma. No matter. In RCB's successful title defence in Ahmedabad on Sunday, he produced an unbeaten 75, sealing the win over Gujarat Titans with a six. He closed the season with 675 runs – a fourth successive 600-plus season in the Impact Player era.

It isn't chart-topping, but 2026 will go down as the season when Kohli adopted the unrelenting code of T20 cricket.

The supreme anchor in him had refused to buy into the manic rhythm for long. But reading the rapidly evolving landscape allowed him to flip a mental switch – not technical. A surge of fearless hitters had given the IPL's record run-scorer something new to pursue.

"You have these super young players pushing you all the time and really asking you to change your game and up the ante. It's exciting because it gives you something to work towards," Kohli remarked after his innings of aggression and attrition in the final.

"The demands of today's game... You need to get those 20-30 extra runs. I had to change my mindset, not my game so much, to hit the shots I hit, but more often and take the bowlers on, probably the best bowlers in the opposition."

When Kohli took 21 off the second over bowled by Kagiso Rabada in the 156-run chase in the final, it reflected the work of an entire season. It was the most he had aggregated in an over of pace in 13 years, coming against a pacer who had dismissed him five times. A rebooted Kohli smeared him for 88 runs at a strike rate of 237 this season.

The mental tweak has scarcely looked out of place in action. The shift is discernible from the outset, but with minimal shot-making adjustments.

Kohli's Powerplay shares soared to an all-time high in 2026. Over half the deliveries he faced came in the Powerplay, yielding 360 of his 675 runs (53.33%). Kohli aggregated them at a 174.76 strike rate in the Powerplay – his best for any season – bettered only by Sooryavanshi (233.63) and Abhishek (214.53) for more runs.

Of the eight batters who amassed at least 300 Powerplay runs this season, Kohli has hit the fewest sixes. His 11 maxis are far fewer than Sooryavanshi's (46) and Abhishek's (29), but Kohli has also played the fewest dot balls (58).

The 2024 season was arguably the former RCB skipper's previous best in terms of Powerplay run-scoring, managing 373 runs at 161.5. Kohli struck 36 fours and 21 sixes



Virat Kohli's aggression at the top played a crucial role in RCB's title-winning campaign. ANI

• Most Powerplay runs in IPL 2026

PLAYER	I	R	AVG	SR	4s	6s	DOTS
Vaibhav Sooryavanshi	16	521	74.43	233.63	48	46	82
Abhishek Sharma	15	369	52.71	214.53	36	29	61
Virat Kohli	16	360	51.43	174.76	47	11	58
Sai Sudharsan	17	347	43.38	142.8	50	9	104
Travis Head	15	337	37.44	170.2	44	17	86

then, with his non-boundary strike rate reading 59.15. Excluding his 58 boundaries, Kohli's Powerplay runs have arrived at a 71.6 strike rate this year, emphasising his unique mechanism to maintain the run flow.

Beyond the Powerplay, Kohli has also unlocked the freedom to bat quicker in the middle overs with the assurance of a solid middle-order

cartel behind him. Facing fewer balls in overs 7-16 than previous seasons, Kohli struck at 149.7 – close to his 2016 highs (150.8).

The most striking switch remains the clinical takedown of pace. Over 80 percent (542) of Kohli's runs this season have emerged against the quicks, a clear indication that his reflexes are as sharp as ever. Only once has he scored more

against pace in a season – 609 in 2016 – but the 177.7 strike rate this time stands much above his past versions.

The transformation peaked with a 25-ball fifty in the final – his fastest IPL half-century across all seasons. Kohli hadn't traded his core in the transaction. Fending off a tricky passage, his last 25 runs took 17 balls, his varying avatars infusing to stub the Titans.

"You can have all the excitement and slam-bang in the world, but come the big situations, you need the big boys to step up," Kohli said after the match-winning knock.

Holding his past self just as dear, Kohli reiterated that the acceleration was not a blind leap, but founded on the conviction that he can still ace the T20 game in his late thirties.

• COACH'S CORNER

Nehra's way: Despite flaws, GT keep making finals

Venkata Krishna B
Chennai, June 1

THIS WAS a scene early in the IPL season when Gujarat Titans were playing Lucknow Super Giants. Gujarat Titans captain Shubman Gill seemed to be drifting away from a plan discussed in the team meeting. But it didn't escape the eyes of coach Ashish Nehra, who called Kulwant Khejroliya from the bench, put an arm around him, explained the plan and then held him by the back of the head, pushed him onto the field and shouted, "Bhaag". If there was a moment that summed up Nehra, the first Indian coach to win an IPL title, it was that – always animated on the sidelines, never resting in the dugout and passing messages onto the field at every possible opportunity.

Those animated antics on the boundary line are not new to the IPL; they have been a feature since he took charge of Gujarat in 2022. But for cricket, they are still new. These antics, of course, haven't sat well with some influential BCCI officials, it is understood, but watch Nehra run the show from the sidelines, constantly in Gill's ear and moving fielders here and there, and he is more in the mould of a Jose Mourinho, Pep Guardiola or even Mikel Arteta, whose instructions from the touchline have divided opinions. But ask



Gujarat Titans coach Ashish Nehra with captain Shubman Gill. CREIMAS

anyone in the Gujarat team, and they will tell you that Nehra is their orchestrator.

Ahead of IPL 2026, Gujarat appeared to be a team with a few holes. In a tournament where 12 players are in action, it was as if they were taking the field with only nine at times. When teams had moved on to aggressive batsmen, they still seemed stuck in a different time. Were they going to end up like Chennai Super Kings and Mumbai Indians? The questions were plenty. Nehra was even asked if GT needed to think differently this season. "I don't think there's a need to think differently this season. In fact, I don't have to think, the players do. They have to think. They have to play. I'm sitting outside," he would say.

But, like the football man-

agers, Nehra is unique in his own way as a coach. There is a template that he has, which football managers prefer to call a philosophy or style. Sun or moon, they don't deviate from it. Nehra, in many ways, fits into that category, for from the time he took charge, he has stuck to a philosophy. In a tournament where former batsmen take up key coaching roles, Nehra is the lone former bowler who happens to be a head coach. And quite naturally, instead of stocking his teams with power-hitters, he has chosen to strengthen the bowling in a format where batsmen call the shots. In football parlance, he is what Mourinho used to prefer in the good old days – give away possession to the opposition. The reasoning was simple: "One

who has the ball makes more mistakes."

With Nehra, the ideology seems to be that the team with the strongest attack will win games. And so he goes looking for this at the auction:

• A strong pace attack, which includes fast bowlers who can clock over 140 kmph consistently and bowl Test-match lines.

• Have compact, steady batsmen at the top, who will provide consistency over flamboyance and offer higher rewards than a high-risk approach.

• Look for players at the auction who will fit this template rather than ones who could end up complicating it.

• While investing in young Indian players, go for hungrier ones and the cream of the domestic talent.

These are just the crux of his template, but a lot goes on behind the scenes. Since GT came into the IPL fold in 2022, no team has won more than the 43 matches they have in the league stage. In five seasons, they have missed out on the playoffs only once.

Beyond the consistent run, Nehra has seldom deviated from his template. If Hardik Pandya and David Miller were the experienced ones in the early years, after losing both, he relied on Jos Buttler and Gill.

And when Sherfane Rutherford headed to Mumbai Indians like Pandya, he didn't search for another similar finisher, instead choosing to look inwards to players who fit his needs. Even with uncapped players, the talents he has chosen to invest in are those in India's scheme of things: Nishant Sindhu, Manav Suthar, Gurnoor Brar, R Sai Kishore and Ashok Sharma.

Across all seasons, their batting unit has always remained thin and has been consistently top-heavy, with the openers and No. 3 having to do the bulk of the scoring. That means they are not the team that can post gigantic totals on the board, but one that can consistently post between 180 and 220. With a strong attack at its disposal, which includes arguably the best T20 spinner, Nehra's template is simple: restrict the opposition to a total below 200, which is manageable for his batting line-up to chase. Of course, given the increasing run rate, GT picked up their scoring rate after their defeat in Bengaluru, scoring 229 twice. But it is still a unit that plays to its limitations wonderfully well.

At the start of the season, Gujarat weren't among the favourites to win. They had holes. They had their limitations. But they had a coach who knew their strengths, who used his players in specific roles and ended up taking the team to another final.

Shankar Narayan
Ahmedabad, June 1

EVER SINCE they joined the Indian Premier League (IPL) fold in 2022, Gujarat Titans (GT) have built a reputation as one of the smartest, most methodical franchises in the league. They built their squad around a strong bowling attack, an efficient top-order and the right balance of experienced Indian and overseas players. Yet, when the dust settles on another season where they remained largely consistent before faltering in the final, GT will be left circling back to the same question they have been asking for a while now: how to build a middle-order that supports the opening duo?

Much of the Titans' identity in IPL 2026 again revolved around Shubman Gill and Sai Sudharsan. Between them, they don't just open the innings but also form the batting backbone. Gill finished with 732 runs, Sudharsan with 722, and the opposition targeted their wickets more than those of anyone else in the team. Yet, beyond them, the transition between consolidation to late-innings explosion remained GT's most glaring vulnerability throughout the 2026 edition. Much of that responsibility was expected to be taken by M Shahrulkh Khan, acquired for Rs 4 crore at the pre-season auction. But the investment did not translate into impact.

In nine matches, he man-



M Shahrulkh Khan, GT's bet at the auction, did not deliver. CREIMAS

aged just 43 runs at a strike rate of 130.30, numbers that fell far short of expectations. Shahrulkh did not feature in the playing XI after April 30, and GT were effectively carrying a passenger when they needed someone more reliable. Rahul Tewatia, once celebrated as a finisher, also endured a subdued season. He scored 190 runs in 16 matches at a strike rate of 143.94, with just one fifty-plus score, that too in a losing cause. He did not bowl a single over in the entire season, thereby limiting his impact significantly; in fact he hasn't bowled one since IPL 2023.

What GT lacked most was not just runs, but intent. Washington Sundar offered stability, scoring 377 runs in 17 matches at 150.20. But while he held the innings together, he lacked the power game required to consistently provide the final flourish in

the death overs.

The numbers underline the issue. GT's middle-order produced just 865 runs in IPL 2026, the fewest among all 10 teams, while their strike rate of 143.21 ranked only sixth. They hit just 79 fours and 33 sixes, comfortably the lowest six tally among all sides. By comparison, Sunrisers Hyderabad's middle-order scored 1194 runs and hit 69 sixes, while RCB's middle-order amassed 1173 runs at a strike rate of 170. More importantly, this is not a new problem. Since the 2023 edition, GT have repeatedly backed Indian players, but few have delivered consistently enough to make the role their own. Since 2023, Tewatia has led GT's middle-order run charts with 564 runs, followed by Sundar's 510. No middle-order batter has crossed even 600 runs across this period. The bigger concern is how little Gujarat have extracted from overseas players in recent years. Likes of Glenn Phillips and Jason Holder have been used in different combinations, but none has become the dependable enforcer capable of routinely taking games away from opponents.

The best teams are defined by balance, which runs through the XI. GT have an exceptional opening duo and arguably the most varied pace attack among all teams. But the middle-order still lacks the consistency and firepower needed to decide games on its own.

Kalinskaya beats Potapova in a super tiebreak; Serena to return



Anna Kalinskaya defeated Anastasia Potapova to enter her first quarters at French Open. AP

Associated Press
Paris, June 1

ANNA KALINSKAYA surprised herself after defeating Anastasia Potapova 6-4, 2-6, 7-6 (10-7) to reach her first French Open quarterfinal on Monday. The Russian had not expected to get this far. "Thinking two weeks ago that I will be here, I wouldn't believe it," she said. "I would probably laugh with my team." Perhaps setting a low bar has helped her play more freely in the opening rounds.

"I just take this clay season very easy mentally. I don't put too much pressure to do well. I guess it helps," the No. 22 seed said. "I didn't have any expectations on play for myself." Their contest on Court Suzanne-Lenglen stretched to almost three hours after Potapova failed to serve out the match twice in the decider and Kalinskaya overturned a 4-1 deficit in the super tiebreak. "I'm super proud, and I can't believe it," Kalinskaya said. "The match was so long, so I'm still processing what's going on." It will be Kalinskaya's second quarterfinal at a major beside the 2024 Australian Open.

Despite pre-tournament men's favorite Jannik Sinner losing in the second round, Italian fans will have at least one player in the quarterfinals.

Tenth-seeded Flavio Cobolli advanced to his second Grand Slam quarterfinal - and his first here - after beating American Zachary Svajda 6-2, 6-3, 6-7 (3), 7-6 (5).

"It's for sure my favorite Grand Slam to play," Cobolli said after winning on Court Philippe-Chatrier. "We have the best feeling with the surface as Italians." A little while after his win, Cobolli - a former youth soccer player at Italian club Roma - joined players from the Paris Saint-Germain team as they paraded the Champions League trophy on Chatrier. PSG beat Arsenal in the final on Saturday.

Serena returns

Serena Williams is returning to professional tennis at age 44 after nearly four years away from the sport.

The 23-time Grand Slam singles champion has accepted a wild card invitation to play doubles at the upcoming Queen's Club grass-court tournament, the WTA Tour announced Monday. The Queen's Club tournament starts next Monday and the WTA said Williams will play "with a partner to be announced in due course." Williams has not competed since bidding farewell.

MATHIAS BOE COMES BACK

Secret intelligence: The ‘Four Eyes’ guiding Satwik-Chirag

Returning Dane and coach Tan cover all bases as India's dynamic duo prepare to take on the world's best

Shivani Naik
Mumbai, June 1

THE DAY Satwik-Chirag defeated World No 1s Seo Seung-jae and Kim Won-ho on way to the Singapore Open Super 750 title, silent preparations were ongoing in Hyderabad and Mumbai, and wherever Mathias Boe was hunched over his laptop. The backroom analysis focused on how to prepare for the same Koreans the next time.

Defeated in straight games, Seo-Kim are expected to hit the drawing board with Korean doubles great and legendary coach Park Joo-bong, and ensure Seo would figure ways to foil the strategy of being pushed to the back-court by the Indians. Team Satwik-Chirag was readying to counter these counter-strikes.

"Four eyes see better than two," went Mathias Boe's announcement on Instagram of "secret" intelligence-sharing that has admittedly happened behind the scenes.

Satwicksairaj Rankireddy, Chirag Shetty and their Malaysian coach Tan Kim Her have all been in cahoots with Boe for a month now, plotting against the best names in men's doubles from Korea, Indonesia, China, Taiwan and Malaysia.

The result was the Indians dissecting and defeating World No.1 Koreans and No.3 Indonesians on their way to the Singapore title. The World No.2 Chinese and No.5 Malaysians were neutralized on their way to winning the World Championships bronze last year. It's why the four eyes of their partnership-creator coach Tan and their opponent-destroyer, coach Boe,

Satwik-Chirag are literally facing a different style each day, given Seo-Kim, Wang-Liang, Fikri-Fajar and Chia-Soh all play different games.

are both needed.

"It's not a statement-making win or anything. We have won Super 750s, even Super 1000s before," Chirag would state during a media interaction. But Satwik would declare his bucket list - to win in every arena in Japan, Korea, Singapore - basically, everywhere. And Chirag would avow that the unfinished business of an Olympic medal remains the ultimate goal.

"We are not trying to prove any point to anyone. We are very driven by ourselves. Also very critical of ourselves," Satwik would stress, adding they were feeling upbeat after ending the title drought and ambitious about winning every major event. With the on-boarding of consultant Boe, who feels the sting of their losses as much as Tan does, the Avengers had assembled.

"He's helping remotely with match analysis. All four of us sit together (online) and see what works, what doesn't," Chirag would say.

A proper brainstorm follows the storm they have been through. The World Championships in Delhi and the Asian Games at Nagoya are the short-term goals.

Attacking smashes are their first instinct. What Boe brings



Satwik-Chirag had a good stint with Mathias Boe till the 2024 Paris Olympics. FILE/PTI

is nuance to the offensive play. "Small changes, like going down the line when smashing instead of into the body," Chirag explained.

Different approaches

From coach Tan came the method to tackle the dreaded spin-serve that wrecked their Olympics and six months before Paris. "It took us time to go from Boe to Tan. Almost 90 percent of their ideas are the same, but it needed a brain-opener," Satwik would add. It's been hard work. "Pushing in training even on Sundays."

A Boe-Tan combo will also thrash out the clarity of who makes the play and sets it up for the partner. Unlike any other pairing where one is creative and the other a muscling-finisher, the Indians are versatile-both can switch roles. It's what Boe-Tan will optimise.

Singapore was also crucial because the whirlpool playing

hall is one of the biggest tests in terms of drift. It took time for them to understand how high the lifts needed to be to thwart smashing, says Chirag. Last year, they made the semis, this year they were ready to win the title. For Satwik, Singapore was a test of their patience.

Satwik-Chirag are literally facing a different style each day, given Seo-Kim, Wang-Liang, Fikri-Fajar and Chia-Soh, not to mention the new Malaysian pairs and their Chinese threat, Chen-Liu, all play different games.

Strong attack

"They know we have a strong attack. Nobody likes lifting the shuttle to us. But everyone has a different style, we need to prepare for each match," Chirag explained.

The biggest problem for Satwik-Chirag, invisible to most but highlighted by HS Prannoy, was sparring - another area

where Boe can step in. The Dane takes massive pride in his coaching nous while Tan, who coupled them, has high stakes in seeing them succeed.

But the Indians struggled for a year coming up against lefties. They solved that, but high quality sparring - that other powerhouses have - is missing here.

"If Arjun-Hari are playing a tournament, we have nobody to spar with," Satwik said.

"At the All England, we asked the Indonesians if we could spar with them. The confidence I got from just two days was outstanding. Sparring is like homework, preparing for an exam."

In a partnership of a dozen years, the good days have come from implicitly trusting each other. And the bad days?

"If it's not a good day, you trust your partner even more," Satwik would say, of the secret superpower of the eight eyes.

Gukesh's high-risk game puts opponent under pressure: Carlsen's coach

Amit Kamath
Oslo, June 1

PETER HEINE Nielsen sighs contemplating the tricky question: Gukesh or Javokhir Sindarov, for the World Chess Championship in six months?

Usually one of the most opinionated people in the sport, Magnus Carlsen's coach weighs his words. Predicting an outcome in a match between two 20-year-olds, that too largely unfamiliar to him, could be tricky.

"If either player wins by three points, I would not be massively shocked," Nielsen says with a shrug. "Here, anything could happen. They are both very cool players, take a lot of risks, and have a lot of confidence."

Nielsen helped Carlsen win four of his World Championship titles as a second and has been with the world no 1 over a decade. Before that he also

helped Viswanathan Anand win four of his own World Championship titles.

He points out that Sindarov is a "slight favourite" because how the last few months transpired. Gukesh has been bleeding rating points with losses at tournaments mounting up. The Uzbek challenger's career, meanwhile, has shot off into the stratosphere with an unbeaten Candidates campaign.

"But just half a year ago we were not talking much about Sindarov," he says, pointing at the fickle nature of form in young players.

Since becoming world champion, criticism of Gukesh, who turned 20 recently, has mounted. Much of it came from former world champions like Garry Kasparov, Kramnik and Karpov, besides Carlsen, the man who is coached by Nielsen.

Nielsen, however, is impressed by the way that the In-

dian played at the World Championship in 2024 to defeat Ding Liren and the way Gukesh's coach Grzegorz Gajewski has pushed him.

"I'm very impressed with Gukesh's team. Gajewski is very creative and I think he's pushing Gukesh's style really well. What they did in the World Championship match was a sort of very modern way of what we did with Vishy. We would try to make surprises, but they (Gukesh and Gajewski) will go to a much greater extent and were quite successful with it... It's not a sensation he won the World Championship," says Nielsen.

"He and his team came up with a very interesting strategy. The preparation was, in my opinion, very modern. He took incredible risk by putting incredible pressure on his opponent." Carlsen had spoken about the Indian's tendency to play aggressively in most games rather than trying to



Magnus Carlsen's coach Peter Heine Nielsen at the Deichman Bjørkika in Oslo during Norway Chess. EXPRESS PHOTO

settle for draws.

Nielsen understands that approach.

"If you have the style of Gukesh, you will lose some games where you look very bad. Someone like (Vladimir) Kramnik can criticize that Gukesh

looks like a player with no positional understanding when he loses this game. But at least we should acknowledge that Gukesh is doing it on purpose because he is taking risks which he thinks are justified to put his opponent under maximum

Zee lands 2026 FIFA WC rights for India



Zee will broadcast multiple FIFA tournaments in this deal. REUTERS

Express News Service
New Delhi, June 1

THE 2026 FIFA World Cup has finally got an official broadcaster in India just over a week before the start of the tournament. Zee Entertainment Enterprises Ltd. said on Monday that it has reached a deal with FIFA, football's global governing body, in which it will broadcast "39 global football events", including the World Cup this year, the 2027 FIFA Women's World Cup and the 2030 FIFA World Cup as well.

The matches will be shown on its newly launched Unite8 Sports channels - Unite8 Sports 1, Unite8 Sports 1 HD, Unite8 Sports 2, and Unite8 Sports 2 HD, and will be streamed on Zee5. The deal is believed to be valued at around \$ 35 million, although there is no mention of the amount in Zee's official statement. FIFA had initially quoted close to \$100 million for rights to the 2026 and 2030 editions combined.

"The Indian market is of strategic importance for FIFA as it displays immense potential driven by a young and passionate audience. We believe the extensive broadcast and digital distribution ecosystem of 'Z' coupled with their deep understanding of local viewers and multi-platform capabilities will play a pivotal role in expanding the reach of football with fans across every part of India," FIFA Chief Business Officer Romy Gai is quoted as saying in the statement.

The other tournament that will be aired on Zee include the FIFA Men's U-17 World Cup (2026-2034), FIFA Women's U-17 World Cup (2026-2034), FIFA U-20 Men's World Cup (2027, 2029, 2031 and 2033), FIFA U-20 Women's World Cup (2026, 2028, 2030, 2032 and 2034), FIFA Futsal Men's World Cup (2028 and 2032), FIFA Futsal Women's World Cup (2029 and 2033), FIFA Women's World Cup (2027) and FIFA Intercontinental Cup (2026-2030).

The announcement ends months of uncertainty around the telecast of the tournament in India, the last major market for which FIFA was yet to secure broadcasting rights. It also comes just over two weeks after China's CCTV announced a deal to broadcast the World Cup on the mainland.

For India, one of the challenges has been the timing of the matches. Of the 104 matches scheduled across the USA, Canada and Mexico, nearly 90 percent will be played between midnight and 6 am IST - a difficult slot for advertisers, especially with India not featuring in the tournament.

The 2022 World Cup in Qatar, won by Lionel Messi's Argentina, was reportedly acquired for around Rs 480 crore (\$60 million). Industry estimates suggest broadcasters struggled to recover even half the investment through advertising revenues, making FIFA's initial asking price this time commercially unviable for major players.



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